



Battle lines form over regulation, safety of AI

Trump and allies have sniped at the movement for tighter guardrails

BY NITASHA TIKU, IAN DUNCAN AND GERRIT DE VYNCK

BERKELEY, CALIF. — After artificial intelligence safety advocates captured Washington’s attention with dire warnings about the technology’s power, the Trump administration and its allies embraced some of their suggestions, while moving to sideline the advocates themselves.

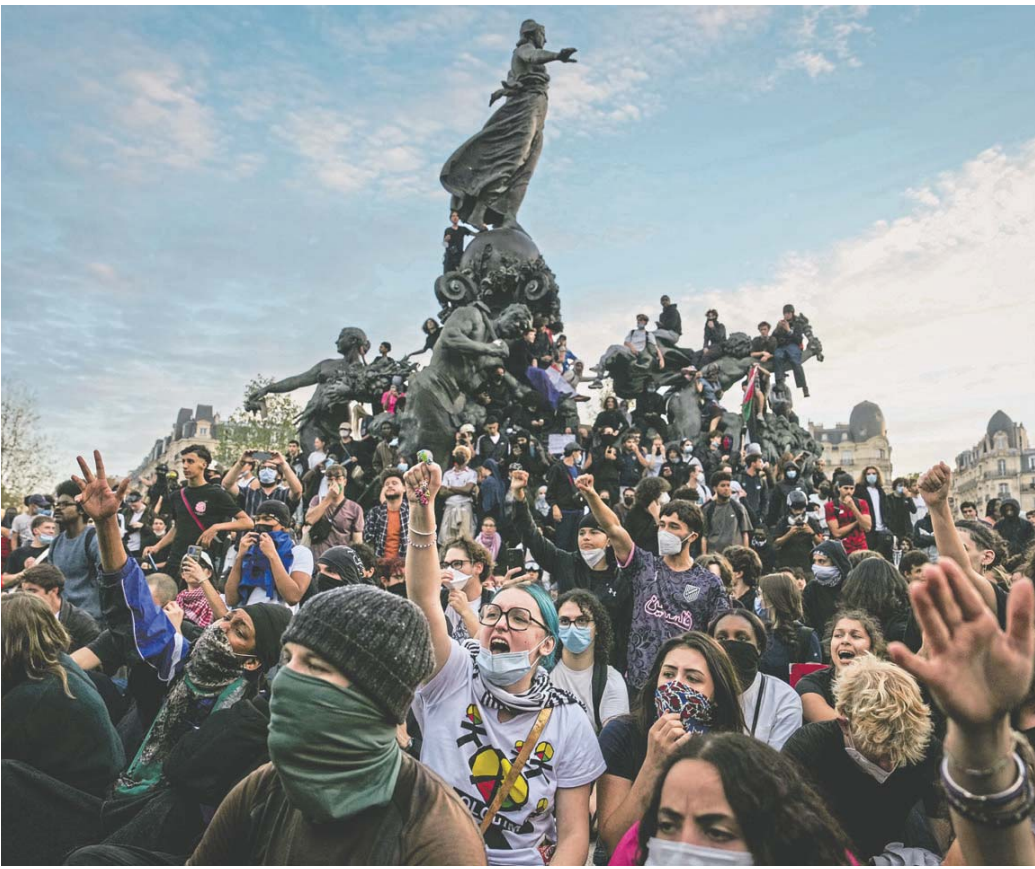
Battle lines have been drawn in recent days over part of an accord signed by President Donald Trump and AI chief executives last week: Who should audit AI companies’ systems to ensure their technology behaves as intended.

Leading AI companies — including OpenAI and Anthropic — have for years worked with a cluster of nonprofits concentrated in the Bay Area’s AI safety community, which grew out of the effective altruism movement. But Trump’s tech-world allies say the work of auditing AI should be taken on by America’s largest consulting firms.

“In my view they should be professional auditors, not these NGOs,” investor and former top White House AI adviser David Sacks said on his All-In podcast last week. He said in a post on X last month that the AI safety nonprofit METR, which has worked with Anthropic, was too close to the company to be called independent. Soon after, Anthropic said it would partner with consulting giant Accenture to build a team of outside evaluators.

At a conference here over the weekend, members of AI safety organizations grappled with the impact of what some see as a coordinated campaign to delegitimize their work and paint their community as cultish and unserious. The event took place at a former hotel popular with AI safety acolytes that also recently hosted a conference on AI con-

SEE AI ON A18



DIMITAR DILKOFF/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Protesters rally Tuesday at the Place de la République in Paris. The demonstrations have gained steam amid austerity measures.

ELECTION 2026

Kamala Harris has an opening, and a problem

BY CLEVE R. WOOTSON JR., PRAVEENA SOMASUNDARAM AND DAN MERICA

If Kamala Harris runs for president again, she would begin with advantages no rival could match: near-universal name recognition, experience in the White House and the hard-earned lessons of already having carried the party’s banner.

For many Democrats, that still may not be enough.

With roughly a dozen Democrats maneuvering toward possible 2028 bids, Harris retains considerable affection and respect inside the party. But inter-

views with 18 strategists, donors, former Harris surrogates and other Democrats — including some who backed her in 2024 — revealed persistent uncertainty about whether her moment was cut short or her time has passed, and whether she can lead Democrats back to power.

Some see a former vice president with an unmatched résumé in the still-forming field — a candidate who, her supporters argue, deserves a fairer shot than the 107 frantic days she had to take over and try to rescue Joe Biden’s faltering campaign.

Others see a defeated nominee

SEE HARRIS ON A6

For Collins, Trump is a drag in bid for 6th term

BY DAN MERICA

BUCKSPORT, MAINE — Sen. Susan Collins’s bid for a sixth term in the Senate is a test of political gravity.

For years, the Republican senator in an ever-more Democratic Maine has run so far ahead of President Donald Trump that she practically floated above him, suspended in air thanks to a mix of selective defiance and canny use of Senate seniority to steer millions to the small state for local works projects.

But 11 years into Trump’s political life, Collins’s campaign against Democrat Troy Jackson

has been weighed down by the Republican president and his constant controversy and growing disapproval. Trump is everywhere in the race. When voters talk about it, they invoke Trump more than they do the two candidates. Democratic ads accuse Collins of doing “whatever Donald Trump wants” and Jackson has claimed that the president “owns” Collins.

Collins rejects these attacks and told The Washington Post that she has “done more than

SEE COLLINS ON A8

Polling: Call centers say they can’t keep up with surging demand. **A7**

Anger boils over in France

STUDENT PROTESTS FILL THE STREETS

Walkouts tap into deep discontent ahead of voting

BY ELLEN FRANCIS

Student protests are sweeping France, morphing into a display of broader discontent as the government strains to control its finances, months before a critical presidential election.

People spilled into the streets Tuesday across the nation after two weeks of students blockading schools and at times clashing with police. Several influential French labor unions joined Tuesday’s rallies, as people gathered in dozens of cities including Paris, Lille, Lyon, Marseille, and Toulouse.

Hundreds of schools and colleges were shut, with students airing grievances over crowded classrooms, understaffing and inequalities in the education system.

“Old enough to be teargassed, but not to protest,” one sign in Lille said. “Disenchanted generation,” read another sign in Paris.

The protests have gained momentum as they tap into popular anger over spending cuts and rising prices, with a heated debate gripping France about how to contain record debt.

The storms risk converging six months out from an election that will determine the successor of two-term President Emmanuel Macron and the political direction of France, traditionally a key pillar in Europe.

The movement first spiraled out of a demonstration in late September in support of striking teachers at a school in the Paris suburb of Créteil, spreading through neglected, working-class suburbs of the French capital.

Protests have since expanded to many public high schools, or lycées, across the country. They have now grown with the backing of French unions including

SEE FRANCE ON A11

Obama-era DOJ official to lead probe of Cornell case

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA AND DANIELLE DOUGLAS-GABRIEL

A former acting U.S. attorney general will lead an independent review of Cornell University’s response to allegations of rape at a fraternity house in 2024, as well as how the school more generally deals with allegations and prevention of sexual misconduct, a new committee of the university’s board of trustees announced Tuesday.

The Ivy League university is facing widespread outrage related to the allegations, including from faculty members who have proposed a draft resolution saying they have no confidence in the school’s central administration to address the crisis.

Sally Q. Yates, now a partner at the law firm King & Spalding, and her team will review areas including Cornell’s campus

SEE CORNELL ON A2



ILIA YEFIMOVICH/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Three years later, wounds fester

Israelis pay their respects Tuesday at the Nova festival site in Reim, Israel. On Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas-led militants killed some 1,200 people in southern Israel and abducted 251 others.

Televangelist was disgraced in sex and fraud scandals

JIM BAKKER | 1940-2026

With wife Tammy Faye, he led PTL empire before his fall in the 1980s

BY MATT SCHUDEL

Jim Bakker, a televangelist who once led a multimillion-dollar religious empire with his wife, Tammy Faye, before a sex scandal tarnished his reputation and a conviction for fraud and conspiracy sent him to federal prison, died Oct. 5. He was 86.

His second wife, Lori, announced the death but did not cite a cause or say where he died. He had a stroke in 2020.

Mr. Bakker (pronounced “bak-er”) was a preacher and fundraiser on television for more than 20 years, developing a following that numbered in the millions. An ordained minister before being defrocked by his denomination, the Assemblies of God, he espoused a message that mixed wealth and success with

salvation.

He and his first wife were Bible Belt preachers before evangelist Pat Robertson hired them in the mid-1960s as personalities for his new Christian Broadcasting Network. Over several years, they refined their folksy, talk-show style of religious broadcasting with upbeat music, interviews, prayer and relentless fundraising, often punctuated by tearful pleas from one or both of them.

Mr. Bakker broke with Robertson in the early 1970s, establishing a separate broadcast network and a new show, “The PTL Club,” which stood for “Praise the Lord” and later for “People That Love.”

With Mr. Bakker’s boyish charm and his wife’s endless enthusiasm, accentuated by her thick makeup and elaborate wardrobe, “The PTL Club” became a mainstay of evangelical Christian broadcasting. The Bakkers built a ministry and financial juggernaut in Charlotte, and later in Fort Mill, South Carolina, that lasted from the mid-1970s

SEE BAKKER ON A9

IN THE NEWS

Reflecting Pool damage Attorneys for the former Olympian who had been accused of vandalism have called for watchdogs to probe alleged misconduct in the case. **B13**

A crucial strand of evidence Thomas Jefferson’s link to Sally Hemings’s children may have been settled by a single hair. **B13**

THE NATION **Border agents** knocked down a tree in Arizona that activists had occupied for months. **A3** **Christa Pike** is awake and speaking after a botched execution attempt, lawyers said. **A8**

THE WORLD **Vladimir Putin** is said to be counting on a collapse of European support for Ukraine. **A10** **The ex-head** of Germany’s foreign intelligence service is accused of selling state secrets. **A12**

THE ECONOMY **Paramount** closed its merger with Warner Bros. Discovery, creating a megacorporation in Hollywood, news and streaming. **A13** **Mocking victims** of romance scams only helps the criminals, columnist Michelle Singletary writes. **A14**

STYLE **Youth sports parents** are even more insufferable in a new Kim Kardashian-produced reality show. **B1**

SPORTS **Deion Sanders** is still capturing hearts at the Colorado program he put back on the map. Wins aren’t coming. **B7**

THE REGION **A hearing** for Kilmar Abrego García on his possible deportation to Liberia was abruptly canceled. **B13**

FOOD **A \$60 loaf** of rye bread illustrates everything that’s right and wrong with New York, Elazar Sontag writes. **E1**

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The Washington Post
Year 149, No. 54727



The Washington Post

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Letters to the editor:
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Published daily (ISSN 0190-8286).
POSTMASTER: Send address changes to The Washington Post, 1301 K St. NW, Washington, D.C. 20071.
Periodicals postage paid in Washington, D.C., and additional mailing office.

CORRECTION

• A Sept. 20 Real Estate article about utility bills in home-buying incorrectly said the company Pearl can provide a performance score for single-family houses and townhouses based on utility costs, energy efficiency and other measures. Scores are available only for single-family houses.

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I felt like bait: A timeline of the Cornell rape allegations

BY AMY B WANG

A lawsuit filed last month against Cornell University by “Jane Doe” — a former student who made allegations that she was drugged and raped by seven fraternity members in 2024 — has ignited a national debate about sexual assault on college campuses and drawn intense scrutiny over whether the response by Cornell and law enforcement two years ago was adequate.

The public outcry has prompted New York Gov. Kathy Hochul (D) to appoint New York Attorney General Letitia James (D) as a special prosecutor to reinvestigate the matter after saying she had lost faith in the district attorney’s ability to handle the case fairly. Meanwhile, local authorities have defended their initial decision not to pursue criminal charges.

Here’s how the allegations and the fallout unfolded.

August 2022

Jane Doe enters Cornell University as a freshman and pledges the Alpha Beta chapter of the Delta Delta Delta (Tri Delta) sorority.

Oct. 19, 2024

Doe, 20, visits two bars in Ithaca, New York, with her sorority sisters and consumes the equivalent of 10 drinks in about three hours. At about 11 p.m., Doe leaves the second bar alone and walks to the Chi Phi fraternity house to hang out with a friend who was a member there, according to the complaint.

The complaint states that the friend hands Doe a beer, dances with her in the main room of the house, then pulls her off to a quieter area and propositions her with having a threesome with him and one of his fraternity brothers. According to the complaint, the two men lead her upstairs and allegedly pressure her into ingesting ketamine, marijuana and liquor, then begin engaging in sexual acts without her consent.

Oct. 20, 2024

At 1:42 a.m., one of the men sends a Snapchat message to fraternity members and says there is “Free p---y” upstairs. Several members join the assault, the complaint says.

A screen recording of the conversation, obtained by The Washington Post, shows that a picture of Doe was shared in the chat. Someone asks afterward: “Shop still open?” Another responds, “Yeah,” with a devil emoji, and later adds: “Boys come whip it out.”

Several men enter the room throughout the night and snort ketamine off Doe’s body, according to the complaint. Later in the night, two of the men initiate another sexual assault of Doe, concluding around 5:45 a.m., the complaint says.

When Doe wakes up later in the day, she returns to the Tri Delta sorority house “in a state of shock” and notices that a large bruise had formed on her buttocks, the complaint says.

Oct. 21, 2024

Doe receives a text message from one of the men, who says he “just wanted to apologize for how things went down the other



A protester at Cornell University. The Jane Doe case got national attention after the school newspaper wrote about it last month.



The Chi Phi fraternity house where Jane Doe said she was assaulted by several members.

er night,” according to the New York Times.

Oct. 22, 2024

Doe visits the university’s health center and reports to a doctor that she contracted a urinary tract infection “in a traumatic way,” according to the Times.

Nov. 3, 2024

Doe sends a text to another fraternity member she later would accuse of sexual assault and tells him that “90% of what happened that night was not consensual” and that she “was given more [ketamine] than i can remember,” according to the Times.

Nov. 8, 2024

Doe reports what happened to Cornell University police and Cornell’s Chi Phi branch — called the Xi chapter — and seven students are placed on temporary suspension, according to the complaint.

Nov. 14-15, 2024

Campus police interview Doe,

according to CBS News. An officer drafts a six-page statement based on those interviews and, after making about 20 handwritten corrections, Doe signs a final version of her sworn statement to police, according to the Times. Cornell later says it turns over its investigative material to the Tompkins County District Attorney’s Office, which declines to pursue criminal charges.

Nov. 26, 2024

Cornell’s interim president, Michael Kotlikoff, issues a statement to the university regarding “ongoing investigations into the serious and deeply disturbing allegations of drug abuse and sexual violence at the Chi Phi fraternity house.” He notes that the fraternity remains under a temporary suspension.

January 2025 to May 2025

Cornell commences a Title IX investigation. Title IX investigations into allegations of sex-based discrimination or sexual misconduct are mandatory for schools that accept federal funding.

The university conducts more than 50 interviews with 32 witnesses over several months. Cornell also conducts at least 12 hearings in May 2025 regarding Doe’s allegations. Doe testifies at one of those hearings, saying: “I felt like bait. I felt like lions around me. It just was a totally debilitating place to be in.”

Sept. 16, 2026

Doe files a lawsuit against seven members of the Xi chapter of Chi Phi, Cornell University, the national Chi Phi fraternity, the Tri Delta sorority, an Ithaca bar and others.

The 101-page complaint states that Doe “was plied with alcohol and drugs to the point of intoxication” at the fraternity house, and it made allegations in detail that she was sexually assaulted and raped by members of the fraternity over the course of about seven hours.

The lawsuit accuses the students of sexual assault and battery, while accusing Cornell of failing to do enough to protect Doe. It seeks a jury trial to determine damages.

Sept. 18, 2026

The Cornell Daily Sun, a student newspaper, writes about the lawsuit, and the case begins gaining national attention.

Sept. 28, 2026

Tompkins County District Attorney Matthew Van Houten releases a lengthy statement announcing he has reopened the case and defending his decision not to pursue criminal charges in 2024. His comments include a summary of facts from Doe’s sworn statement, in which she says she “described her participation in drug use and sexual conduct as voluntary, conscious, and consensual.”

Cornell also issues a statement defending its response: “Any suggestion that the university did not impose consequential punishments for those involved is false,” university spokesman Kyle Kimball writes.

Sept. 30, 2026

CBS News reports that it has obtained a copy of a transcript of the interview between Doe and campus police in which she says that she had gaps in her memory, that she remembers being “physically hit very, very hard” during the assault, and that she said, “I can say with 100% confidence I was raped.” Van Houten tells CBS News he had not seen a copy of that transcript before.

Chi Phi issues a statement saying the fraternity “went beyond anything the law or Cornell University required” in disciplining the alleged perpetrators, noting they had been expelled permanently from the national fraternity.

Oct. 1, 2026

New York Gov. Kathy Hochul (D) announces that she has appointed New York Attorney General Letitia James (D) as special prosecutor because she has lost faith in the Tompkins County district attorney’s ability to fairly oversee the case.

Cornell University leaders may face a no-confidence vote by the Faculty Senate

CORNELL FROM AI

police response and processes, coordination with external law enforcement and prosecutors, disciplinary decisions and oversight of Greek life, the university committee said.

Yates and her team also will inquire in detail about Cornell’s response to a then-student’s allegations of sexual assault by members of the Chi Phi fraternity two years ago — including whether the university followed its own policies in its response to the incident.

A longtime federal prosecutor, Yates was appointed deputy attorney general under President Barack Obama. She became acting attorney general early in the first Trump administration, but she was fired days after ordering Justice Department lawyers not to defend President Donald Trump’s refugee and immigration ban in court. She later led an independent investigation for U.S. Soccer after allegations of sexual misconduct and abusive behavior at the highest levels of women’s professional soccer.

“Sally Q. Yates brings extraordinary experience, independence and judgment to this work,” Anne Meining Smalling, chair of the Cornell special committee, said in a news release. “The questions

raised by the Jane Doe matter warrant a rigorous examination of Cornell’s response to that case, but our responsibility is broader. We have asked Ms. Yates and her team to examine Cornell’s overall approach to preventing and responding to sexual misconduct, identify where we are doing things well and where we can do better, and recommend changes that will help make our community safer.”

Since news broke last month of a lawsuit the former student had filed in connection with her allegations, Cornell’s leaders have faced mounting pressure from critics who question whether enough was done to investigate and address the alleged assault.

Cornell undertook an extensive Title IX investigation, disciplined students and barred the fraternity from campus, but some of the alleged perpetrators were permitted to remain enrolled or eventually return to campus.

The local district attorney declined to seek criminal charges, but the criminal case was reopened after the lawsuit was filed. The criminal investigation has since been taken over by the office of New York state Attorney General Letitia James. On Tuesday, her office said it is in the fi-

nal stages of also hiring outside counsel to assist it in the criminal investigation.

The allegations have touched off emotional discussions nationwide about sexual assault, drug use, consent and Greek life. On Monday, hundreds of students protested on campus. Before dawn that day, activists vandalized an administration building.

The draft no-confidence resolution by a group of Cornell faculty members is a rare move reflecting the depth of concern on campus. It could be put on the Faculty Senate’s agenda for discussion as soon as next week, several professors said in interviews. If eventually scheduled for a vote and approved, the resolution would send a symbolic but still powerful message to the university’s leaders.

“People are very upset,” said David Bateman, an associate professor in the government department and president of the university’s chapter of the American Association of University Professors. “People are upset about what happened, and they are upset about the university’s actions and behavior and posture toward the entire attack.”

Ariana Kim, an associate professor of music, accused Cornell administrators of putting the preservation of image and the



Sally Q. Yates speaks at Harvard University in 2017.

bottom line above the welfare of the community. She said there is momentum to call for resignations and a turnover in leadership. “Now is the time,” she said.

Other professors disagreed. Charles Walcott, who has been on the faculty for 45 years and served as university ombudsman for a decade, said it would be difficult for any college president to navigate the current situation but that he believes the adminis-

tration has done a good job.

“I happen to think that our president, Mike Kotlikoff, is just excellent, and a thoughtful, caring human being who really wants to get this right,” said Walcott, a professor emeritus of neurobiology and behavior. He called the independent reviews an important step.

Dozens of members of Cornell’s board of trustees did not immediately respond to questions Tuesday.

Kyle Kimball, a spokesman for the university, said, “We understand the frustration and concern being expressed by members of our community, and we are listening and engaging directly with them.”

He said Cornell President Michael Kotlikoff and members of the administration are scheduled to meet with the Faculty Senate next week. “We look forward to that conversation,” Kimball wrote in an email, “and to continuing to engage constructively with faculty and others across the Cornell community.”

On Saturday, Kotlikoff released a video acknowledging the anger and sadness on campus and saying he supported Hochul’s decision to appoint James as a special prosecutor to lead a reopened criminal investigation.

The appointment triggered

pushback from Trump, a longtime James critic, and from some New York Republicans who questioned whether the attorney general could be impartial in the case. They pointed to a social media post in which James had expressed sympathy for the woman who made the allegations.

James’ office noted Tuesday that it was not unusual for a state attorney general to seek out outside counsel in high-profile cases. But the retention of outside counsel, which could be finalized in the coming days, could help the attorney general fend off her skeptics.

Alexis Richards, a spokeswoman for James, said the attorney general’s office “remains committed to a thorough and independent investigation guided only by the facts and the law.”

Richards added that attorneys in James’s office have already met with Tompkins County District Attorney Matthew Van Houten and Jane Doe’s attorney.

Van Houten, who has been sharply criticized over his office’s initial handling of the allegations, has agreed to cooperate with the state probe, according to James’s office. Van Houten did not return a call to his office on Tuesday.

Tim Craig contributed to this report.



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THE NATION



PHOTOS BY CASSIDY ARAIZA/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST



CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: An activist retrieves a bucket from the tree sitter last month. A plywood platform had been rigged up. The border wall under construction. Kate Scott, who kicked off the tree sit.

Border agents topple ‘grandmother’ tree after a long standoff with activists

Giant cottonwood was in way of \$46.5 billion border wall expansion

BY JAKE SPRING

LOCHIEL, ARIZ. — For more than two months, activists sat high up in the branches of a giant cottonwood tree here on the border with Mexico in an effort to block federal contractors from knocking it down to make way for President Donald Trump’s \$46.5 billion border wall expansion.

But that standoff came to an end Monday when demonstrators say more than 50 Customs and Border Protection agents raided the activist camp and an excavator knocked down what they called a “grandmother” tree, estimated to be 150 to 250 years old.

Footage taken by protesters shows the massive tree crashing down as border agents look on, and the activists who worked to protect it wail.

“We have been raided, assaulted, battered, bruised, bleeding by the Border Patrol agents,” said Kate Scott, an activist who kicked off the group’s tree sit, in a call following Monday’s raid. As CBP cleared the area, about 10 people were arrested, the group of activists estimates, and another 10 received citations, including for “violation of a closure order” for being in the border-wall zone.

At least one activist showed images of scrapes and bandages on a Monday video call.

Customs and Border Protection previously identified cottonwood trees on federal land in Lochiel “that needed removal for planned border wall construction” and finished removing them as of Monday, the agency’s assistant commissioner Hilton Beckham said in a statement.

“CBP recognizes the importance of protecting the environment, wildlife, and cultural resources during border wall construction,” Beckham said, adding that preconstruction sur-

veys found no active migratory bird nests. The Department of Homeland Security has waived dozens of laws requiring rigorous review of environmental impacts, although Hilton said the agency was still conducting environmental and cultural reviews and seeking public input.

CBP did not respond to questions about the descriptions of the confrontation with activists.

The cottonwood tree had become a rallying point for anti-border wall activists, who opposed the destruction of a native habitat and major wildlife corridor, as well as the Trump administration’s immigration crackdown.

The scene Monday brought to close a confrontation that began on July 27.

Scott, who had been in Lochiel on and off for weeks to keep an eye on advancing border construction, had sped back to the tiny former border crossing town that day after hearing fellow activists were in trouble. Arriving just in time, she ran across a field and dove under a fence, popping up on the other side to block an excavator that had already knocked down three other “grandmother” cottonwood trees.

The operator banged the excavator’s bucket around the tree threateningly and came within six feet of Scott. But he could not knock down the tree without hurting her, she said. He backed off, churning up the dirt nearby before leaving the area, damaging some tree roots but leaving it otherwise intact.

The moment was the start of what became a 70-day standoff on the Arizona border, amid efforts to massively expand the border wall during Trump’s second term.

Wanting to stop contractors from moving forward, Scott and a small but rapidly growing group of activists saw only one option to protect the cottonwood that clearly was in the border wall’s path.

“We looked at each other and said ‘Who is going to go up in the tree?’” Scott said.

At first, a tree-sitter just sat on

a high branch with a yoga mat. But by night, a plywood platform — big enough for just one person at a time — had been rigged up to the tree, offering a bit more stability.

The group’s tree sit drew on a decades old tradition that became most famous in California and the Pacific Northwest as a way to block loggers from cutting down old-growth forests. In the late 1990s, Julia Butterfly Hill occupied a redwood tree in Northern California for more than two years to prevent loggers from cutting it down.

“I have been supporting from a distance, the efforts against the border wall construction,” Hill said on social media, resharing posts from the Arizona tree sit to her account and alerting her followers to the clash with border agents on Monday.

As of late September, the wall construction stopped short about 300 feet from the tree. The contractors rarely passed, choosing alternate routes.

Speaking to The Washington Post in Lochiel last month, Scott called the effort a success thus far.

“Any group of people that can prevent border wall ecocide for close to three months is a milestone achievement,” she said then.

Federal contractors have been building the wall at a furious pace at the other end of the San Rafael Valley, a rolling grassland where the 1955 musical “Oklahoma!” was filmed. About 10 miles east of the tree-sit, a newly built concrete plant continuously loads trucks pouring the footers of the wall, while dozens of trailers sit nearby to house contractors working in the otherwise remote area.

On Monday, the camp that held frenetic construction at bay for weeks descended into chaos. As the group held a “sunrise ceremony,” a regular camp ritual not long after daybreak, dozens of CBP officers stormed the area.

“We were holding prayer. We were all silent and in meditation when they originally started to come,” said one activist on a Monday video call, identifying

herself as “Hoops,” showing a scrapped and bandaged arm.

“One of our comrades was literally handcuffed and they were kicking him as he was on the ground,” the activist said. “They were dragging our comrades on the ground. They were pushing us into barbed wire fences. They had knees on people’s necks. They shoved me — I’m a very small person — and multiple men shoved me to the ground and got on top of me.”

All except for Scott declined to give their names or have their faces photographed, speaking on the condition of anonymity to protect their privacy and for fear of retaliation. Many of the activists adopted nature-related noms de guerre like “Tidepool.”

The border wall construction has already changed the landscape in an area where no wall was built in Trump’s first term. One completed section with two 30-foot-high parallel walls — and 150 feet of no man’s land between them — bisects a landscape that until recently would have offered visitors a panorama view of near-pristine nature for miles on either side of the border.

In Lochiel specifically, the tree-sitters are defending one of Arizona’s last riparian ecosystems, or those that grow along waterways or water just below the surface, said Russ McSpadden, Southwest conservation advocate for the Center for Biological Diversity, an advocacy group. He estimates those ecosystems, which allow for larger plants like cottonwoods to grow, have been more than 90 percent wiped out in the state.

The camp often mounts colorful, artistic protests that involve music, dance or dressing up. Last month, three activists were arrested after confronting contractors while dressed as animals — including a jaguar and yellow-billed cuckoo — they say will have their migration corridors cut off by the wall.

Scott, who wore a monochrome jaguar shirt and a shawl, is a “great hippy matriarch of the valley,” McSpadden said, contrasting with the mostly much

younger activists in the camp. Others protestors wore bandannas or even T-shirts tied across their faces, some expressing distrust of mainstream media.

Some wore dusters and broad brimmed hats — evoking the look of 19th-century desperados of the Wild West — seemingly enough to spook at least one contractor who turned the truck around.

What unites the group is a feeling that someone needs to stand up for the nature that is being destroyed for the border wall, several said.

“The border wall is not yet a scar. It’s an open wound on our mother, mother earth’s skin, mother mom’s family and in the heart of the mother in all of us,” wrote one activist who went by “Buglove,” when asked how they felt about the border wall. They wrote responses with pen and paper on the tree platform, sending them back and forth 50 feet via bucket and pulley.

“It is a monument to fascism and tool of fear. It is not built for any ‘real’ purpose, even the evil purpose the state claims,” they wrote.

During the tree sit, activists took turns ascending to the platform, where there was just enough room for one person to live for days at a time. One activist, a Tucson-based arborist who only identified herself as “Magnolia,” said that when sitting in the tree, she could feel the roots shift whenever heavy equipment drives past. Living in the tree was “uncomfortable but really special.”

There was some “surf” on the platform, she said. It shifted with the person’s movement and the wind.

“It’s a mixture of terrifying, boring, magical and peaceful,” the activist said.

A bucket, raised by rope helped deliver meals to the sitters, and helped with bathroom and waste needs. The group kept secret how tree sitters would get into the tree and how often they would need to switch places.

By September, the camp could fluctuate between as few as half a dozen protestors and swell to

more than 100 on days when special events were planned. When The Washington Post visited the site on Sept. 24, about 20 tents were set up on a private property just behind the cottonwood tree, whose owner allowed them passage to the 60-foot border zone controlled by the federal government.

But most of the group did not know each other before they organically arrived at the tree, Scott said.

“It’s magic. People just show up and they know how to do things for exactly what you need,” she added.

She said pockets of resistance against the wall have risen up in other areas along the border in Tohono O’odham Nation in Arizona out to Big Bend in Texas, where people say they are fed up with the government.

Some Tohono O’odham members have taken up watch on their segment of the border, where they have maintained a camp and prayer fire for weeks, observing masked CBP agents escorting contractors to drill soil samples in August.

In Big Bend, a judge granted a temporary injunction last week blocking construction of border infrastructure, in response to a lawsuit brought by environmental advocates and locals.

“We’re all aligned, and we all feel this is the moment in time and this is a time we have to take these direct actions because nothing else has mattered,” Scott said. “We know they don’t listen to us. They file our requests and our pleas and our petitions in boxes.”

In late September, Scott had vowed: “We will be here as long as it takes.”

Following Monday’s raid, Scott said they would continue carrying out other unspecified “direct action” that could take imaginative or creative forms.

“They have just cut down our grandmother but her roots are within all of us. I want to tell the country they will have a firestorm of energy, of prayer and song and activism and direct action like they have never seen,” Scott said.

Trump says public money won't be used to fund ads

BY NATALIE ALLISON

President Donald Trump announced Monday that he would reverse course on using taxpayer dollars to pay for ads promoting himself and his policies, following backlash from Democrats and even some Republicans about the campaign-style commercials.

Trump had initially doubled down on plans to continue the ads, saying they were justified because he was not on the ballot.

"The Radical Left is upset with the fact that I am taking Ads, which I consider to be a positive promotion for our Great U.S.A., and paying for them with U.S.A. money," Trump wrote on Truth Social, shortly before landing in Nebraska for a rally.

Trump argued that the television spots, which included one that closely resembled an ad for his 2024 presidential campaign, and another of him and Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth

advocating for the Iran war, were "a rather standard thing to do." But he said he had "decided to do the Patriotic Ads, among others, and pay for them myself, and with money I raised for MAGA, Inc."

A White House official, speaking on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to discuss the matter publicly, said Trump's commitment covered future ads. The official defended the propriety of the ads that already ran and did not say whether Trump would reimburse the government.

Trump last week signaled that he was open to reversing course, telling reporters he would "gladly pay the money" if someone determined the practice was "wrong."

Federal law prohibits agencies from using taxpayer money for unauthorized "publicity or propaganda." The Government Accountability Office, Congress's investigative arm, says the prohibition covers communications that are purely par-

tisan, but acknowledged that administrations may use public money to explain and defend their policies.

Other ads featured campaign slogans and footage of Mount Rushmore.

Each featured a message saying "Paid for by the U.S. Government." So far, the ads have been paid for with money Congress approved for border security upgrades, efforts to combat drug trafficking and memorials for officers killed in the line of duty, The Washington Post previously reported.

Days before the ads began airing, the White House Office of Management and Budget on Sept. 19 added \$20 million to a Department of Homeland Security budget line designated for "commemorative events."

The next day, DHS awarded a \$20 million contract to a "national media campaign" to a Maryland-based media firm.

Isaac Arnsdorf contributed to this report.



President Donald Trump argued that the television spots were "a rather standard thing to do."

President approves use of firing squad in execution of Fort Hood shooter

BY AOIFE WALSH

President Donald Trump has approved the execution by firing squad of Nidal Malik Hasan, a former U.S. Army psychiatrist who opened fire on dozens of people at Fort Hood, Texas, in 2009.

Sean Parnell, the Pentagon's spokesman, said Monday that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth had recommended death by Army firing squad and that Trump approved it.

"Judgement day for Hasan has finally come," Parnell said on X.

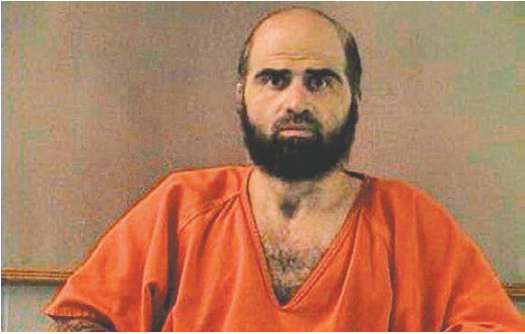
The secretary of the Army will decide the time and place of the execution, Parnell added.

If carried out, it would mark the first U.S. military execution since April 13, 1961, when Army Pvt. John A. Bennett was hanged after being convicted of rape

and attempted murder, according to the nonprofit Death Penalty Information Center, which monitors capital punishment. The military's last known firing squad execution was carried out by "musketry" on Nov. 9, 1945, according to the group.

Hasan, an American-born Muslim, killed 13 people and injured 32 others when he opened fire at Fort Hood's Soldier Readiness Processing Center, where troops were preparing to deploy to Afghanistan. He shouted "Allahu akbar!" meaning "God is great," before targeting soldiers with a handgun he had fitted with laser sights.

Hasan, who acted as his own attorney, was convicted of premeditated murder and sentenced to death in 2013. During his court-martial, he admitted responsibility for the shooting,



Nidal Hasan was sentenced to death for a shooting rampage at Fort Hood, Texas, in 2009 that killed 13 people and injured 32.

deploy, the court heard.

Execution by firing squad is rare in the United States, permitted in a handful of states: Idaho, Oklahoma, Utah, South Carolina and Mississippi. Three people in South Carolina were put to death using the method last year, Death Penalty Information Center data shows. Before then, only three people had been executed in this manner since 1977 — all in Utah.

Trump has long been a staunch supporter of capital punishment. During his first term in 2020, the Justice Department carried out its first federal executions in nearly two decades. In his second term, his administration lifted a moratorium on federal executions and pushed for more death sentences.

In April, the Justice Department said it would move to ex-

pand execution methods used to carry out federal death sentences beyond lethal injection, including by making the electric chair and firing squads available in some cases. It also directed federal officials to restore the execution protocol from Trump's first term, which uses the drug pentobarbital for lethal injections.

Trump's approval of Hasan's execution by firing squad comes days after Tennessee authorities made a botched attempt to execute Christa Pike, who was sentenced to death for her role in a brutal 1995 murder, by lethal injection.

Pike was hospitalized after she was given two doses of pentobarbital but continued to breathe for nearly an hour, court filings by her legal team stated. Her attorney said Sunday she remains in critical condition.

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Doubts swirl about whether Harris could lead Democrats back to power

HARRIS FROM AI

inextricably tied to the party's recent past confronting Democrats hungry for new leaders, sharper ideas and a more decisive break from the political order that preceded Donald Trump's return to power.

Beneath the respect for the former Democratic standard-bearer is a striking anxiety about the potential consequences of her return to the political conversation. Her stature could instantly reorder the field, discouraging some candidates from running and forcing others to define themselves around her. For some in the party, the concern is not simply that Harris could lose again. It is that her candidacy could pull Democrats back toward a painful political era before they have fully reckoned with what happened and how to move beyond it.

"She's extraordinarily popular in the party and people are very fond of her and want her to be treated with a lot of respect and deference — given all the due of someone in her position," said Jamal Simmons, a Democratic strategist who was Harris's communications director for a year starting in January 2022. "Many people see it as a service what she did in 2024, where she really stepped up for the party, stepped up for Joe Biden, stepped up for the country. There's a lot of respect for her. But it's yet to be seen how much of that becomes support for another presidential run."

Former transportation secretary Pete Buttigieg, Maryland Gov. Wes Moore and California Gov. Gavin Newsom have already begun making appearances in South Carolina, which will host the Democrats' first presidential primary in 2028 — a change designed in part to give Black voters and the party's broader coalition a larger voice in choosing the nominee.

Newsom, who has made a pair of recent visits there, said last month he would not run if Harris enters the race, wary of forcing their overlapping political bases to choose between them.

Fletcher Smith, a former South Carolina state legislator and one of Biden's surrogates in the state in 2020, said Harris's pending decision is impeding a necessary conversation about the Democratic Party's future.

"People just want to move on," he said. "We've got a number of younger-generation people who are capable of leading — we've got governors, we've got congresspeople, we have senators. I think what she needs to do is sit out 2028 and let some other people have a shot at saving our democracy."

Through a spokesperson, Harris declined multiple requests to comment on this story. She revisited the frustrations of her abbreviated campaign in full last year with a memoir, "107 Days," that included the difficulty of distinguishing herself from Biden while serving as his vice president.

She has left open the possibility of another presidential run. This spring she said she was "thinking about it." She has expanded her public appearances as the midterms have approached, campaigning in key battleground states — in Michigan for U.S. Senate candidate Abdul El-Sayed and, soon, in Georgia for Sen. Jon Ossoff.

For those eager for Harris to run again, her experience is an argument for another chance.

Harris has been a senator, presidential candidate, vice president and presidential nominee — a résumé that would ordinarily be an enormous asset and, many Democrats say, make her an instant front-runner should she enter the race.

Harris and her allies have long viewed the 2024 loss through the constraints of the campaign she inherited: an unpopular incumbent, deep voter frustration over inflation and the economy, and barely three months to convince voters that she represented change while still serving as Biden's vice president. She lost the popular vote to Trump by about 2.3 million votes and the electoral college, 312 to 226.

Maria Cardona, a longtime Democratic strategist and friend of Harris, said the former vice president faces less time pressure than other potential candidates. Given her 2024 experience, Harris would be able to scale up campaign operations faster than other potential contenders who have never appeared on a national ballot, Cardona said.

Another go-round would look different from the 2024 campaign that she assembled in a pinch after Biden dropped out, Cardona said: "If she decides to run, she will run as an unapolo-



MARIO TAMA/GETTY IMAGES

Beneath deep respect for the former Democratic standard-bearer is a striking anxiety about the potential consequences of her return to the political conversation.



JOE KLAMAR/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

For some, the concern is not simply that she could lose again. It is that her candidacy could pull Democrats back to a painful political era.

getic, unabridged version of Kamala Harris. And I don't think any of us know what that looks like."

Ashley Etienne, who was Harris's first communications director as vice president, acknowledged that Harris would need to create some distance from a Democratic establishment facing an increasingly anti-status-quo sentiment. But she argued that Harris's critics discount something none of her potential rivals has yet demonstrated: that she can withstand the personal scrutiny, political pressure and sheer intensity of a national presidential campaign.

"It's almost like, why not her? She has proven, unlike anyone

else in the race, that she's got these advantages that will matter in a national election," Etienne said.

Some Democrats warned that moving too quickly past Harris would carry its own political cost, particularly among Black women, one of the party's most loyal constituencies.

L. Louise Lucas (D-Portsmouth), the first woman and first Black person to be president pro tempore of the Virginia Senate, said she would back whoever becomes the Democratic nominee. But she said Black women she knows could see Democrats' rejection of Harris as another painful rebuff of a Black woman who had earned

her chance to lead.

"There's no question that people would be upset because you see what happened last time," Lucas said. "It could very well be that some folks would be so disillusioned that they would just say, 'I give up on this process' — especially people who've been fighting as many years as I have, who have come through the civil rights movement and just experienced so much, endured so much, and then to see this happen again would be quite painful."

The 2024 campaign gave Harris unequalled name recognition, said Clay Middleton, a former senior adviser to the Biden-Harris campaign in South Carolina

and a longtime Democratic operative in the state.

"She is instantly the front-runner because she was our nominee the last time, she has an infrastructure that was in place that she can turn on quickly," Middleton said. "But can you stay up through the course of the entire cycle?"

Those advantages may help less as the party searches for new language, new fights and new political identities. To some Democrats, Harris looks less like the beginning of the next Democratic era than a vestige of the last one.

"I think she is a great candidate, but I don't want to see Harris run," said David Wilson, an 81-year-old retired educator from St. Louis. He supported Biden in the 2020 primary, voted for Harris in 2024 and would like to see someone else on the ballot in 2028. "She already lost and I don't think there is a practical purpose when you have a lot of good candidates to put up a loser a second time around. I want new ideas."

Harris faced skepticism about her political skills before her defeat. During her vice presidency, Democrats consistently questioned whether she could eventually lead the ticket, concerns that flared after awkward interviews, verbal stumbles and periods when she receded from public view. At one point, Sen. Elizabeth Warren (D-Massachusetts) conspicuously stopped short of endorsing Harris as Biden's 2024 running mate, though she quickly clarified that she supported the pair's reelection.

Yet when Biden abruptly ended his campaign in July 2024, the doubts gave way to remarkable speed and unanimity. Biden endorsed Harris, Democratic leaders quickly followed, and within days she had secured commitments from enough del-

"If she decides to run, she will run as an unapologetic, unabridged version of Kamala Harris. And I don't think any of us know what that looks like."

Maria Cardona, Democratic strategist and Harris's friend

egates to effectively claim the nomination.

Her defeat renewed questions about how she had made her case to voters.

A Democratic autopsy of the 2024 race argued that the White House, under Biden, did not do enough to set Harris up for political success, a frequent if whispered gripe among people in Harris's camp. But the report, which party leadership has said did not meet its standards, also faulted the campaign for assuming that negative views of Trump were baked in and for not doing enough to win the economic argument.

For some past supporters, the test will be what a Harris campaign has to offer Democrats.

Bakari Sellers, a former South Carolina state senator who helped marshal delegates behind Harris in 2024, said he still regards her as "extremely talented." But talent alone, he said, will not answer the questions Democrats have about her viability.

She has taken public stances on issues, he said, but she has not defined what her candidacy would mean for the constituencies that matter most to her success. She hasn't spoken to him in more than a year, which he said raises questions about someone who would need to win South Carolina.

"One of the first statements she put out was about AI, when it's clear she needs to boost her support among Black men," Sellers said. "California has a cost-of-living issue, and she's not talking about cost of living at all."

Harris has largely receded from the spotlight since her defeat. Her reemergence on the campaign trail will give prospective supporters like Erick Allen, a Cobb County commissioner and former Georgia state representative, another look.

Allen, who backed Harris early during her first presidential run in 2019, said many people he knows are watching her closely.

"I think people want to see what's happened in two years," he said. "What is she going to come out looking like? If she goes out there and she gets the cheers, she's feeling good, you better damn well believe you're going to start seeing the 'Kamala 2028' bumper stickers."



DEMETRIUS FREEMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Harris has been a senator, a vice president and a presidential nominee — a résumé that ordinarily would be an enormous asset.

With so many close races, pollsters struggle to keep up

Increased demand makes it harder to accurately gauge public opinion

BY KATHERINE DOYLE

The expanded political map for this year's midterm elections has sharply increased the demand for polling, straining the call centers that conduct surveys, squeezing capacity and complicating the already difficult task of getting accurate reads on public opinion, according to pollsters.

"It's like doomsday," said Landon Wall, a Republican pollster and founder of GrayHouse, noting that his firm rotates through three different call centers depending on capacity constraints.

"It's the most stressed I've ever been in my entire career. We are medium-sized. We do millions of dollars of polling. But even that does not mean we have the volume to book things out."

"There are races coming online that should not have been," said Brent Buchanan, founder and CEO of Cygnal, a prominent Republican firm. "When you planned out how many polls you were going to need in a year, you're polling in places you weren't expecting to poll, or polling at the frequency you weren't expecting to poll, and this is on both sides."

"For Democrats, it's more opportunity. For Republicans, it's more defense," he said.

As the fall campaign has moved into its final weeks, the pace has become so intense that pollsters describe staying up late to release surveys, waking up and doing it all again, barely stopping in between for coffee. "We are doing it over and over and over and over again," said one research firm executive. "It's relentless."

One firm told The Washington Post it had been forced to turn down business. And because certain areas have become more time-consuming to poll accurately, the process is taking longer, and labor costs are rising.

The challenges come at a



People cheer on President Donald Trump during a rally in Vandalia, Ohio, on Saturday.

worsening political moment for President Donald Trump and his party. Just 27 percent of voters surveyed by the Economist/YouGov in late September said the country was headed in the right direction, even as the poll showed that Trump retained 91 percent approval among supporters of his Make America Great Again movement.

The demand for more polls to keep up with rapidly evolving races may be worsening the problem of obtaining a representative group of voters willing to participate.

"Even if you increase capacity, you're getting a lower return per hour of calling now than you were two years ago," Buchanan said. "I think a decent portion

of it is, one, the emotional mood of the country, that you have a segment of folks who are just fired up and angry and willing to answer any call, but they don't represent the electorate as a whole, and you have a lot of people that are discouraged, and that doesn't make you want to answer a phone call and have a conversation about a political race."

In many of the places now attracting increased attention, pollsters say voters are tired of being surveyed and increasingly reluctant to pick up the phone. Even text-message surveys, which place smaller demands on people's time, are proving challenging.

The problem has become se-

vere enough in some states to make polling substantially more difficult and expensive.

According to a document reviewed by The Post, one of the country's largest survey-data-collection firms has told clients that, in at least one region, many of its agents are able to get just one completed interview per shift — sometimes fewer.

Alaska, the sprawling and sparsely populated battleground that could decide control of the Senate, has been particularly difficult, pollsters said.

In South Texas, a notoriously low-turnout area, several statewide races are dominating the airwaves, and numerous polls are in the field, compounding the problem of finding voters

who will respond.

These difficulties have led some Republican consultants to question whether polling is accurately capturing the standing of candidates.

"Should you be concerned about accuracy of polling going into November? Absolutely, yes," said Wall. "There are so many signs that the polling is really low quality right now."

One much-discussed issue is what pollsters call nonresponse bias — the tendency of enthusiastic voters to more readily respond to polls than discouraged ones. How much that affects the accuracy of polls is almost impossible to know until after the fact: Among other complicating factors, voters who are too dis-

heartened to answer a survey may also be unlikely to cast a ballot.

White House and GOP officials say that encouraging Republican turnout is the core of what Trump will be seeking to do over the campaign's final weeks.

"President Trump is the unequivocal leader, best messenger, and unmatched motivator for the Republican Party, and he is committed to maintaining Republican majorities in Congress," said White House spokesperson Davis Ingle.

"While Democrats squabble over the last two cents their party has to spare and throw in the towel on key races, the president is barnstorming the country, energizing our base, and supercharging Republican candidates in battleground districts and beyond," said Republican National Committee spokesperson Natalie Baldassarre. "We have the resources to spend, and Republicans are full steam ahead to protect and expand our majorities."

As Trump makes stops intended to bolster Republicans in key races, his outside political operation is also spending heavily on advertising, with about \$96.6 million spent since Labor Day and another \$89 million reserved through Election Day, according to data from media tracker AdImpact.

As the White House ramps up money and travel, the possibility that surveys are overrepresenting enthusiastic Democrats has emerged as a nagging worry for consultants on the left and a remaining hope for Republicans.

Some Republican strategists say they are seeing signs that the deterioration has begun to level off in certain states, even if the political environment remains difficult for the party.

"I don't see it slipping anymore," said David Kochel, an Iowa Republican political strategist who saw movement through July in the state when gas prices were weighing on consumers.

"It's kind of stabilized, and stabilized in a fairly uncomfortable place for Republicans," he said, "but I don't think it continues to move."

Isaac Arnstdorf contributed to this report.

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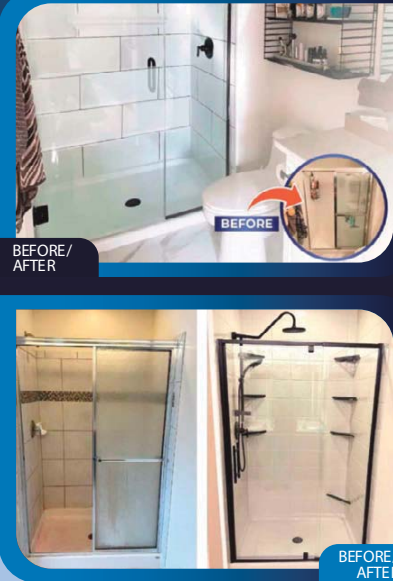
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Collins runs against Trump’s unpopularity in bid for her sixth term in Maine

COLLINS FROM A1

any member of the Maine delegation” to stop “harmful” actions by the president. She defended her more measured approach to Trump, whom she called unpopular with “terrible” numbers in her state.

“It does absolutely no good and is ineffective to go give a fiery speech to build up your social media following and to get on a popular podcast,” Collins said. “It may make you feel better ... but it doesn’t change the outcome.”

A month out from arguably her most difficult bid for reelection, the 73-year-old Collins argues that throwing her out of office due to Trump would be shortsighted, because her stature as a senior Republican allows her to do more than anyone else in Maine to push back against an administration that will only be in power for two more years.

“Although I am certainly not the president’s favorite Republican or favorite senator, by any stretch, I am able to work with members of his team in a way the rest of the delegation cannot,” she said.

Her future depends on voters buying this argument. She and Jackson are squaring off in their first televised debate Tuesday night as polls show a close race. A New York Times-Portland Press Herald survey released in September found Collins with a narrow lead, but highlighted her issues with Trump: Only 32 percent of Maine voters approve of the job the president is doing.

Anti-Collins voters regularly remark that the senator expresses concern with Trump’s actions without meaningful attempts to stop them. Several voters across the state told The Post that even though they respect and like Collins, they plan to vote against her.

“It’s not even anti-Susan Collins; it’s anti-Trump,” Bob Cravens, 72, said between sips of a Manhattan at a popular bar in Ellsworth, Maine. “I like Susan Collins. I like what she’s done in the past. I voted for her. I think she’s competent. But God could be running as a Republican and I would vote against him or her because I think this country will be destroyed if Trump has another two years unfettered.”

Polls show the most critical voters in Maine will be those who disapprove of Trump but are open to backing Collins, a sizable group.

Collins has ridden this trend to victory before. She defeated Democrat Sara Gideon by nine percentage points in 2020, even as Trump lost the state by the same margin. In Hancock County, a coastal region home to Ellsworth, Collins defeated Gideon by six percentage points, while Trump lost the county by 12 percentage points.

Doug Smith, a 76-year-old retired paper mill worker and Hancock County native, was one of those voters who backed Collins but rejected Trump in 2020. He said he won’t do it again.



Sen. Susan Collins (R-Maine) in Kittery, Maine, on Aug. 14. To win, she will need the support of voters who disapprove of the president.

“She’s done a lot for the state, but we need people in there that will bring Trump under control,” Smith said in the shadow of the paper mill he worked at, which closed in 2014. Trump has “shown himself to be who he is” during his second term in office, he said, and Collins hasn’t met the moment.

“I don’t even particularly like Troy Jackson,” Smith said, “but we need some Democrats in there that will give a little balance because the Republicans are giving him free rein.”

Jackson declined to be interviewed. But he has argued that he believes Collins thinks “we’re all stupid in this state and in this country.”

“You can’t say on one hand I’m the most powerful person, I’m the chair of appropriations, don’t replace me, we’ll never be this powerful again,” but all of these things she could have done something significant to stop she wouldn’t,” Jackson said last month.

Collins’s race in Maine may be one of the clearest tests of Trump’s effect on a candidate.

Maine relies on business and tourism from bordering Canada, which the president endangered through his ongoing trade fight. The Trump administration chose to surge aggressive Immigration and Customs Enforcement crackdown in Maine communities, bringing Collins’s votes to fund ICE to the forefront of her reelection. And while Collins has



Democratic candidate Troy Jackson in Portland, Maine, on Sept. 7.

run on her seniority as a top congressional appropriator, Trump has subverted congressional spending authority by clawing back billions in federal funding the Maine senator approved.

Collins, when asked about these issues unpopular with voters, often name-drops the conversations she has had with Trump officials, like when she

called Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin in July after an ICE agent fatally shot a 25-year-old Colombian national in Biddeford, Maine.

Republicans argue that if anyone can survive a midterm backlash to an unpopular president, it’s Collins.

“While she may have different relationships with different

presidents over the years, you can always count on Senator Collins being her own person,” said Jason Savage, a longtime Republican operative in Maine who used to run the Maine Republican Party.

And that has helped Collins win over unlikely supporters.

Beth Clark, 54, is a self-described liberal. The former social worker has never voted for Trump, and described the president as “a neo-Nazi in disguise.” And yet, Clark plans to vote for Collins this year because of the senator’s help after a teenager killed her daughter. Clark, in an act of forgiveness, wanted the young man directed to a youth diversion program that Collins supported.

“If Collins stays in, we will have the backbone that we need and the experience we need to get America out of the hole that we are in,” Clark said.

Collins’s argument for reelection hinges on constituent work like this, and her ties to the state. Collins was born and raised in Aroostook County — the same far-north place Jackson is from, affectionately known in Maine as “the county.”

One ad for her reelection shows her sitting on potatoes, the area’s most notable crop. In conversations with voters, she regularly recalls her work for local organizations and businesses.

“There are workhorses and show horses,” Collins said at a

memorial for fallen firefighters in Augusta on Saturday, “and I am a workhorse who gets things done.”

That argument has worked for Collins before. But even she acknowledged this election was different, calling it “more vicious, by far.” Collins’s house has been egged, and the doors to one of her local offices were spray-painted with an epithet tying her to Trump. Democratic-backed ads, based on a report from nonprofit newsroom ProPublica that have tied Collins to a closed FBI investigation into political corruption, have tried to undercut her image as someone solely out to help Mainers.

The FBI closed an early-stage inquiry into allegations that a defense contractor made concealed political contributions benefiting Collins in exchange for help securing federal contracts. The inquiry centers on the former head of the Hawaii-based defense contractor Navatek, who told investigators that he discussed a large political contribution with the head of a super PAC supporting Collins during her 2020 run.

Collins denies the allegations. She said that she believes Mainers know she has “served with integrity,” but admitted you “always worry when baseless lies are repeated over and over again.”

Collins has broken with the president during his second term, despite Democrats regularly citing that she has voted with him 95 percent of the time, according to CQ Roll Call’s count. After initially supporting the Iran war, Collins has joined with Democrats to restrict the president’s military power on Iran. She voted against Trump’s nomination of Pete Hegseth as defense secretary and Todd Blanche as attorney general. And while she voted for a procedural vote to advance Trump’s controversial tax and spending legislation in 2025, she eventually voted against it on final passage.

Those breaks have not gone unnoticed by Trump and his Republican base, but they highlight Collins’s predicament: holding the president’s base together while continuing to win over independents and Democrats. Collins did not attend an August event Vice President JD Vance held in Brewer, Maine, and told The Post that she doubted Trump would call her about holding a rally in Maine, something the president suggested was possible on Monday.

Keith Fischer, a 76-year-old retired fire service worker from Belgrade, Maine, has noticed how Collins has broken with Trump. He attended the firefighters’ event wearing a shirt that memorialized conservative activist Charlie Kirk.

She’s a “squishy Republican” that has “done so much for the state,” he said. He plans to vote for her, but worries that the state’s shift to the left could end her career.

“She is in a tough spot,” Fischer said.

Christa Pike is conscious and speaking after failed execution, attorneys say

Her prognosis is unclear, they say, after surviving lethal injection last week

BY BRADY DENNIS, KATIE METTLER AND MARK BERMAN

Christa Pike, who survived a botched execution attempt last week in Tennessee, is now conscious and speaking, her attorneys said Tuesday afternoon.

Tennessee officials attempted to execute Pike, 50, by lethal injection on Sept. 30, but she survived and was rushed to a hospital for lifesaving medical care. The historic failure by state officials has raised questions about Tennessee’s execution protocols and led to the resignation of the state’s prison chief.

“Her recovery is medically unprecedented,” Pike’s attorneys said in a statement. “Her prognosis remains unclear but, at a minimum, we expect a long recovery.”

Pike is still receiving “critical medical care,” said her legal team, Randy Spivey, Kelly Gleason, Stephen Ferrell and Luke Ihnen.

They renewed their call for Gov. Bill Lee (R) to commute Pike’s death sentence to life in prison without the possibility of parole. The governor denied the clemency request in the days before her scheduled execution.

A spokesperson for Lee did not immediately respond to a



Christa Pike in court on Dec. 4, 2007. “Her recovery is medically unprecedented,” Pike’s attorneys said in a statement.

request for comment Tuesday night.

A jury sentenced Pike to death decades ago for her role in killing 19-year-old Colleen Slemmer in 1995. Pike and two other teens — her boyfriend and another girl — lured Slemmer into a wooded area in Knoxville, where they beat, tortured and killed her. The teenagers knew each other through the Knoxville Job Corps, and prosecutors argued that Pike believed

Slemmer was interested in her boyfriend.

Pike admitted to hitting the girl in the head with asphalt, cutting her throat and taking a piece of her skull as a souvenir, court documents said.

Slemmer’s mother, May Martinez, traveled from Florida to witness the attempted execution last week and told NBC News afterward that she was furious with state officials. Martinez called the botched execu-

tion “a mess” and said prison officials failed to properly communicate with her about it.

It remains unclear what exactly went wrong in the Nashville execution chamber on the night Pike was scheduled to die.

A process that normally plays out in minutes dragged on for more than an hour, with witnesses saying Pike continued to move, breathe and snore even after officials intravenously administered two fatal doses of

pentobarbital.

Hours later, Lee halted executions in the state and ordered a third-party review into what happened. The incident revived questions about methods of execution nationwide.

The day after the attempted execution, Pike’s attorneys said she was on a ventilator and unconscious. They also reported in a court filing that she had arrived at a Nashville-area hospital with both arms “swollen,

burned, and blistered.”

One of Pike’s attorneys, Spivey, who was present for the attempted execution, said he saw Pike’s arm turn purple after the second dose of pentobarbital was injected, and media witnesses said they heard Pike complain about arm pain.

Medical experts had warned before the lethal injection that Pike’s small veins and a blood disorder could lead to a condition known as “IV infiltration,” when fluids leak into surrounding tissue rather than the vein itself.

Despite that, state and federal judges and the U.S. Supreme Court denied requests for alternative execution methods.

Pike’s attorneys said Tuesday that she was “still handcuffed and shackled to the bed” in the hospital, “despite the severe damage she endured to her arms” as a result of the failed execution.

In an email Tuesday, a spokeswoman for the Tennessee Department of Correction declined to elaborate on Pike’s condition.

Dorinda Carter, the spokeswoman, said Pike remained hospitalized and federal privacy laws prevented the agency “from sharing or confirming her medical information.”

Pike’s attorneys have asked a judge in Davidson County Chancery Court to order state officials to preserve all documents related to the woman’s planned execution. A hearing related to the request is scheduled for Wednesday morning.

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THE WORLD

Putin’s Europe plan: Hybrid attacks, nuclear bluster

He hopes to stymie support for Ukraine as Russia’s economy slumps

BY CATHERINE BELTON

As Ukraine’s European backers deal with myriad challenges at home — violent student protests in France, political upheaval in Germany and a mounting fuel crisis across the continent — Russian President Vladimir Putin is counting on a collapse of European support for Kyiv in the coming months, Russian and European officials and analysts say.

The Russian economy is struggling under the weight of international sanctions, and the Kremlin is laboring to cover a yawning budget deficit. But after Putin’s party secured a scripted win in parliamentary elections last month and Russian forces pounded Ukrainian schools, power plants and bridges with ballistic missiles and jet-powered drones, he has expressed no interest in dropping his maximalist demands in exchange for peace.

Instead, officials and analysts say, he appears to be proceeding on the belief that he has the advantage in a war of attrition against not only Ukraine but also Europe — which, as the Trump administration stops seeking new congressional funding for Kyiv, the Kremlin increasingly views as its main obstacle to victory.

German Chancellor Friedrich Merz on Sunday made an unexpected visit to Kyiv, where he announced \$1.5 billion in new aid to Ukraine. But his own political future is uncertain after stunning gains in regional elections by the far-right Alternative for Germany party, which opposes aid for Ukraine.

Putin, meanwhile, is working to advance Russia’s position on several fronts, Russian and European officials and analysts say.

By targeting civilian infrastructure in Kyiv, they say, he’s aiming to make the capital unlivable by winter, destabilizing the country. He’s hoping that by spring, Europe will no longer have the appetite — or the ability — to support Ukraine.

“Putin has the view that by summer the situation in Europe will change and support for Ukraine will fall away,” said Mikhail Khodorkovsky, once Russia’s richest man, now a leading opposition figure in exile in London. “This gives the Kremlin the motivation to continue its brazen attacks.”

Moscow has been escalating what European leaders have called a “hybrid war” against Europe to further undermine support for Kyiv, including, they say, online disinformation, cyberattacks and sabotage, an attempted drone attack on Germany’s Leipzig airport in August and, last week, another threat to use nuclear weapons.

“We will take the path of escalation” to deter Europe, one Russian official told The Washington Post, “as well as strikes on Ukraine to take full advantage of the lack of missile defense.” Efforts to restart peace talks were going “nowhere,” said the official, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because he wasn’t authorized to discuss the matter publicly.



German Chancellor Friedrich Merz, right, with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky on Sunday, announced \$1.5 billion in new aid.

Putin had indicated he would be ready to return to talks once the Duma elections were over. But he claimed last week that Ukrainian drone attacks over the election period Sept. 19 and 20 had derailed any possibility of a restart.

“The Russian leadership is concerned that the level of involvement of Europe in the conflict is constantly growing,” said a Russian academic close to senior diplomats, speaking on the condition of anonymity to share sensitive discussions. “And of

course Moscow would like to stop the process somehow.”

The head of foreign intelligence in Germany, Ukraine’s largest backer, warned the Bundestag, the German legislature, on Monday that Moscow was stepping up an aggressive “shadow war” against the country to undermine its support for Kyiv. “Russia is putting us to the test and closely watching how we handle this situation,” Federal Intelligence Service chief Martin Jaeger told lawmakers. “From the perspective of the Kremlin

leadership, any sign of wavering invites them to further increase the pressure on Germany. ... We have to stand up to that.”

Merz last week said Moscow’s actions were a “sign of Russia’s desperation in the face of its unsuccessful war in Ukraine.” And some analysts in Moscow say stepping up attacks on Europe and nuclear bluster is the Kremlin’s only remaining option as Russian finances come under increasing strain. “The money is running out,” said Andrei Kolesnikov, an independent political

analyst based in Moscow.

A draft federal budget for next year includes huge new tax hikes to fund an increase in spending on the Russian military to a record \$202 billion. New taxes this year have already brought economic growth to a halt.

A treasury auction was canceled last week after Russian banks, concerned the new spending is unsustainable, balked at buying state debt, undermining a key avenue for the government to cover its funding gap.

Still, the Russian official said, the economic “machine” is “holding.” As political forces with more pro-Moscow views rise in Europe, “strategic waiting and patience are also tactics, of course.”

Marine Le Pen, the leader of France’s right-wing National Rally, is leading in polls ahead of the country’s presidential election next year. Le Pen told the newspaper Le Figaro last month that deteriorating state finances meant France would no longer be able to provide as much support to Ukraine.

The French government, trying to contain spiraling borrowing costs, has proposed a budget for next year that foresees \$48 billion in cuts and tax increases. The government is facing a backlash as students across France protest underinvestment in schools and crumbling infrastructure. Twenty-four schools have been “burned or ransacked,” according to the education minister; up to 500 schools remained closed on Monday.

After Merz appeared in Kyiv on Sunday, Alternative for Germany co-leader Alice Weidel criticized the chancellor for “promising further billions in German

taxpayer money that is missing from the pension and health insurance funds, while Germany is mired in its worst energy crisis.”

“It’s all too much to fathom anymore,” she wrote. Weidel has said Germany should turn supplies of Russian gas back on.

Putin has reveled in Europe’s financial and political challenges. He told the annual Valdai gathering of international foreign policy analysts last week that European leaders’ complaints of escalating hybrid attacks were aimed at distracting attention from their own domestic woes. “Look at what’s happening with the economy,” he said. “Look at what’s happening to social policy, with the living standards of citizens of the biggest European states. In these conditions they have to ... switch the attention of their citizens from internal problems to problems of an external nature.”

Asked by a journalist whether Russia would try to dismantle the European Union, he said no effort was needed: “They will fall apart by themselves.”

Putin is counting on “crises mounting,” said Tatiana Stanovaya, a senior fellow at the Carnegie Eurasia Russia Center. “And that the current leaders who are seen as anti-Russian and inadequate just won’t be able to cope.”

Russia claimed last week it had information that NATO was preparing an “air and naval blockade” of Kaliningrad. The foreign ministry warned the Western alliance that the country was ready to respond to any attempt to isolate its Baltic exclave with “all its arsenal, including nuclear weapons.”

NATO, in response, accused Moscow of “irresponsible nuclear rhetoric.”

Russia made the threat after a British documentary series depicted a fictional war game exercise. But officials said they were also responding to recent NATO military exercises in the region and an operation in the Baltic Sea to protect underwater infrastructure.

Denmark’s defense intelligence service warned last month of “a low but growing risk that Russia will launch a limited military attack against one or several NATO countries” on its border “in the coming months.” Given Russian hybrid attacks, Belgian Defense Minister Theo Francken last week predicted “a dark winter ahead.”

French President Emmanuel Macron called an unusual meeting last month with the leaders of all the country’s political parties and security chiefs to discuss the “intensifying” threat.

The Kremlin, Stanovaya said, is operating on “the understanding that there are different forces in Europe, and that there are those who don’t want the situation to escalate to nuclear confrontation.”

Moscow’s policy on Europe has become “schizophrenic,” she said. “Putin is signaling that there is an official and unofficial line that we don’t want to go to war with Europe” while warning that “we have nuclear weapons if you will continue arming Ukraine and build around us all kinds of military infrastructure and threaten Kaliningrad and so on.”

But all Putin really wants, she said, is for Europe to become “more pragmatic” and follow the path taken by President Donald Trump.



An E.U. flag in front of the main government building in Kyiv after it was damaged in an airstrike.

DIGEST

KENYA

Ebola case linked to Congo outbreak

Kenya has confirmed its first case of Ebola from the outbreak that started in the Democratic Republic of Congo in May.

A Kenyan citizen who had been living in Congo entered Nairobi on Saturday and died Monday night at a Nairobi hospital, Kenyan Health Minister Aden Duale told reporters Tuesday. The patient fell ill about a month ago and had been treated in several hospitals in Congo before traveling by road to Kampala, Uganda, and then flying to Kenya, Duale said.

Kenya’s Health Ministry said 28 contacts, including the victim’s family and health workers exposed to him, were being traced, as were 23 passengers and four crew members on the flight.

It is not clear how he managed to travel from Congo to Uganda to Kenya while un-

well. The three countries have ramped up Ebola surveillance across their borders since May.

Kenya is the fourth country to confirm a case in the outbreak that has infected more than 8,000 people in Congo and killed more than 4,000. Uganda reported 20 cases but was declared Ebola-free in August, and there had been no active cases outside Congo since then. France had reported a case in June: a doctor who had traveled to Congo on a humanitarian mission.

— Rael Omburo

UNITED KINGDOM

Another arrest over potential attack

British police arrested a seventh suspect Tuesday in connection with a widening investigation into a suspected plot backed by Iran to attack an air base that hosts U.S. bombers.

The 22-year-old British national was taken into custo-

dy in London on suspicion of planning an act of terrorism, Counter Terrorism Policing said in a statement.

Over the weekend, Pentagon commanders abruptly evacuated a fleet of about a dozen long-range B-1 bombers from the Royal Air Force Fairford base, roughly 75 miles northwest of London, after multiple streams of intelligence warned of a possible attack, according to two people familiar with the decision and a British official, who all spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive military matters.

British Prime Minister Andy Burnham said last week “there are strong indications” that Iran was involved in the suspected plot. Tehran has denied involvement.

In late September, police detained five men in white vans outside RAF Fairford, raising concerns about the security of the U.S. bombers. Gasoline, but not explosives, was found in the vans, Counter Terrorism Polic-

ing said. U.S. and British officials suggested that Iran might have paid the suspects, but the details are unclear. A sixth suspect was later detained.

President Donald Trump told reporters Monday that the aircraft removed from the air base “didn’t fly out by accident.” He also said the U.S. knows who made the threat.

— Sammy Westfall

CANADA

Carney on Quebec separatists’ victory

Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said Tuesday that Quebec should focus on immediate economic challenges rather than wait for a possible independence referendum years from now, a day after the separatist Parti Québécois returned to power.

Carney said he would respond to the prospect of another referendum by working with Quebec through “coopera-

tive federalism” while focusing on affordable housing, economic growth, infrastructure and support for workers affected by U.S. President Donald Trump’s tariffs.

“This is a crucial time for our country. It is a crucial time for Quebec,” Carney said. “This is not a time to wait for something a few years down the road. It’s the time to act. It’s a time for boldness.”

Carney said he spoke Tuesday morning with Quebec Premier-designate Paul St-Pierre Plamondon, congratulated him, and discussed infrastructure funding and support for workers in the province affected by the U.S. trade war.

St-Pierre Plamondon has pledged to hold another referendum on Quebec independence but has said he would wait until Trump is no longer in office. He reaffirmed his separatist ambitions in his victory speech, saying he continues to envision Quebec becoming a country.

The Parti Québécois, or PQ, won 59 seats Monday, five short of the 64 needed for a majority in Quebec’s 127-member National Assembly. The minority government will need opposition support to pass key legislation and survive confidence votes. The Coalition Avenir Québec was swept out of power after eight years, failing to win a single seat.

— Associated Press

Spain’s government on Tuesday approved two housing decrees whose rejection by parliament last week prompted Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez to call a snap election. The measures — which include rent caps, a temporary ban on evictions and limits on corporate purchases of residential property — were “based on plain common sense,” Sanchez said at a news conference, arguing that opinion surveys showed the public was broadly in favor of intervention in the property market.

— From news services

Thousands have been detained, and classes are canceled for the rest of week

FRANCE FROM A1

transport workers and farmers disgruntled by cuts to public spending and some of Macron's policies.

"Today's high school and university students are tomorrow's workers. They should not have to pay the price for austerity policies," one of France's main labor unions, the CGT, said in a statement.

Though much of the student action has been relatively nonviolent, it has also descended into clashes as some protesters set dumpsters and barricades on fire or launched fireworks, while riot police unleash tear gas.

Rights groups say police are also deploying heavy-handed force with rubber bullets and batons.

More than 5,000 people have been detained in total, mostly minors, according to Interior Minister Laurent Nuñez. Nearly 300 students and school personnel have been injured, as well as hundreds of police officers, authorities said.

A teenage boy had his hand blown off in the northern town of Lens on Monday after touching a stun grenade, local media reported. Officials said they were still investigating the details.

Nuñez has described the scale of student uproar as "surprising," blaming social media and hard-left "proxies" for facilitating its spread.

It has also drawn comparisons to the Yellow Vests protests that roiled the country when tens of thousands of people, many wearing fluorescent safety vests, joined weekly rallies between 2018 and 2020.

Those started with grievances over a fuel tax, but ballooned into an uprising over social and economic inequality — and intermittently plunged into stand-offs with police.

On Tuesday, student groups estimated that about 450,000 people took part in the latest demonstrations, while the Interior Ministry put the number around 250,000. Some people held placards indicating they were parents or school staff showing support.

Education Minister Édouard Geffray said over the weekend that at least 24 schools were hit by acts of vandalism or arson.

Geffray met with students this week to convey that the government is listening to their concerns, and has called on them to allow classes to resume. Speaking Tuesday on French television, he promised the government has "already started implementing a plan of action."

French Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu said he has asked ministers to fill more teaching jobs and address dilapidated buildings.

Lecornu said Tuesday's largely peaceful marches were "met with respect" and that high school classes would be suspended for the rest of the week for consultations with students.

The turmoil is building in France ahead of a spring 2027 election that has come to symbolize the battle between Europe's mainstream political center and the rising nationalist



High school and university students in Nantes, France, participate in a nationwide day of protests and blockades.



French riot police clash with demonstrators in Paris on Tuesday.

forces on the right.

Marine Le Pen, matriarch of France's far-right National Rally, has been leading in the polls.

"Unrest on the streets and unease in the financial markets" are consuming the presidential race and shaking efforts to reassure investors, said Mujtaba Rahman, managing director for Europe at the Eurasia Group consultancy.

"The government also fears

that student anger about the state of public schools will combine with wider public fury about the high cost of fuel and create an insurrectionary atmosphere," he wrote in an analysis note.

A sell-off in French government bonds last week stoked the anxiety. France's 10-year borrowing rate climbed near 5 percent, its highest level since 2002.

The cabinet is trying to pass a new state budget for 2027 that curbs spending on some elements of the social benefits system. It is the latest effort in France, the eurozone's second-largest economy, to plug a gaping budget deficit as sovereign borrowing costs surge.

The plan includes changes to pension rules, freezing public sector wages and limiting health care costs. It is now up

for debate in a fragmented Parliament.

Even with attempts to tighten the purse strings, education remains among the costliest categories, alongside rising military spending. Debt interest costs also take up a mammoth share.

As she seeks to build credibility in her presidential campaign, Le Pen presented her own fiscal plans on Tuesday, including slashing France's contribution

to the European Union's common budget.

Politicians and campaigners across the spectrum have seized on the French student protests to their own ends.

Le Pen has joined French government officials in accusing the far-left party La France Insoumise of hijacking student sentiment and stoking violence.

Its divisive leader, Jean-Luc Mélenchon, also a candidate in the 2027 presidential election, rejects the accusation. He has supported the protests as he seeks to gain ground in the race, and some party leaders attended the marches Tuesday.

In the United States and Britain, meanwhile, anti-immigrant influencers including conspiracy theorist Alex Jones jumped on the French protests to spread claims, including based on unrelated images of disorder, that they were a manifestation of an immigrant takeover or racial strife.

President Donald Trump chimed in Tuesday, characterizing the French unrest as a result of "out of control mass migration" in a post on Truth Social, though migration and religion have not factored into the demands of protesters or the government's messaging in response.

"This is about Islam wanting to take over a once great Country!" Trump wrote.

Trump administration officials have promoted depictions of unfettered migration as Europe's main threat, irking some European leaders even as they have adopted restrictive controls.

U.S. sends formal demand to Russia for transparency on reported plague

State Department pushes Moscow about potential leak in Siberia

BY ADAM TAYLOR AND JOHN HUDSON

The Trump administration is preparing to send a formal diplomatic message to Russia requesting more information about the reported death linked to a facility in Siberia that studies pneumonic plague and a number of subsequent quarantines, according to U.S. officials.

The planned request comes amid growing U.S. frustration about the lack of detailed information from Russia after its public health agency reported that a laboratory worker employed at an institute dedicated to studying plague in the Irkutsk region had died after being diagnosed with pneumonia of "unknown" origin.

A formal message from the United States — known as a démarche in diplomatic lingo — would seek to remind Russia that it has obligations under international law to share information about disease outbreaks with other governments in a timely manner, the officials said, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive dip-

lomatic matters.

Russian authorities have imposed quarantines on several hospitals in the area, but health officials have downplayed the severity of the situation. There remains no confirmation that the deceased lab worker had contracted pneumonic plague, an airborne variant of the bubonic plague.

The planning for a formal U.S. request came as Secretary of State Marco Rubio said it was "incumbent upon Russia to obviously share more information with the world." Rubio said at a news conference in Iceland on Monday that it's "what they should do, and that's what we hope they will do."

Dmitry Peskov, a Kremlin spokesperson, told reporters Tuesday that Rospotrebnadzor, Russia's health watchdog, was "providing all necessary information" regarding the case.

The concern over the reported death coincides with broader tensions between Washington and Moscow, most significantly over Russian President Vladimir Putin's continued war in Ukraine despite repeated attempts to broker peace by President Donald Trump and his envoys. The Wall Street Journal first reported that the U.S. was planning a démarche to Russia.

Speaking to reporters on Monday, Trump said he was concerned about the reports and



This undated photo released in 2019 by the Irkutsk Anti-Plague Research Institute of Siberia and Far East shows the institute's workers in a lab.

noted that "the germs have really become relatively stronger than they were and things that used to work on pneumonia don't work as well anymore." The president also said that the U.S. was ready to help Russia with the situation.

A State Department official, speaking on the condition of anonymity to brief the media, said that health experts at the agency had been in touch with the Russian Foreign Ministry as early as Friday.

Russia is obligated to share information about potential outbreaks with the World Health Organization within 24 hours under a 2005 global health agreement known as the International Health Regulations, but

it has not done so yet, an official with that body said Tuesday.

"WHO hasn't yet received a formal notification about this through the IHR channels," WHO spokesperson Christian Lindmeier told reporters in Geneva, adding that Russia may still be making an "assessment" on whether the outbreak falls under the "notifiable categories."

The WHO is ready to support Russia if it asks, but it has not yet received Moscow's request, Lindmeier said. The WHO also assessed that the risk was "low" for Russia after the reported death and "very low" for the broader European region.

The U.S. formally withdrew from the WHO in January after Trump accused the global health body of "mishandling" the coronavirus pandemic, including early efforts to track its origin in Wuhan, China. Washington has long been the WHO's largest donor, and its departure has left the organization with a significant cash crunch.

Local officials have suggested they do not need help containing the outbreak, with Elena Sofina, a deputy mayor in the Shelekhov district in Irkutsk, stating Tuesday that 60 percent of patients had already been released from quarantine. "The situation is fully under control," Sofina said.

Lena H. Sun and Mary Ilyushina contributed to this report.

Israeli settlers beat AFP photographer covering violence in West Bank

BY SAMMY WESTFALL
AND HEIDI LEVINE

Israeli settlers attacked and fired in the direction of two Agence France-Presse journalists Tuesday as they were reporting on settler violence against Palestinian olive farmers in the West Bank, the French news agency said.

AFP photographers Jaafar Ashtiyeh and John Wessels were in the northern village of Aqraba to follow up on an incident the previous night in which several cars were burned, allegedly by settlers, AFP told The Washington Post.

The journalists were taking pictures of an Israeli soldier detaining a man when a driver on a quad bike raced toward them and opened fire, AFP reported. At least six other people also opened fire.

A Palestinian man was shot in the foot, AFP reported, citing the Palestinian Red Crescent.

The men were attacked within 500 meters of a group of Israeli soldiers, Wessel told the agency. The assailants took Ashtiyeh's camera equipment.

Ashtiyeh, a Palestinian man whom the AFP described as a veteran journalist in the West Bank, tried to escape into a car clearly marked "Press," the agency reported, but two men jumped on him and "beat him repeatedly with the butts of their rifles."

"I could hear his screams," Wessel told AFP. Wessel, too, was threatened at gunpoint, the agency reported.

Ashtiyeh, 58, was conscious Tuesday evening in a hospital at Nablus, the agency reported. He was being kept overnight for observation. He suffered severe bruising but no broken bones, AFP told The Post.

Phil Chetwynd, AFP's global news director, called for a "full investigation."

"It is unacceptable that journalists can be beaten and robbed by armed settlers in front of Israeli security forces who made no attempt to intervene," he said in a statement.

The Israel Defense Forces did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

The Foreign Press Association in Jerusalem called the attack a "blatant attempt to intimidate the press and obstruct accurate reporting from the West Bank."

"International media have a responsibility to tell all sides of the story and will not be deterred by physical assaults or threats," the association said.

Settler violence in the West Bank has risen sharply in recent months. The Israeli government has shown little interest in reining it in.

The United Nations documented more than 1,600 attacks by settlers causing injury or property damage during the first eight months of the year, an average of more than six a



Jaafar Ashtiyeh is carried by Palestinian first responders to seek medical assistance on Tuesday.

PHOTOS BY JOHN WESSELS/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

day. At least 76 Palestinians in the West Bank have been shot to death by Israeli soldiers or settlers since the start of the U.S.-Israeli war on Iran in February, the United Nations' humanitarian office reports.

Photos taken by Wessels show Ashtiyeh being carried into an ambulance on a stretcher. Other photos show Palestinian men around and on top of a tractor looking on after another man was shot and Palestinians running from gunfire.

Ashtiyeh was injured as he covered the West Bank olive harvest last year, too, AFP reported. In that incident, the agency reported, around 70 Israeli settlers attacked olive pickers and journalists with sticks and stones. Israeli soldiers present did not stop the attackers, Ashtiyeh told the agency at the time.

It was the first time in his 30-year career, he said, that he had "faced violence of this kind."

"It is unacceptable that journalists can be beaten and robbed by armed settlers in front of Israeli security forces who made no attempt to intervene."

Phil Chetwynd, AFP's global news director, in a statement



Palestinian men run away from Israeli forces that opened fire in Aqraba, West Bank, on Tuesday.

Germany arrests former intelligence chief in espionage case

BY CATHERINE BELTON
AND GREG MILLER

The former head of Germany's foreign intelligence service has been arrested on suspicion of "treasonous espionage," including seeking to hand state secrets to foreign governments, in what could be the worst security breach to roil the agency since the end of the Cold War.

August Hanning is accused of illegally acquiring nearly 2,000 documents from the top of the Bundesnachrichtendienst (BND), Germany's foreign intelligence service, via his former chief of staff at the agency, who continued to serve there. He sought to sell the information from the documents to at least one foreign state power, German prosecutors said in a statement Tuesday.

The documents included briefings prepared for the head of the foreign intelligence service for weekly security meetings at the German chancellor's office detailing major issues. "These are the crown jewels that the BND was producing," said one former senior BND official, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive matters. "It sounds really bad."

The revelations — at a time when the BND has been seeking to acquire new powers from parliament to carry out active operations to try to thwart hybrid attacks, and when it has been seeking to boost cooperation with European partners — risked undermining the agency's standing, the former official said.

Two senior German officials, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss confidential information, said there was no



MICHAEL KAPPELER/AP

August Hanning, who led Germany's foreign intelligence agency from 1998 to 2005, is accused of selling state secrets to at least one foreign government, in what could be the worst security breach to roil the agency since the end of the Cold War.

indication that the foreign intelligence service Hanning sold classified information to was Russia. Hanning did not respond to requests for comment Tuesday.

Hanning, 80, was arrested at his home in the German city of Steinfurt on Tuesday morning. His former chief of staff, whom

prosecutors identified only as Manfred D. in line with German privacy laws, was also arrested, and properties belonging to both men were searched.

Current BND chief Martin Jäger said the agency had launched extensive internal investigations. "There can be no compromises on internal security," he said.

Hanning served as BND chief from 1998 to 2005, during Gerhard Schröder's term as German chancellor, and then as state secretary in the Interior Ministry until 2009 in Chancellor Angela Merkel's cabinet. He went on to set up his own commercial consultancy company, where, according to the German magazine Der Spiegel, he built up a roster of controversial clients, including Russian businessmen and bankers.

In his capacity as a private consultant, Hanning arranged for his former chief of staff Manfred D., who continued to work in the same position for other

BND chiefs, to supply him with a steady stream of classified information in exchange for payment over a 12-year period until 2022, German prosecutors said.

Hanning had fallen on hard times after losing most of his pension following the 2019 collapse of a Latvian bank, where he served on the board, Der Spiegel reported in 2023.

German law enforcement stumbled across the alleged scheme by accident during an investigation into a separate high-profile case involving allegations a German heiress, Christina Block, had sought to abduct her children from her former husband. Hanning had served as a consultant to Block, and German prosecutors searched Hanning's residence in September 2025 in connection with that case, prosecutors said, discovering a trove of classified documents from his former workplace.

Jessica Berlin, a senior fellow at the Center for European Policy Analysis who is based in Germany, said the fact that the breach was uncovered by accident showed it was not an isolated case. "It's systemic and ongoing for decades," she wrote in a post on X. "... Anyone who thinks we've found the last breach is kidding themselves."

It's far from the first time the BND has been rocked by a spying scandal. Most recently, a department head whom prosecutors named only as Carsten L. was arrested in 2022 on suspicion of spying for Russia. He is alleged to have handed over highly sensitive documents from the BND to the Kremlin. The BND's then-leader Bruno Kahl described his activities as a "catastrophe."

ECONOMY & BUSINESS

Paramount closes deal for Warner Bros. Discovery

Companies' \$110 billion merger is official after months of wrangling

BY SCOTT NOVER
AND MIRIAM WALDVOGEL

After months of battling fellow bidders on Wall Street and state attorneys general in court, Paramount Skydance — the media conglomerate owned by tech scion David Ellison — has closed its \$110 billion merger deal with Warner Bros. Discovery, creating a new megacorporation in Hollywood, streaming and news.

The new company, called simply Skydance, will house the Paramount and Warner Bros. film and TV studios, Paramount+ and HBO Max streaming services, and news giants CNN and CBS News.

Ellison will be the company's chairman and CEO while Ynon Kreiz, formerly the top executive at Mattel, is co-CEO. The duo now helms one of the most powerful forces in American media.

CBS News will continue to be run by its editor in chief Bari Weiss — who has attracted controversy since being tapped to run the network last year. CNN CEO Mark Thompson said Monday that he is staying at the network as its chairman and editor in chief, a decision that has been seen as a sign of stability for the cable news giant.

The deal was challenged in federal court by a coalition of 12 Democratic state attorneys general led by California's Rob Bonta. The group settled out of court with Paramount Skydance last month having extracted concessions: Paramount agreed to spend at least \$300 million more per year on United States-based production and to make at least 30 movies in each of the next two years, followed by 32



Paramount Skydance CEO David Ellison at the 2025 Kennedy Center Honors. His father, Larry Ellison, is a Republican donor whose close ties to the president have fueled public speculation that the deal received favorable antitrust treatment from the Justice Department.

movies in each of the three years after that. It also vowed to establish a board of journalists to ensure the editorial independence of CNN and CBS.

In a statement, Ellison said it was a "historic day, not just for Skydance but for our entire industry." He added that his focus now is "building a company that empowers creatives, entertains audiences and rewards shareholders."

Shares of the company began trading Tuesday on the New

York Stock Exchange under the ticker symbol SKYD.

In a memo to staff obtained by The Washington Post, Ellison and Kreiz said that they chose the name Skydance for the corporate parent company but will maintain the Paramount and Warner Bros. studios, names and symbols — a mountain for Paramount, a shield for Warner Bros — that audiences have known for decades.

A bidding war

Paramount was never the intended buyer for Warner Bros. Discovery. The company chose to sell the bulk of its entities to Netflix in a deal that would have spun off cable channels including CNN. But Ellison was undeterred and waged a hostile campaign to court Warner Bros. shareholders by driving up the price of the deal. Netflix in February bowed out and Warner Bros. agreed to sell to Paramount.

To finance the acquisition,

Skydance took on a huge amount of debt — \$80 billion in total. The deal is being backed by a group that includes Ellison's father, Oracle co-founder Larry Ellison, as well as the investment firm RedBird Capital Partners and sovereign wealth funds in Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates and Qatar.

To pay off that debt, the company said Tuesday that it plans to make \$6 billion in cuts within three years.

They face a considerable chal-

lenge recouping this investment in Hollywood and the media industry. For instance, Warner Bros.' recent Tom Cruise-led film, "Digger," bombed at the box office this weekend. The movie earned just \$8 million over the weekend and could be on track to lose \$150 million.

The credit agency Fitch Ratings on Tuesday downgraded bonds issued by Skydance citing "uncertainty about the company's ability to achieve its stated synergies" and "materially higher leverage" following the merger.

Still, Skydance now controls a litany of valuable entertainment franchises including Harry Potter, Game of Thrones and Mission: Impossible that it could tap into to ease the financial strain.

David Ellison's father Larry Ellison is a Republican donor whose close ties to President Donald Trump have fueled public speculation that Paramount's deal to buy Warner Bros. received favorable antitrust treatment from the Justice Department, which approved it in June. Those ties have also intensified allegations that Weiss interfered with CBS News stories, including at "60 Minutes," to appease the Trump administration — allegations CBS has fervently denied.

The deal also puts David Ellison in charge of a news property that's angered Trump throughout his political career: CNN. Trump has repeatedly attacked and criticized the network's coverage of him and its individual journalists.

In September, Trump banned CNN, along with Politico and MS NOW, from the White House grounds, saying the outlets had spent years pushing false stories about him. The three news organizations sued in federal court and won a temporary reprieve from the ban — though Trump has still barred CNN from riding with him on Air Force One.

Markets set new records on earnings expectations

BY STAN CHOE
Associated Press

The U.S. stock market has never been higher, even though the list of challenges chipping away at it keeps growing.

The S&P 500 climbed 0.6 percent Tuesday to a record after topping its previous all-time high set in August. Despite worries about everything from war to high inflation to pressure from the bond market, the index at the heart of many 401(k) accounts has soared 23 percent since hitting a bottom in late March.

The Dow Jones Industrial Average added 253 points, or 0.5 percent, while the Nasdaq composite tacked 0.4 percent on to its own all-time high set the day before.

The record-high stock prices are helping investors feel better — or at least less bad — about their finances when Americans are generally feeling discouraged about keeping up with the

fast-rising cost of living.

Many of the fears that sent the U.S. stock market to its bottom in March have indeed come true. Oil prices are high because of the war with Iran, which has made inflation worse. Yields have cranked higher in the bond market, which threatens to slow the economy by making it more expensive for everyone to borrow money. And Americans broadly say they're feeling more pessimistic about the economy and where it's heading.

But one vital source of support has remained resolute for the U.S. stock market throughout: companies' relentless ability to make money.

All kinds of companies are lining up to report how much profit they made from July through September, and expectations are high. Delta Air Lines will report its third-quarter results on Friday, with several of the country's biggest banks headlining the following week.

Analysts expect companies in

the S&P 500 to deliver overall growth of nearly 30 percent in earnings per share from a year earlier, according to FactSet. If they're correct, it would be the third straight quarter of growth better than 25 percent.

That's crucial because corporate profits are one of the main levers that set prices for stocks, along with interest rates. At the moment, high bond yields are making investors less willing to pay high prices for investments that aren't bonds. But the simultaneous strength for corporate profits is allowing the market to stay high and "to win the tug-of-war against yields," according to strategists at Barclays.

To be sure, much hinges on companies actually meeting those expectations for fatter profits. If they fail to do so, stock prices could easily fall off their records. Some critics also point to a possible bubble in stocks in the artificial intelligence industry after how much they soared in the frenzy around the technol-

ogy.

All stocks have been a huge force driving the U.S. market to records, including Nvidia's 28.3 percent surge so far this year. That's roughly double the market's gain overall.

All told, the S&P 500 rose 44.98 points to 7,818.93. The Dow Jones Industrial Average added 253.38 to 51,521.28, and the Nasdaq composite climbed 122.48 to 27,599.79.

Bond yields offered some slack on Tuesday after falling back from their highest levels in years or even decades. The yield on the 10-year Treasury eased to 5.28 percent from 5.31 percent late Monday.

It fell after oil prices steadied themselves somewhat. The price for a barrel of Brent crude oil, the international standard, dropped to roughly \$97 in the morning before pulling back to settle at \$100.58. While that was up 0.3 percent from Monday's settlement price, it's still below the nearly \$110 it was at a few



An options trader at the New York Stock Exchange in June.

weeks ago.

In stock markets abroad, indexes ticked higher in Europe as yields continue to swing amid concerns about high govern-

ment debts and tight budgets. In France, tens of thousands of demonstrators marched in support of protests by students demanding more funding for schools.

DIGEST

ENTERTAINMENT

Emmys leave TV, move to streaming

Hollywood's annual celebration of all that is television is leaving traditional television next year to stream on Amazon Prime.

It's all part of a six-year partnership with Amazon that gives the streamer global telecast rights to the Emmy Awards ceremony, the Television Academy announced Tuesday. The Emmys will be in front of the streamer's paywall, meaning viewers can tune in without paying a fee, the academy said.

The move to streaming mirrors a broader trend, as streamers increasingly secure the rights to air live events that were once the domain of network and cable television. Platforms hope to attract new users, and the organizers of awards ceremonies hope to appeal to wider — younger, more global — audiences.

Amazon Prime airs the NFL's "Thursday Night Football" and the Academy of Country Music Awards. Netflix streams some

major NFL games, comedy roasts and the Screen Actors Guild awards; six of the top 10 new member sign-up days were because of live events, Netflix leaders said in a recent earnings call. And starting in 2029, YouTube will have exclusive global rights to stream the Oscars.

— *Elahe Izadi*

MEDIA

ABC aims to avoid early license review

A lawyer for ABC on Tuesday asked a federal judge to prevent the Trump administration from conducting an unusual early review of its broadcast licenses, likening it to a looming execution by guillotine that was already chilling the network's editorial decisions just weeks before the U.S. midterm elections.

U.S. District Judge Loren AliKhan did not immediately rule on ABC's request for a preliminary injunction prohibiting the Federal Communications Commission from conducting its early review, which ABC

said was unconstitutional, a violation of free speech and a retaliation for content President Donald Trump dislikes.

A government attorney argued that, as a procedural matter, the court doesn't have jurisdiction over ABC's case because it belongs in a different venue. The government also challenged the network's First Amendment arguments and said ABC had failed to show it suffered irreparable harm.

A ruling was not expected until at least mid-October. The judge asked the two sides to submit brief additional arguments by Oct. 9 (for the government) and Oct. 14 (for ABC).

ABC and its parent company, Disney, sued the FCC and FCC Commissioner Brendan Carr in August, several months after the commission ordered eight ABC-owned stations to submit renewal applications for their broadcast licenses years ahead of schedule.

The case is one of several ongoing legal battles between the administration and news outlets over their coverage of and access to the executive branch since Trump returned to the

White House for a second term.

— *Associated Press*

AUTOMOBILES

NHTSA to address headlight concerns

The National Highway Traffic Safety Administration said Tuesday that it will rewrite its vehicle lighting standards to address concerns about headlight glare and allow for the latest safety-improving lighting technologies.

NHTSA said it plans to improve rules for LEDs, dusk sensors, automatic high beams and replaceable light sources. The agency will also evaluate headlamps' height and aim, and how they impact driver visibility and address headlight glare, and make appropriate changes.

Complaints about glare from headlights have increased, and some lawmakers have urged the government to set a maximum headlight brightness standard. A growing number of taller trucks and SUVs on roads has also led to more complaints about glare.

LEDs, which now account for most headlights in new cars, are much brighter than traditional halogen headlights.

Headlight glare remains a factor in a small number of nighttime crashes, according to a study last year from the Insurance Institute for Highway Safety. The study noted, however, that glare contributes to far fewer crashes than insufficient visibility.

— *Reuters*

ENERGY

Google inks deal to power data centers

Google has contracted for 3,590 megawatts of power from Constellation Energy, with new nuclear energy accounting for about a quarter of that supply, the companies said Tuesday.

Constellation will make more than \$4.3 billion worth of new investments in its fleet as part of the agreement, which involves adding capacity at several of the power company's nuclear reactors in the Midwest and Mid-Atlantic regions, the companies said.

Major tech companies are racing to secure massive amounts of electricity supplies to power data centers across the U.S. by striking unprecedented power deals and reviving the country's nuclear industry.

Over the past two years, Constellation has unveiled an agreement to restart its Three Mile Island reactor in Pennsylvania to serve Microsoft data centers, while Google contracted to restart NextEra Energy's nuclear power plant in Iowa.

In the latest arrangement, Google entered into a 20-year power purchase agreement for 890 megawatts of electricity from multiple Constellation-owned nuclear power plants, which would be upgraded to produce more electricity from existing reactors.

Maryland-based Constellation is the largest U.S. nuclear power plant operator and owns a fleet of natural gas-fired power plants, as well as geothermal energy, following its acquisition of electricity producer Calpine Corp earlier this year.

— *Reuters*

Mocking victims of romance scams only keeps more people from speaking out



Michelle Singletary
THE COLOR OF MONEY

Imagine matching with a man on a dating app who claims to be a San Francisco 49ers wide receiver and a successful real estate developer from Switzerland. He shows you account balances in the millions of dollars and promises to build a prosperous future with you. You decide to check him out by Googling his name. The search results seem to confirm his story.

But then you find out it was a complete fabrication. According to a federal criminal complaint unsealed in Oregon in August, 35-year-old Daejon Labrayae Love wasn't an athlete and was not a wealthy investor.

Federal authorities allege he was a serial fraudster who, alongside an 18-year-old co-conspirator posing as his financial adviser, cheated at least 26 women in Oregon, Washington, Idaho and California out of about \$1.3 million. The FBI said in a release about the case that it believes there are many more victims, most of whom Love met through online dating apps. Their alleged schemes date back to at least February 2022.

Some of the women saved his video messages and communications. In one clip obtained by TMZ, he pulled out what he said was a key to a \$340,000 Lamborghini, holding up a ring of car keys he said were collectively worth about \$1 million.

According to prosecutors, all of the bragging — along with

displays of luxury watches, designer clothing, and claims of owning several multimillion-dollar homes — was intended to make his story believable and to convince the women that their money was safe with him because he was uber-rich.

Love currently does not have an attorney. According to a spokesperson for the U.S. attorney's office in Oregon, he remains in the custody of the U.S. Marshals Service while awaiting transport from Idaho to Portland, Oregon, for his initial court appearance, where an attorney will be appointed.

Love is charged with wire fraud and conspiracy to commit wire fraud. The 47-page complaint alleges elaborate investment schemes to defraud numerous women.

To gain their trust, the complaint says, women were shown screenshots of account balances that falsely indicated an increased value of their investments.

According to the complaint, one woman was scammed out of \$87,500, including \$30,000 paid to break a lease on a \$250,000 McLaren sports car. Love allegedly persuaded the woman to help him lease the vehicle.

Some of the women even loaned Love large sums of money, with the promise that their investment returns would more than cover the debt. When others didn't have enough cash to invest, they were coached on how to take out personal loans, according to the complaint.

I know what many of you are thinking right now: How could these women be so gullible? Having covered cons for

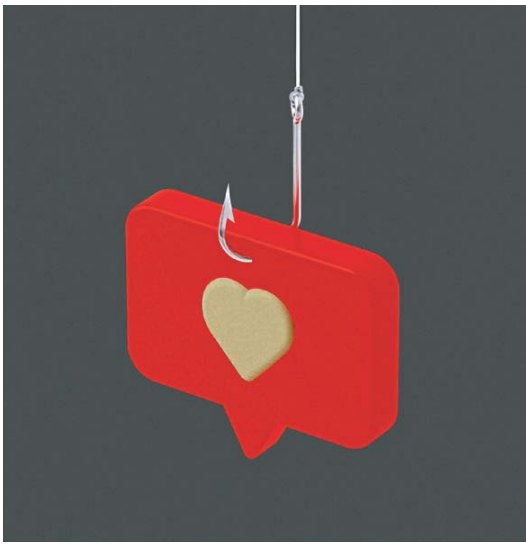


ILLUSTRATION BY CHLOE MEISTER/THE WASHINGTON POST; ISTOCK

years, I'm not surprised that much of the commentary on this case has been critical of the women.

Sports commentator Stephen A. Smith weighed in on his YouTube channel. "This unbelievable," he said. "I'm not laughing about it, because it ain't funny to know that women got swindled."

He added: "But I guess some of you are lonely, huh?"

While claiming to have "compassion," Smith, in his typically animated fashion, pointed out, like a Monday-morning quarterback, that he would have noticed that Love's workout videos

weren't credible.

"Clearly, there are a lot of you women out there who don't watch football," he said. "Because, if you watch football, it ain't hard to see that brother was no NFL player. If you watch the videos that he put out there with him working out, it's real easy to see he ain't an NFL player."

Social media comment sections were even harsher.

On Instagram, one user reacted to a video of Love catching a football on the beach in a 49ers helmet: "The fact he took that helmet everywhere was the first [flag]. I laughed 10 minutes

straight when I saw the videos. Women, if you fell for that, please seek counseling."

On Reddit, another commenter posted: "No offense to the women who are hurting, but I literally cannot fathom how this could happen to you in 2026."

When someone opens a sentence with "no offense," an insult invariably follows. These knee-jerk comments mocking women who say they have been scammed are cruel and fail to recognize how insidious such schemes can be.

According to the FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center, reported losses in 2025 to confidence and romance scams surged to more than \$929 million, up from \$672 million in 2024.

Romance scams succeed because predators systematically manipulate people's emotions. Consider the psychological and technical traps Love is accused of using.

He convinced the women that they could build a life together.

"Love convinced many of his victims that they were in sincere romantic relationships with him and that he was financially savvy and successful to gain their trust," the complaint said.

The FBI said he created a fake digital footprint.

Investigators noted that searches for Love's name in early 2026 returned results and AI summaries that sometimes incorrectly identified him as a 49ers player.

Scammers use apps and AI to create fake documents that look incredibly authentic. In one video sent to a woman, Love allegedly showed a statement

indicating that he had an account balance of more than \$30 million, the FBI said.

I've reported on financial fraud for years, and if there is one universal truth, it's this: Even the most cautious, analytical people can be conned when trust and affection are weaponized against them.

Federal law enforcement agencies, including the FBI and the Federal Trade Commission, stress that official figures represent only a fraction of actual losses. Because of shame, fear of judgment and the emotional trauma caused by these cons, law enforcement estimates that many victims never report being cheated.

The relentless public ridicule of scam victims exacerbates the problem. Shaming keeps them silent.

On this point, Smith is correct. Romance scams are no laughing matter.

Here's advice I've given before that I hope you will share.

If you or a loved one has been scammed, call the AARP Fraud Watch Network helpline at 877-908-3360 or go online at aarp.org/fraudhelpline.

The AARP Fraud Victim Support Group provides an online forum for scam victims. Group sessions are confidential and led by trained facilitators. They are also open to friends and family; go to aarp.org/fraudsupport.

Coming forward can be difficult if you have been victimized, but it's important to notify law enforcement. File a complaint with the Federal Trade Commission at ReportFraud.ftc.gov and the FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center at ic3.gov.



ANNA MONEYMAKER/REUTERS

After speaking to Iowa gubernatorial hopeful Zach Lahn last month, Vice President JD Vance started making calls about "dyed diesel."

Why Vance took on diesel pain ahead of midterms

Iowa candidate's fuel suggestion piqued the vice president's interest

BY NATALIE ALLISON AND KATHERINE DOYLE

COUNCIL BLUFFS, IOWA — When Vice President JD Vance flew into this deep-red corner of a rural state, the soaring price of fuel was already increasing concern about Republican turnout in November.

The Republican Senate candidate, locked in a neck-and-neck race, didn't come to the rally. Two of Iowa's four Republican House members, both in their own worrying reelection fights, had just broken with the president to vote to stop the war with Iran. But Zach Lahn, the GOP nominee for governor who is trailing his Democratic opponent, was there to campaign with Vance's support — and to make a plea.

Backstage, according to three people with knowledge of the conversation, Vance asked Lahn what the administration could do to help farmers, whose discontent with high fuel prices and poor market conditions has weighed down Republican chances across the Midwest. Lahn had an answer ready: Provide some relief from diesel costs by allowing farmers driving up and down the roads during harvest to take advantage of tax-exempt diesel intended only for off-road use on farms and construction sites. The three people spoke on the condition of anonymity to report on private conversations.

It was a wonky policy request involving so-called "dyed diesel" — a little-known topic outside the agriculture and energy communities. Vance told Lahn it was an "interesting idea."

Back in his armored SUV heading to the Omaha airport,

Vance asked his longtime adviser, Luke Thompson — now also working on Lahn's campaign — to see what was feasible. Vance started making his own calls, lingering on the phone for several minutes before exiting the vehicle to board Air Force Two.

Just over two weeks later, President Donald Trump on Monday night signed an executive order putting the policy into effect, doing so on stage at a rally in Nebraska, another rural state his party is trying to shore up ahead of November's midterm elections.

"Today, I'm announcing another unprecedented step to bring down costs," Trump said, before signing the executive order, displaying his signature to the crowd of supporters.

"We're not going to need it long," he added, saying, as he has for several months, that prices would soon "plummet" because the Iran war will end.

The scramble to change the tax treatment of diesel fuel was the latest instance of Vance trying to play his own part in mitigating anticipated GOP losses at a time the president's approval rating is at an all-time low. As he has traveled the country, the vice president has touted the administration's policies while repeatedly acknowledging that work still has to be done to address voters' economic pain.

Trump has largely dismissed concerns about the cost of living and fuel, insisting that the economy is booming — based on financial markets — and framing Americans' disapproval as merely a matter of poor "public relations" by the White House.

In Nebraska, where he campaigned for the state's incumbent Republican Sen. Pete Ricketts, Trump repeated that the current run-up in fuel prices was a "very small price to pay" to prevent Iran from obtaining a nuclear weapon.

The average price of diesel in the Midwest was \$6.53 per gal-

lon last month, up \$2.80 from a year ago, according to federal statistics.

Trump also repeated his exhortation for his supporters to "pretend I'm on the ballot" and warned that "the fake news media is trying to demoralize Republican voters with rigged polls."

But the fact that Trump visited such a heavily Republican state within a month of the midterms illustrates how much economic woes — including high diesel costs — have hurt his party.

Ricketts, a former two-term governor of the state, faces a competitive challenge from Dan Osborn, a labor organizer endorsed by Democrats who is running as an independent. Osborne's campaign has been boosted by the same economic concerns that have helped Democrats across the Midwest, although the Nebraska race does not appear as close as the contests in Iowa or neighboring Kansas.

Those cost concerns, especially as they apply to farmers, have had administration officials scrambling to find policies to bring prices down.

As part of that search, Agriculture Secretary Brooke Rollins, who throughout the year has been on the receiving end of appeals from farmers seeking help, had been kicking around the concept of tax relief for dyed diesel, but the vice president's intervention expedited the process.

"Any time the vice president of the United States wants to get involved in the weeds of dyed diesel, that is much, much appreciated," Rollins said.

Vance spoke with Cabinet members, and the vice president's staff scurried to get buy-in from Energy Secretary Chris Wright, Interior Secretary Doug Burgum, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and top White House officials.

Dyed diesel gets its name from coloration put in to allow enforcement agents to easily de-

tect misuse of tax-exempt fuel by truckers on the nation's highways. Tax-exempt fuel is intended only for off-road use. Most revenue from fuel taxes goes into the federal government's Highway Trust Fund, which finances road construction and repair projects.

The administration can't waive taxes on diesel without congressional authorization. Instead, under Trump's order, federal officials will simply not enforce the tax requirement through the end of the year. States, which also collect diesel taxes, can still choose to enforce the tax rules.

The administration hopes the move will lower costs for farmers driving on highways to transport their crops to mills and production facilities during the current harvest season.

Because federal enforcement will be paused for everyone, truck drivers and others traveling on highways who have access to dyed diesel, which is limited in availability at truck stops, would also be able to use the tax-free fuel.

In recent weeks, 10 states — nine led by Republican governors, plus North Carolina — have liberalized use of dyed diesel, according to ClearView Energy Partners, a D.C.-based research firm. Administration officials hope that other states will now follow suit.

Agriculture Department projections estimate that farmers could save \$640 million on federal and state diesel taxes combined during the current harvest season, based on each farmer driving 150 miles. The White House estimates truck drivers using dyed diesel could save \$129 per refill, according to a person with knowledge of the policy.

Doyle reported from Grand Island, Nebraska. Allison reported from Council Bluffs, Iowa, and Washington, D.C.

Trump steers nearly \$7B to shipbuilding in deal with Anduril

BY PRANSHU VERMA, DAN DIAMOND AND ERIN COX

SPARROWS POINT, MD. — President Donald Trump on Tuesday announced a nearly \$7 billion deal with a defense firm founded by one of his most prominent political supporters to expedite submarine shipbuilding, an unexpected arrangement that thrusts a largely autonomous-weapons company into a more traditional defense manufacturing role.

During an address at the industrial hub in Sparrows Point in Maryland, Trump said the new project with Anduril Industries will transform the Baltimore-area port site into "one of the most significant shipyards" in the world.

"Right here in Sparrows Point, you'll build the next generation of American submarines, including autonomous subs, torpedo tubes, and critical components for our cutting-edge Virginia-class attack submarines — the greatest and quietest ever built," Trump said.

The deal is backed by a \$3.7 billion investment from Anduril coupled with a \$2.9 billion U.S. Navy contract, Trump added. He also said that U.S. taxpayers "will receive a 40 percent stake in the new shipyard," without providing specifics of the potential equity arrangement.

Anduril was founded by the prominent Trump supporter and billionaire Palmer Luckey. It holds billions in Defense Department contracts to provide AI software services to the military, and Luckey was named alongside Elon Musk last week as a key member of a Pentagon project tasked with planning for the future of warfighting.

Trump's announcement serves as potential boon to Maryland's economy and could bring thousands of jobs to the Baltimore area. Wes Moore, the state's Democratic governor and a prominent critic of the Trump administration, said he was slated to speak at the event but the administration blocked him from speaking.

The Sparrows Point project, called Arsenal-2, marks a departure for Anduril, a weapons technology company known for making autonomous drones and unmanned sea vehicles. The manufacturing initiative places it in a more traditional defense contracting role, creating components for manned Virginia-class nuclear submarines, which have faced significant production delays for years. They are crucial component to the U.S. military's strategy for competing against China in the Indo-Pacific region.

"It is unusual," said Stacie Pettyjohn, director of the defense program at the Center for a New

American Security, a bipartisan national security think tank. It will be interesting to see if Anduril, which is known for making simple weapons quickly, can work on large nuclear submarines, the "most complicated ones that exist," she added.

The Pentagon has been plagued with delays in building nuclear submarines for years. Coronavirus-induced employment shortages, maintenance backlogs and supply chain issues have left domestic submarine shipbuilders delivering roughly 1.1 new Virginia-class nuclear submarines a year, less than the military's annual goal of two, according to a Congressional Research Service report from January.

The U.S. has also agreed to provide Australia — through the trilateral AUKUS partnership that also includes the United Kingdom — with several Virginia-class nuclear submarines, increasing its supply requirements.

The Sparrows Point project is aimed at reducing the backlog, and it has the potential to transform an industrial peninsula outside Baltimore, whose economic fortunes were crippled with the financial collapse of Bethlehem Steel two decades ago.

Sparrows Point was once a home to a thriving blue-collar manufacturing hub anchored by Bethlehem Steel, which was one of the world's largest shipbuilders and also had a steel mill at the site. At its peak in the middle of the last century, it employed roughly 30,000 people.

Now, the site hosts logistics and fulfillment centers for Amazon, Under Armour and Home Depot, and it recently served as a cleanup hub after the Francis Scott Key Bridge collapse. Roughly 14,000 people work at the Tradeport Atlantic site. (Amazon Executive Chairman Jeff Bezos owns The Washington Post.)

As manufacturing jobs moved overseas, the Baltimore region endured the same erosion that hollowed out manufacturing towns across the country, and the steel mill eventually shuttered in 2012.

In 2014, a group of investors purchased the site for redevelopment and renamed it Tradeport Atlantic.

Moore, the governor, said in a call to reporters that the state and Baltimore County could provide up to 13 percent of the project's \$3.7 billion in private investment in matching funds, and that the project could create 3,100 permanent jobs.

"This massive new project will deliver the largest private investment, drive billions of dollars in economic activity, and create the most jobs in Maryland in history," he said in a statement.

OPINION

This 19th-century novelist might be the best economist you’ve never heard of

BY JULIA R. CARTWRIGHT

In opulent London salons at the turn of the 19th century, economists including David Ricardo and Thomas Malthus debated trade, famine and the fate of the poor. Among them was Maria Edgeworth, an erudite woman who helped shape how the emerging field of economics reached the wider world. In an intellectual world that offered women few conventional avenues into the discipline, she wrote it into novels, weaving lessons of political economy into the tales of captivating characters.

She arguably reached far more people with her economic ideas than her male counterparts because she translated the otherwise daunting language of thinkers such as Adam Smith into something much more accessible. Maria Edgeworth (1768-1849) is the economist most people have never heard of.

The book “The Invisible Hand of Maria Edgeworth” is about her: how she went from a celebrated literary figure to someone relegated to a footnote in the field of economics. Its author, Jeanna Smialek, a New York Times reporter who spent years translating the Federal Reserve for ordinary readers, is a fitting biographer for a woman who did the same for Adam Smith. Histories of economics usually feature its fathers, whom Smialek keeps as main characters, but the author focuses on the woman standing beside them who believed economics belonged to everyone.

Edgeworth’s story begins with a longing for affection. Her mother died when she was 5, and her father, the restless inventor Richard Lovell Edgeworth, remarried within months. The young girl turned rebellious and was sent away to boarding school, where she felt abandoned. Desperate to return to her father’s good graces, she discovered that writing could win back his affection, and the same gift soon made her the storyteller among her classmates.

The affection she had worked so hard to win returned when he finally pulled her out of school. Maria returned to the family estate in Ireland and rode alongside her father as he collected rent from his tenants. Richard Lovell shortened leases, rewarded tenants who improved their land and, following Smith, paid higher wages on the theory that



WASHINGTON POST STAFF ILLUSTRATION; ISTOCK

better pay was good for everyone. He also required his daughter to study “The Wealth of Nations,” among other works, to prepare her to help manage the estate. Between the book and the rides, Maria gained an inside view of the lives of the poor, an experience few ladies of her upbringing ever had.

As a young woman, Edgeworth wrote children’s tales and books on education, and in 1800, she published the novel “Castle Rackrent,” a sensation. At her height, she outsold Jane Austen. Smialek writes that “readers were coming to Edgeworth books for dry quips, rollicking plots, and haphazard love stories, yet they were leaving them with an understanding of tenant-landlord relationships and the benefits of educating workers.” King George III reportedly said that after reading her work, he knew his Irish subjects better.

All of this unfolded in an age of tumult. The French Revolution in 1789-99 and the Reign of Ter-

ror in 1793-94 shook Europe, and the Irish rebellion of 1798 came so close to home that local loyalists, suspicious of Richard Lovell’s political sympathies, nearly lynched him. At 34, in 1802, Edgeworth traveled to Paris, where she discovered how famous she had become and turned down a proposal from a Swedish courtier, a decision that ended up leaving her heartbroken.

Her influence and knack for writing about economics for a general audience earned her respect in the field and a place in the rooms where economics was being invented. She befriended Ricardo and followed his sparring with Malthus over trade. She read and critiqued the work of Jane Marcet, whose 1816 “Conversations on Political Economy” became one of the earliest and most influential popular economics textbooks. Where Marcet spoke plainly about economics, Edgeworth hid it in narrative. Together, they helped pave the way for a generation of

women to write about the subject.

In her 50s and 60s, as critics soured on her fiction, she remade herself as a political observer and unofficial economic adviser. The Great Famine, which began in 1845, underscored the limits of simple economic prescriptions: As blight destroyed the potato crop, grain and livestock kept leaving Ireland for export, sold to buyers who could pay. The poor had little money to buy food, and markets alone had trouble reaching them. Edgeworth spent her last years working to relieve the starving poor around her.

Her sex was surely a limitation, as “academic women were viewed as subversive, even dangerous,” Smialek writes — but it was also a strength. Largely shut out of the emerging professional world of economics, Edgeworth wrote stories, and they traveled where treatises never could. One could argue that confinement to the novel cost her a place in the canon, but Smialek makes the more interesting case that it is precisely why she mattered: “Maria’s lessons reached every corner of the empire” as “readers across the English-speaking world were exposed to whatever lessons she chose to tuck into her fictional pages: social commentary, ruminations on rent, ideas for improving the lot of the poor.”

Which leaves the question Smialek cannot stop asking: If she was so influential, “why do we hardly know her name?” The cruelest irony is that her name survives in every economics classroom through the Edgeworth box, named for her nephew Frances Ysidro Edgeworth. But Maria, who carried the ideas out of the salon and into the parlor, slipped away.

Return to those rooms where Ricardo, Malthus and other famous men argued over the pressing economic challenges of their time. The diminutive woman among them was part of the exchange, questioning, debating and advancing ideas alongside them. Maria Edgeworth’s name may have faded, but her legacy shaped the field of economics, bringing the dismal science into the lives of ordinary readers.

Julia R. Cartwright is a senior research fellow in economics and law at the American Institute for Economic Research.

The 9/11 generation of warriors deserves the nation’s respect and gratitude

BY MARTHA RADDATZ

On Oct. 7, 2001, the United States and allies went to war in Afghanistan, where the al-Qaeda terrorists who had plotted the 9/11 attacks were harbored. With the 25th anniversary of the war’s start, my mind turns to Joshua Webster — 21 years old at the time, a 6-foot-4 Californian from a middle-class Catholic family. He had enlisted in the military in 1999 to help pay for college.

He graduated two years later from Army Ranger School at Fort Benning, Georgia. On Sept. 11, 2001, Webster and his fellow Rangers awakened early, still sore from having completed a final, grueling three-month field test. Eager to share his news with his family, Webster stood in line at the only pay phone and, just after 9 a.m., got through to his mother. But she had bigger news for him — two planes had just hit the World Trade Center. Word spread quickly among the Rangers, who huddled around a radio someone had managed to find.

Like just about everyone else across the country, the soldiers spent that morning in shock. But unlike the rest of the country, they were sure of one thing: They were going to war.

And they did — many of them for several de-

ployments. The wars that started that day in Afghanistan spread to Iraq and Syria and went on for years. Forever wars seemed to mean forever service.

In fact, Josh Webster would spend 20 years in the military; he retired in August, five years after American troops abruptly pulled out of Afghanistan, leaving Kabul in the hands of the Taliban. His career took him from the Army Rangers to Air Force pararescue, and back to the Army as an officer. In Afghanistan and Iraq, he risked his life time and again to save those who had been wounded in combat. He also managed to squeeze in that college degree — a bachelor’s from UCLA.

I met Webster in 2011 on a pararescue helicopter in the mountains of Afghanistan. He told me about saving an Army captain who had been shot in the head by the Taliban and fallen into a ravine during fierce fighting. Both he and the wounded captain, Webster said, were among those whose lives had been transformed by 9/11.

The attacks that day spiked recruitment in all branches of the military, and made those already in the service more eager to stay. As the wars went on, the plans and lives of all Americans who had signed up or extended their tours were completely upended. In too many cases, the challenges and nightmares of their deployments extended into

their years as veterans.

In 1980, 18 percent of U.S. adults were veterans; by 2022, that figure had dropped to about 6 percent. Many Americans today, especially those with college degrees, don’t know anyone on active duty. The years of “Thank you for your service” are long gone. As a nation, we are woefully disconnected from the men and women who have fought and are fighting our wars.

The service members who deployed after 9/11 knew the value of the press and largely welcomed the coverage. Respect for the First Amendment was fully ingrained as journalists embedded with their units to report on their triumphs, tragedies and, when warranted, their mistakes as well.

With a Pentagon that now resists coverage and brands the press as treasonous, the stories from this latest war and the human faces of the military are largely lost or overrun by debate. The men and women who serve are far too often lumped in with the politics and policymakers. They should not be.

Our service members are not making policy. They are not sending us to war. They took an oath to defend the U.S. Constitution, and to obey the orders of the U.S. president and their officers. They are part of the 9/11 generation of warriors, and I have been privileged through my work to know many of them.

The troops of the “Greatest Generation” fought the one war in our history that had near-unanimous approval from the American people. But we should honor the veterans of Fallujah and Tora Bora as much as we have honored those who fought at Normandy and Iwo Jima. This generation of warriors, like the one that fought in Korea, is no less great.

Yes, World War II had a moral clarity that other wars have not had. But the warriors of all our conflicts have shown courage, commitment, and patriotism.

They hold their love of country so dear that they are willing to fight and to die for it.

These people deserve our respect and gratitude, and maybe they will remind us that we all can do better — if we think in terms of our own “missions,” the small and large ways we might work to better our communities, our fellow citizens and our country. As our nation marks 25 years since America fought back against a massive terrorist attack, that lofty ambition seems a good way to go.

Martha Raddatz, the chief global affairs correspondent for ABC News and co-anchor of “This Week With George Stephanopoulos,” is the author of “The Hero Next Door: Stories of Patriotism and Purpose.”

The data center boom will shrink. That’s good news.

BY TODD G. BUCHHOLZ

In 1946, ENIAC — an ancestor of today’s computers — weighed 30 tons, could fill a house and gulped 140 kilowatts just to add numbers faster than a bookkeeper. Today, the phone in your pocket can translate ancient Greek, recognize your face, fly a drone and remind you that Rocky Marciano defeated Joe Louis in the eighth round in 1951. NASA would have been delighted with the first three.

Keep that history in mind as technology companies race to build data centers — the windowless warehouses stuffed with chips, cooling systems and enough electrical gear to shock Nikola Tesla. As politicians from both parties fight over whether to oppose these developments, investors and engineers should wrestle with a different question: What will a data center look like in 10 or 20 years, and what exactly is worth owning?

Gordon Moore supplied an answer 60 years ago. The Intel co-founder observed that the number of components that fit on a chip rises exponentially. Experts have pronounced Moore’s Law dead almost as often as humanities professors have pronounced capitalism dead. Both keep outliving their obituaries. The precise engineering has changed — chips are stacked, cooling improves, software gets leaner — but the direction remains stubborn: We extract more computing from less.

Computing has migrated from a room to a desk-top to a laptop and then to a phone. Now it lives in wristwatches, earbuds, doorbells and even devices not suitable for mention in a family newspaper. Why assume the data center has reached its final physical form?

In Ohio, a SoftBank-backed campus is rising, with commitments from OpenAI and Nvidia, hundreds of billions of dollars in long-term contracts and plans for 10 gigawatts of power. (The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI.) Investors and communities locking in 20- and 30-year commitments should ask a sharp question: How much land, electricity and equipment will be required to produce a unit of intelligence?

That number will probably keep falling as com-



ILLUSTRATION BY CLARE RAMIREZ/THE WASHINGTON POST; ISTOCK

puting migrates into smaller devices. Your car should not need to consult a 500,000-square-foot warehouse in Kansas before swerving around a pothole.

There is a catch, which a 19th-century English economist spotted long before anyone had heard of Bluetooth. William Stanley Jevons noticed that more-efficient steam engines did not reduce Britain’s coal consumption. Because cheaper steam power created more uses for it, Britain needed more coal, not less.

Artificial intelligence could spark a powerful Jevons effect. If intelligence is 10 times cheaper, entrepreneurs may devise 20 times as many uses

for it. Hospitals, tractors and household appliances will grow smarter. At some late-night hour, your refrigerator may develop strong opinions about your cholesterol and refuse to surrender the Häagen-Dazs.

Two apparently contradictory things can therefore happen at once: The world can consume vastly more computing while requiring less infrastructure for each computing unit.

That’s why communities should welcome new investment but insist that developers pay the costs of power, water and grid upgrades. They should be especially skeptical of subsidies that assume today’s physical footprint will last for decades.

Done correctly, these investments could end up benefiting nearby residents. A June study by the Electric Power Research Institute estimated that data center growth between 2015 and 2024 modestly reduced U.S. residential electricity prices because large, steady customers spread fixed grid costs across more kilowatt-hours. Of course, if utilities choose to build for a giant new customer and then stick households with the bill, families will pay more. That is not a law of computing; it is a bad contract.

Investors face a different question: What survives when the technology inside the building improves and the building itself begins to resemble a giant box stuffed with fast-aging silicon? Some data centers might start to resemble dreary indoor shopping malls in the internet age — expensive shells hoping for another use, like an indoor skating rink or pickleball courts.

But remember: Although railroads made horses less valuable, rights of way held their value. A site with contracted power, transmission access and fiber-optic cables has something far harder to replace than chips: a place at the front of the line to connect to the electrical grid. Securing that access can take years, but data centers might one day serve as a shortcut. The building is just a box; the more valuable asset may be the right to plug in.

America should build data centers along with more energy capacity. AI may prove as transformative as its evangelists claim, and starving it of infrastructure would be foolish, especially as China plows ahead. But it would be equally foolish to draw a ruler from today’s acres, megawatts and cooling towers straight through to 2050.

In 1946, a computer took up the size of a house. Now, it fits in the palm of one’s hand. Don’t bet that the house has won.

Todd G. Buchholz, a former White House director of economic policy and managing director of the hedge fund Tiger Management, is the author of “The Price of Prosperity: Why Rich Nations Fail and How to Renew Them.”

Superintelligent is a weekly newsletter on AI. Sign up at wapo.st/superintelligent

OPINION

The Washington Post

AN INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER



British Prime Minister Andy Burnham speaks at the Labour Party conference in Liverpool on Sept. 29.

EDITORIALS

More government won't fix Britain

THE “NEW PATH” proposed by British Prime Minister Andy Burnham in his debut speech at the Labour Party’s annual conference last week sounds a lot like the one that led the United Kingdom into prolonged stagnation.

The U.K. economy, which grew just 1.2 percent last year, desperately needs to be unleashed. Despite paying lip service to this, Burnham dedicated his much-anticipated speech to visions of a bigger government, more public ownership and more spending on entitlements that Britain cannot afford.

“This country isn’t where any of us would want it to be,” Burnham told his party. The former mayor of Greater Manchester, who replaced Keir Starmer as prime minister in July, pledged that under his leadership the party would “draw a line on a decade of division” and “stop doomscrolling on posts running Britain down.”

Britain is already down. Borrowing costs hit their highest levels since 1998 on Thursday, when 30-year gilt yields tipped over 6 percent. The government has little room to maneuver.

It’s a positive sign that Burnham wants to end the unsustainable “triple lock” on state pensions. The policy increases payments by either the rate of inflation, average wage increases or 2.5 percent, whichever is highest.

Six prime ministers in 10 years promised more spending would fix Britain. Andy Burnham just became the seventh.

But he proposed ending the triple lock as a way to pay for creating a universal social care program. Burnham said he wants something “as significant as the creation” of the National Health Service itself, but details of what he envisions were scant. The barest-bones version of a social care system, which might provide assistance with daily living, aging care and disability support, would annually cost an estimated 7.5 billion pounds (\$9.93 billion), though the amount would probably be far more.

Meanwhile, the NHS is beset by long waiting lists, staff shortages, delayed access to basic care, deteriorating infrastructure and growing demand. The NHS accounts for nearly 40 percent of day-to-day public spending. Why create a new entitlement when the one Burnham wants to model it on is so badly broken?

On public ownership, Burnham announced a plan to change the law so that the government could control water

companies. The state-run energy company set up by Starmer would also gain more access to the country’s energy grid.

Conservative prime ministers of recent vintage had their own attractions to Big Government: Boris Johnson sped up the process of rail renationalization, Liz Truss tried to implement energy price controls, and Rishi Sunak ushered in a generational smoking ban. In Truss’s case, it led to a market meltdown.

If Burnham isn’t worried that markets could be similarly spooked by his ideological fever dream, he should be. Britain spent almost twice as much on debt service as on defense in the past fiscal year. Rising borrowing costs make Burnham’s “new path” even less realistic.

Luckily, if you can call it that, Britain is tied to the Labour Party’s 2024 manifesto, because that’s what the party ran on when it won power. Departing from it to pursue much of what Burnham floated at the party conference would require a new mandate. That would entail calling a general election, which Burnham has said he won’t do until at least 2029.

Britain is now on its seventh prime minister in the past 10 years. All promised to put the nation on a better path. None meaningfully succeeded. If Burnham is to be different, he’s going to need a better plan.

Small nuclear reactors reach a big milestone

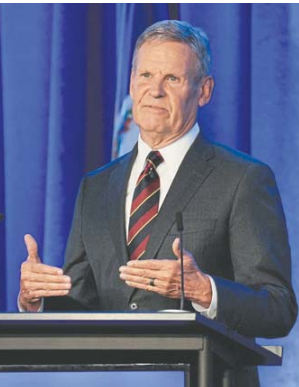
WILL NUCLEAR POWER be able to scale up quickly enough to meet America’s energy needs? That’s one of the most pressing challenges for the industry, and there’s no guarantee of success. One major milestone last week, however, offers hope.

The Nuclear Regulatory Commission granted a construction permit for a small modular reactor near Knoxville, Tennessee. The approval means the commission determined that the reactor’s design is safe and that its operator — the Tennessee Valley Authority, a public utility — can begin building, though the TVA would still need an operating license to start generating power.

This marks the first time the NRC has given the green light for a commercial small modular reactor, which, if successful, could usher in a new era for nuclear power. Unlike the hulking traditional reactors of the past, which rely on large-scale energy generation to make sense financially, this new technology goes in the opposite direction: It attempts to shrink the technology, providing less energy per reactor but using a design that doesn’t take so much space and can be replicated more easily.

The TVA project is projected to generate 300 megawatts, enough to power 240,000 homes. That’s about a quarter of the power produced by America’s most recently built nuclear reactors in Georgia. A government-owned utility in Canada is planning a fleet of reactors using the same design, which it began constructing in April.

The technology could help scale advanced nuclear power to meet America’s energy needs.



CAITIE MCMEKIN/NEWS SENTINEL/USA TODAY NETWORK VIA REUTERS CONNECT

Tennessee Gov. Bill Lee (R) holds a news conference on Sept. 29 regarding a construction permit for a small modular nuclear reactor in his state.

Several obstacles remain: TVA, though it has authorized \$350 million for the project, is still negotiating with partners on cost-sharing and has not

committed to breaking ground. Costs for the first reactor are also likely to be high, though the hope is for them to fall as the utility works out the kinks and builds additional generation capacity.

This project is the furthest along, but about a dozen companies are developing their own smaller reactor designs, often with investments from large tech companies looking to power the artificial intelligence boom. One of them is Amazon, whose executive chairman, Jeff Bezos, owns The Post.

The enthusiasm about modular reactors reflects increasingly bipartisan support for nuclear energy. A decade ago, investing in the technology was risky, since it takes years to develop and therefore needs sustained support across administrations. Now, majorities in both parties understand the need for expanding nuclear power, so much so that Congress overwhelmingly passed reforms to speed up the onerous review process for new reactors.

The NRC managed to issue the construction permit for TVA in 14 months, four months faster than anticipated. That’s the second time the notoriously lethargic agency shocked developers with its speedy review of an advanced reactor. The first, for TerraPower’s proposed plant in Wyoming, was completed nine months ahead of schedule.

Those are encouraging signs of a possible nuclear renaissance — or, at the very least, they’re indications that the industry will succeed or fail based on economic merits, not ideological grounds.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

As a veterinarian, I can’t stand botched executions

Regarding the Oct. 5 news article “Pike remains in critical condition, on ventilator”:

I’m a veterinarian, and I find it unconscionable that the United States abides the death penalty but so regularly bungles the execution. I personally do not support the death penalty, but I believe that if an institution or judicial system elects to utilize death as a form of justice, then it is incumbent on that system to be able to perform the procedure painlessly and reliably.

One of my most important functions is to provide a safe, peaceful and ethical end of life for all species of animals. This is not a complicated procedure, and the administration of a lethal dose of pentobarbital is commonly used for humane euthanasia in dogs.

It is the legal obligation of any health care worker to deliver medication safely, within the permissible routes of administration of the agent, and to cause no unnecessary suffering. The decision to forcibly end a life is a serious one that deserves to be done correctly. If we will not reconsider the ethics of the death penalty, then either the drug and safety protocols used for judicially mandated death need review or there needs to be more training and oversight of the staff performing the procedure.

If cost of appropriate staffing and training is a concern, then making funds available should be of paramount importance to the institutions utilizing this procedure. The cost of training and appropriate staffing is nothing compared with the moral and ethical cost of taking a life — even if that life is an inmate’s.

Kate Hartzler, Toronto

Tennessee’s latest execution disaster exposes an inherent contradiction in execution using lethal injection. The state relies on medical expertise to take a life, yet major medical, nursing and pharmacy professional organizations oppose their members’ participation in executions. Many pharmaceutical companies also object to states using their medicines for executions.

Even if Tennessee were to revise its lethal injection protocol, it would still violate a fundamental moral principle: Individuals have no right to take another person’s life except in self-defense or to protect others from an imminent threat.

The state also frequently makes mistakes. On Sept. 28, Utah released Douglas Carter after more than four decades in prison, much of it on death row, following new DNA testing that excluded him as the source of genetic material on key crime scene evidence. Once the state executes someone, evidence that later casts doubt on the conviction is moot.

A convicted and securely confined prisoner poses no imminent threat. No improvement in execution procedures can justify the state’s power to take the life of a securely confined prisoner.

Jeffrey A. Singer, Phoenix

The writer, a physician, is the author of “Your Body, Your Health Care.”

The Christa Pike situation should compel all of us to rethink the death penalty. The Constitution explicitly prohibits “cruel and unusual punishments.” I believe our courts have made a grievous mistake in finding that capital punishment is not cruel. It is cruel whether the procedure is botched or effective. As a Marylander, I am proud that the death penalty is now banned here. It should be banned everywhere.

Bryan Stevenson, one of the truly great Americans of our time, wrote in “Just Mercy: A Story of Justice and Redemption”: “The death penalty is not

about whether people deserve to die for the crimes they commit. The real question of capital punishment in this country is, *Do we deserve to kill?*”

Robert Tiller, Silver Spring

Why is the suffering of Christa Pike being given so much attention after the state of Tennessee attempted to execute her? Her situation does not compare to the terror and pain she caused Colleen Slemmer.

I don’t think this case should be used as an example of why the death penalty should be abolished. Nor should Pike’s age at the time of the crime or the abuse she suffered as a child and teen be factors in the severity of her punishment. The logical path forward should be to change the method of execution. Hanging or firing squad would surely accomplish the appropriate punishment for such heinous crimes.

But further sympathy and attention should be shifted away from Pike and toward her victim’s devastated family.

Anne Dodrill, Leesburg

A word about the seventh day

I enjoyed George F. Will’s Sept. 27 column, “Integralists’ and their socialist soulmates.” I appreciated the irony that integralists, who wish to “return America to being a ‘Christian nation,’” so badly misunderstand what Jesus meant when he declared, “My kingdom is not of this world” (John 18:36).

After discussing “blue laws,” which restricted work, commerce and pleasure on Sundays, Will said, “Until 1934, Pennsylvania’s piety prevented the Pirates and Phillies from playing home games on the Sabbath.” However, God rested on the seventh day (Genesis 2:2-3), which, according to our calendars, is Saturday. In many languages, the word for Saturday is based on the Hebrew word Shabbat, which means “to cease,” “to stop” or “to rest.” Examples include Spanish: sábado; Italian: sabato; Greek: sávvato; Russian: subbota; Czech: sobota; Arabic: al-sabt; Indonesian: Sabtu; Filipino: sabado; Malay: Sabtu; Baluchi: shambeh. The Catechism of the Catholic Church says Sunday is distinguished from the Sabbath, and the church ceremonially observes it on Sundays.

Marty Bokow, Silver Spring

Letter submissions

Send letters to letters@washpost.com. Submissions must be exclusive to The Post and should include the writer’s address and day and evening telephone numbers. Letters are subject to editing and abridgment. Please do not send letters as attachments. Because of the volume of material we receive, we are unable to acknowledge submissions; writers whose letters are under consideration for publication will be contacted.

Post Opinions wants to know: What do you wish you had known earlier? What nuggets of wisdom, gleaned from years of experience, would you share with your younger self? Send us your response, and it might be published as a letter to the editor. wapo.st/wise_words

CORRECTION

The photo caption accompanying the Oct. 3 editorial, “The Atlantic’s hurricane drought offers a lesson in climate science,” misidentified the state where the image was taken. Tybee Island is in Georgia.



ANGELINA ALCANTAR/NEWS SENTINEL/USA TODAY NETWORK VIA REUTERS CONNECT

Demonstrators hold a vigil for Christa Pike in Knoxville, Tennessee, on Sept. 30.

OPINION

Medicare-for-all is back. The hard questions remain unanswered.

BY ELISABETH ROSENTHAL

As Americans grow increasingly frustrated with their health care system, a reform proposal that has long been kicked around on the Democratic periphery is showing up in debates and on political platforms: Medicare-for-all.

According to a 2025 Economist-YouGov poll, nearly 60 percent of Americans favor a system of Medicare-for-all, while 85 percent of Democrats support it. For years, Democrats in Congress have proposed symbolic Medicare-for-all bills that have had no chance of passage but have been supported by dozens of members.

Democratic Sen. Chris Van Hollen of Maryland added his support in December. “I was listening to my constituents,” he told me. “It’s just reached the complete breaking point. Our system is unaffordable and unsustainable with premiums going up, co-pays going up and up.”

At a time when more than 100 million Americans carry medical debt, it’s easy to get behind a promise of free, or free-ish, no-hassle health care. But turning an inspirational slogan into law gets gnarly. Those three words, Medicare-for-all — a pledge to bring universal health care to every American — mean not one thing to supporters but many. And all versions would face considerable obstacles to enactment.

“Medicare-for-all is a slogan, not a concrete proposal, so it’s hard to have an opinion on,” said Amy Finkelstein, an MIT economist who, with Stanford’s Liran Einav, wrote “We’ve Got You Covered,” which laid out what the pair considered a realistic and fiscally responsible plan for providing basic insurance to every American.

“What we can afford is a basic plan — what we call a shack, not a chateau,” Finkelstein said. Its bedrock would be a government-funded skinny plan less generous than Medicare, with potential constraints such as a limited number of physical therapy visits or stricter criteria for getting a knee replacement but guaranteed robust basic coverage for catastrophic medical conditions. She estimated that most Americans would opt for supplemental coverage.

The most high-profile political proponent of Medicare-for-all this election season is Abdul El-Sayed, the Democratic senatorial candidate in Michigan who has made a more sweeping proposal central to his platform, far more chateau than shack.

It would create one plan that covers a suite of medical needs with no cost to patients — including dental and vision care, which traditional Medicare doesn’t cover.



A Medicare-for-all rally in D.C. in 2019.

(Traditional Medicare has increasingly come to resemble private insurance with premiums and co-insurance, and unlike standard commercial plans, it has no annual out-of-pocket maximum. To fill such gaps, patients buy separate “Medigap” and drug plans.)

“The most important thing is just to make Medicare whole — meaning no charge for medical care — rolling back the complexity and costs of the last 10 years,” El-Sayed told me.

His program would start off covering children and adults five years younger than the current eligibility age for Medicare and close the gap over a period, he estimates, of eight years. To ease the transition for the health care system, he would initially set the Medicare payment rates so they mirror the totals doctors and hospitals receive now, avoiding a “price shock” to their operations. Future increases would be limited to the rate of inflation.

One big question is how to make the financing work in a highly profitable industry. National health spending was projected to hit \$5.7 trillion in 2025, or nearly 20 percent of U.S. gross domestic product.

Yes, the United States spends twice as much on health care per person compared with many peer countries. And, yes, health insurance is often a company’s second-largest expense after payroll.

But how will the government divert financial outlays of employers and households into a new Medicare-for-all system without new taxes or massive government spending?

When polls ask voters whether they would support Medicare-for-all if it meant losing their insur-

ance or paying new taxes, support often drops.

“You could decide to raise taxes and cover more,” Finkelstein said. “If you don’t want to cut current Medicare benefits, you could decide to bust the budget, which seems to be a common practice.”

As president, Joe Biden said he would veto any Medicare-for-all bill, given the cost, which was estimated at up to \$40 trillion over 10 years. The bills in Congress don’t include very detailed financing plans.

Economists who have mapped out the possibilities are divided on a realistic path.

A group of Yale researchers estimated that converting to a Medicare-for-all program could save \$450 billion annually. That’s in part because a government plan could negotiate — or simply set — far better prices for hospitals, doctors, drugs and devices than private insurers. It would reduce the overhead created by private insurance with its army of negotiators, coders and claim deniers — and reduce profits.

There are strong forces pushing back against such “rightsizing” of exorbitant prices, most notably: insurers, hospitals, and drug and device manufacturers. In 2022, they spent over \$700 million on lobbying and have been a powerful force for job creation. But a grand Medicare-for-all proposal may simply be a strategy to open the debate to lesser possibilities. President Barack Obama’s initial Affordable Care Act proposal contained ambitious ideas — such as drug price negotiation — that fell by the wayside to get the votes for passage.

Texas Democratic Senate candidate James Taralico supports what he calls Medicare for Y’all — allowing people under 65 to buy into Medicare.

“There are versions of Medicare-for-all that could potentially include our proposal, and versions that could look extremely different,” Finkelstein said.

Support in some parts of the industry is growing.

According to one survey, more than half of all physicians have said they’d prefer some sort of single-payer system. Though the American Medical Association is opposed, its student and resident sections are pressing to overturn the opposition. The American College of Physicians, the nation’s second-largest physician group, also supports Medicare-for-all. Obama called the ACA a “starter house.” It was “an improvement, but it has not met the need,” Van Hollen said.

Now the growing number of Medicare-for-all proponents will have to define exactly what kind of new house they can accept and afford.

Elisabeth Rosenthal is a senior contributing editor at KFF Health News and the author of “An American Sickness: How Healthcare Became Big Business and How You Can Take It Back.”

LEANA S. WEN

Pennsylvania’s measles outbreak could be worse than it looks



HANNAH BEIER

The measles outbreak in Pennsylvania has already reached staggering proportions. Since it began in April, more than 970 cases across 39 counties have been confirmed. Nearly 200 people have been hospitalized. The state has reported five measles-associated deaths, including three unvaccinated adults and two infants.

As troubling as these numbers are, they don’t tell the whole story. To get a better sense of how the outbreak is unfolding for clinicians on the front lines, I spoke with Patrick Gavigan, a pediatric infectious diseases specialist at Penn State Health Golisano Children’s Hospital.

Gavigan’s hospital borders Lancaster County, where more than a third of the state’s cases have been confirmed. Before this outbreak, measles was so rare that he encountered it only once during his training. This year, his hospital has treated between 15 and 20 cases, most of them in the past month.

In addition to the volume, the symptoms his patients exhibited were what stood out to him. He had thought that most measles patients needing hospitalization would experience respiratory distress. About 1 in 20 children with measles develop pneumonia, and indeed, he is seeing patients who need oxygen support and, in some cases, machines to help them breathe.

Gavigan told me that his biggest surprise was how many severe cases he was seeing in previously healthy individuals, and how many involved non-respiratory symptoms. Some patients experienced vomiting and diarrhea and were found to have elevated liver enzymes and ultimately diagnosed with hepatitis. Some developed encephalitis, an inflammation of the brain that can result in seizures, paralysis and permanent brain damage. Some have been discharged to go home; others have faced a much slower recovery and may never regain the abilities they had before becoming ill.

What also worries him is how many people in the community are infected with measles but are not accounted for in official statistics. “Every pediatric patient that we’ve had at the hospital, when we talk to the family, everyone or nearly everyone at home has had a measles-like illness,” he said. When clinicians ask whether those family members were tested, the answer is no, unless they, too, were sick enough to go to the hospital.

This means the reported case numbers are almost certainly far below the true number of infections, which is why this outbreak has been so hard to contain. Measles is caused by a virus that can linger in the air for up to two hours after an infected person leaves. Initial symptoms of fever, runny nose and congestion mimic other common viral illnesses. The characteristic rash does not appear until about four days after symptoms begin; during this window, the person could unknowingly spread the virus.

The best way to rein in measles is to track down exposed individuals and monitor them for symptoms during the incubation period, which can last up to 21 days. When people don’t realize they are infected and never get tested, contact tracing becomes much harder. Some reported cases have involved exposures affecting potentially thousands of people at a time, including at service stations along major highways, grocery stores, a courthouse and a soccer camp.

Gavigan told me all the patients requiring inpatient care at his hospital have been unvaccinated. This tracks with statewide data: Less than 1 percent of Pennsylvania cases have been in vaccinated individuals. Two doses of the measles, mumps and rubella vaccine are more than 97 percent effective against measles infection, making the kind of widespread societal disruption seen during the covid pandemic unlikely. But the resurgence has made life less safe for infants too young to be vaccinated and immunocompromised individuals, whose families must change how they interact with the public to protect them.

Despite the ballooning numbers, Gavigan sees signs of hope. He has seen people get vaccinated after watching family members fall ill. Some who were previously hesitant about the shot are now promoting it in their communities. His region has large populations of Amish and Mennonite families whom he believes are not necessarily opposed to vaccines but have been disengaged from the medical system.

“For so long, people hadn’t seen any measles,” he said. Now that it has become a real threat, there is more willingness to take preventive action.

The state health department is also reporting a surge of interest in the measles, mumps and rubella vaccine. In August, health care providers administered more than 49,000 doses, nearly double the number in a typical month. In the first three weeks of September, they administered more than 38,000, including many through pop-up vaccination clinics in affected communities.

How Pennsylvania handles this crisis will offer important lessons for other states. Over the past two years, major measles outbreaks have struck Texas, South Carolina and Utah. It’s only a matter of time before other states experience their next public health challenge from what remains a vaccine-preventable illness.



PAVEL BEDNYAKOV/AP

Russian Orthodox Church clerics carry the relics of the Holy Grand Prince Dmitry Donskoy during a procession in Moscow on Sept. 6.

JIM GERAGHTY

Russian troops may have lost this holy relic. Is it a sign?

Whether the Russian invasion of Ukraine is in the headlines or not, the war just keeps grinding on. Last month, British intelligence updated its estimates of the total number of casualties suffered by Russia — killed, wounded and missing — to 1.5 million troops since February 2022. Air Chief Marshal Sir Richard Knighton, chief of the U.K. defense staff, noted that most of the losses occurred since January 2023, and in that time, Russia gained just 2 percent of Ukrainian territory.

The Center for Strategic and International Studies estimated this summer that Russia had suffered as many as 450,000 battlefield deaths over the course of the war. A February 2026 estimate indicated Ukraine had suffered 250,000 to 300,000 military casualties, combined killed and wounded.

For perspective, in the roughly two decades of the Vietnam War, the U.S. casualties came to 58,220 killed, 303,704 wounded and 1,584 missing in action.

Clearly, Russian forces could use a morale boost, and last month the Russian Orthodox Church pitched in. Church officials sent relics including a piece of the right hand of Dmitry Donskoy to the front. The relics had been discovered this summer during restoration work in the Kremlin’s Archangel Cathedral. Donskoy was a prince celebrated in Russia for his victory over Mongol forces at the Battle of Kulikovo in 1380; the Russian Orthodox Church

canonized him as a saint in 1988.

The Moscow Patriarchate’s military department — “the Synodal Department for Cooperation with the Armed Forces and Law Enforcement Agencies” — announced on Sept. 8, “Right now, a reliquary containing a particle of the relics of the holy and faithful Grand Prince Dmitry Donskoy is en route to the front line. ... The holy commander is heading to where the fate of the Fatherland is being decided today, to invisibly stand in battle formation with our defenders.”

It’s tempting to scoff at the notion that an army of invaders who commit atrocities with metronomic regularity would take inspiration from a Christian relic, even if it is supposedly from a warrior prince’s sword-wielding hand. But put that aside for a moment, because now it appears Russian troops ... *lost Dmitry Donskoy’s hand fragment.*

The Moscow Times, a news site covering Russia from Amsterdam after being driven out of Russia, reported on Oct. 1 that two pro-war Telegram channels in Russia had described retreating troops as abandoning the Donskoy relics.

Unsurprisingly, church authorities insist that Donskoy’s relics are doing just fine. Spokesman Vakhtang Kipshidze told the state-owned domestic news agency RIA Novosti, “Reports have surfaced on social media that a particle of Dmitry Donskoy’s relics was lost in the area of a special military operation. This is a fabrication, and it is being spread,

presumably, with anti-church intent.” Military officials haven’t commented.

Of course, no one is posting recent pictures of the relics from the front, so neither side’s claim is easy to verify.

We do know that Ukraine’s Operation Vivaldi has retaken about 68 square miles around Lyman in the northern Donetsk oblast and captured 250 Russian troops. And it’s the front of a hard-fought war with constant drone bombardments; the notion of Russian troops coming under fire during a prayer service and abandoning the relics, as one report had it, is entirely plausible.

If you bring a saint’s hand fragment to the front in a war of aggression, and within a few weeks, the enemy’s attack just happens to be in the right place and at the right time and forces your guys to retreat, and they leave the hand behind ... is it possible God is trying to tell you something? Maybe, just maybe, the Creator is not on board with your more than 3,000 attacks on hospitals and other health care facilities during the war? The more than 3,900 Ukrainian children reportedly killed or injured during the war? The systematic abduction and forcible transfer, according to the United Nations, of thousands of Ukrainian children to Russia and Belarus?

And if the presence of a holy relic on the battlefield is supposed to be such a great inspiration, how should Russian soldiers interpret its loss?

They told the world AI is dangerous. Now Trump’s allies are coming for them.

AI FROM AI

sciousness and a sex workshop called “Slutcon.”

Trump officials and allies have sniped at the movement for months but the attacks intensified after public anxiety over AI risks forced the White House to respond. Sacks last month shared on X a New York Post front page that called employees of METR, which helped OpenAI investigate its rogue AI agents, “THE WOKE WIZARDS OF AI.” (The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI.)

Trump on Sunday named several figures who have rejected calls from advocates for an AI industry-wide slowdown to his Super Intelligence Force advisory panel. They include Sacks and Emil Michael, the Pentagon’s chief technology officer, who said last month that calls for action to prevent extreme scenarios of AI causing harm promoted “extinction, death-cult-like philosophies.”

“There has absolutely been a rhetorical push within certain corners of the White House and broader Trump administration to get the message out about effective altruism and its potential dangers,” said a Trump administration official, speaking on the condition of anonymity to describe private discussions.

A White House official said that it supports organizations that evaluate the security and safety of how AI models are engineered. The official pointed to Trump’s 2025 executive order targeting what the president termed “woke AI.”

Anthropic declined to comment.

Nathan Leamer, director of the pro-industry nonprofit Build American AI, said he has been briefing congressional staff and other influential conservative figures in Washington about effective altruism, describing it as antithetical to his own Christian values.

“A year ago no one in Hill offices knew what effective altruism was,” Leamer said. Build American AI is linked to Leading the Future, a political campaign group funded by the venture capital firm Andreessen Horowitz and OpenAI President Greg Brockman, a major mid-terms Republican donor.

Brad Carson, co-founder of Americans for Responsible Innovation, which says it is focused on AI policy in the public interest, said that Trump allies are trying discredit anyone pushing for meaningful AI regulation, an idea that now has significant momentum.

“In D.C., at least, and maybe in the broader culture, we won that fight. The vibe is with us,” said Carson, who also leads a political advocacy organization funded in part by Anthropic. “People are very concerned. Congress wants to regulate.”

But leaders of AI evaluation start-ups that did not grow out of the AI safety movement said some Washington Republicans are distrustful of the label.

“It almost felt like a new version of McCarthyism,” said Rayan Krishnan, CEO of the Andreessen Horowitz-backed start-up Vals AI, after a trip to Washington last month to pitch his start-up to the public sector.



KEVIN DIETSCH/GETTY IMAGES

Former White House AI adviser David Sacks, right, pictured with tech leaders at the White House last week, argues that some advocates for AI safety should be sidelined.



AL DRAGO/BLOOMBERG/GETTY IMAGES

Emil Michael, the Pentagon’s chief technology officer, has dismissed calls for action to prevent extreme scenarios of AI causing harm.

Judd Rosenblatt, CEO of AE Studio, who described himself as a conservative small business owner, said multiple people in the Trump administration have told his team that they see the need for third parties to assess AI tools, but are wary of effective altruism, he said.

Civil society groups that have been auditing AI systems since

before the debut of ChatGPT warn there is a risk that an opportunity for oversight of opaque AI giants will be squandered.

“Where we find ourselves now is trying to determine who will actually be in the room in making decisions,” said Miranda Bogen, chief technologist at the Center for Democracy &

Technology and director of the advocacy group’s AI Governance Lab, one of various groups eager to contribute their expertise in standard-setting.

The accord signed by AI chief executives last week, which Trump called “morally binding,” was frequently mentioned on stage and in huddles between sessions at the Berkeley con-

ference last weekend, where attendees endured a heat wave with fans and Popsicles.

At a Sunday discussion panel on what the AI auditor ecosystem might look like, one speaker said they are working on building a broad coalition of experts, including people working on bias and discrimination as well as blue-chip firms like Accenture

and Deloitte. Panelists also discussed other ways the community could prove its legitimacy. Another suggested two-month boot camps to train a talent pipeline of qualified auditors.

Adam Gleave, CEO of FAR AI, a nonprofit research institute, said in an interview that excluding the AI safety community would shut out people with expertise that are important in the current moment.

“When it comes to looking at millions of agent transcripts and trying to piece together what they did and how they were interacting, I don’t think there are many organizations in the world that have that expertise,” Gleave said. “The reality is that anyone you hire with that background is going to have some connection to the industry.”

On his podcast, Sacks and his co-hosts, who remain close to the White House, made clear that they preferred instead to have established corporate giants do the work.

“You’re going to see EY in short order here announce something,” said investor Chamath Palihapitiya, who earlier in the episode said his start-up 8090 was building the global accounting firm formerly known as Ernst & Young “an entire audit infrastructure for super intelligence,” and that 8090 now plans to “roll it out to everybody.”

EY said in a statement that it was working with 8090 to “develop new capabilities that bring greater visibility, traceability and human accountability to consequential AI-enabled decisions and workflows.”

For couples with an age gap, turning 65 doesn’t solve health insurance issue

BY JOHN CSISZAR

Turn 65 and you might think your health insurance problems are over. Although Medicare doesn’t cover every medical service or cost, for many retirees, it reduces coverage costs. But this doesn’t solve the coverage problem if you have a younger spouse who relied on your insurance and isn’t eligible for Medicare.

“People think of 65 as the finish line for health insurance,” said Zoe Lim, senior vice president of business development at DynEx Group Benefits. “For a couple with an age gap, it’s really only the finish line for one person.”

Large age gaps are not uncommon. The Census Bureau reports that in 2025, more than 5 million opposite-sex couples living together had a man who was at least 10 years older than his female partner. Another 1.3 million had a woman who was at least 10 years older than her male partner.

Even sophisticated workers can be left in the dark about their insurance choices after retirement or when becoming eligible for Medicare.

“I’ve consulted for CEOs of major corporations ... and what they’re given is a piece of paper and sent on their way,” said

Elizabeth Gavino, president and owner of insurance brokerage Lewin & Gavino.

One solution is to remain on an active employer plan even after becoming eligible for Medicare. In that case, a person can have both employer insurance and Medicare. Companies with 20 or more employees are generally responsible for paying medical bills of covered workers first. If it doesn’t cover the full amount, Medicare may then pay some of the remaining bill, depending on whether Medicare covers the service. The opposite is true for smaller companies, where Medicare generally bears first responsibility for paying.

If the employer option isn’t viable, the older spouse may choose to move to Medicare while the younger spouse obtains coverage through their own employer, COBRA, the Affordable Care Act marketplace or an individual policy purchased directly from an insurer.

COBRA can provide continuity because it allows the younger spouse to remain on the existing employer plan for up to 18 months, although coverage can sometimes last longer. But it can be expensive.

“I wouldn’t automatically assume COBRA is the answer for the younger spouse. It’s one



ISTOCK

option, but I would price everything before making that decision,” said Lim.

The older spouse can enroll in Medicare while the younger spouse remains on COBRA. If the older spouse has delayed Medicare Part B while covered by an active employer plan, they gener-

ally have up to eight months to enroll after the job or coverage ends, whichever happens first. Choosing COBRA does not extend that deadline, and missing it can result in a late-enrollment penalty. The important factor is that this deadline continues running, even if the person chooses

COBRA.

Another bridge solution for some couples could be marketplace coverage.

Generally, workers who lose job-based insurance can use a special enrollment period that runs from 60 days before to 60 days after the loss of coverage to

pick a plan.

Depending on household income and family size, premium tax credits and other savings may be available.

“Many couples think they are making a Medicare decision when they are really making a retirement decision that affects the whole family,” Gavino said.

Ultimately, the cost of providing health insurance for the younger spouse could end up forcing the older spouse to continue working.

“When the couple sits down to assess the real costs of Medicare and health insurance for the younger spouse, the decision to retire may be delayed,” Gavino said.

To avoid this scenario, couples can compare the premiums, deductibles, provider networks and out-of-pocket limits of each available insurance option before selecting a retirement date for the older spouse.

They can also review which marketplace subsidies are available, if any, and how long any temporary coverage will last.

By modeling both spouses’ insurance costs together and understanding how various solutions operate, couples can determine when retirement becomes affordable in terms of covering the cost of the younger spouse.



SPORTS
Four years in, what has the Deion Sanders experiment yielded for Colorado? **B7**



METRO
Jefferson’s link to Sally Hemings’s children might be settled by a hair. **B13**

The Washington Post
Style



TAYLOR JEWELL/AP

Where the
dads are
big league
boors

In ‘Team Moms,’ it’s the fathers who are the stars — and the villains

BY STEPHANIE APSTEIN

There is a moment midway through the third episode of “Team Moms: Baseball,” a new Kim Kardashian-produced reality show, when it almost seems as if the adults will remember that they are watching children play games.

There are still scenes of absurdity — such as when one child is revealed to be failing a few of his classes, and his father’s primary concern is that the poor grades make him ineligible for practice; when another dad, ejected from a youth tournament for berating the umpire, sneaks back in, beer in hand. But surely those are extremes, played up for the television audiences. Surely at some point, someone is going to take a glance at these 13- and 14-year-old boys, all floppy hair and sweeps of eye black, and offer them a childhood.

The cast has taken a spring break trip to Sedona, Arizona, from their homes outside Phoenix, and they are preparing for a kayaking excursion. By the river, a dozen tweens crowd around equipment crates, pawing through water shoes and fastening life jackets.

Except for three, who wait to see if they will be allowed to take some time off from what their father describes as their job: playing sports, to his standards. One

SEE **BASEBALL** ON **B2**

Q&A

Michael Douglas’s
‘sense of immortality’

BY HILLEL ITALIE
IN NEW YORK
Associated Press

The actor
bares the
most painful
moments
of his life in
memoir

Michael Douglas, the award-winning actor and producer, recently turned 82. He is a cancer survivor, a recovered addict, a married man, and the father and son of actors. He is also an author, who begins his memoir with a message of thanks to his family — past and present and future — for the “sense of immortality.” ¶ Immortality. ¶ “Many times my father was asked, ‘Kirk, are you jealous of your son?’” he said during a recent interview at a Manhattan hotel, referring to his late father, fellow actor and sometime combatant Kirk Douglas. “And he said, ‘Jealous?’ This is a sense of immortality, a continuity of generations.” ¶ Family is how Douglas anchors his legacy and his place in a world he fears is breaking down. But there are other ways to live on past your own time: starring in cultural touchstones such as “Fatal Attraction” or “Basic Instinct,” or writing a 500-page book that is titled “One Helluva Ride,” a famous man’s journey from rebellion and coming of age, to midlife success and transgression to the inevitable reckoning with mortality and past mistakes.

SEE **Q&A** ON **B3**

In his new memoir, “One Helluva Ride,” Oscar-winning actor Michael Douglas reflects on his youthful rebellion, his midlife success and his past mistakes.

THE LAST FIRST: WINTER K2 ★★☆☆

Greed amid
the falling
rocks and
avalanches

Documentary looks at the commercialization of extreme climbing

BY JOCELYN NOVECK
Associated Press

“He has to go and live on the edge,” explains Lina Móey about her husband, the Icelandic mountaineer John Snorri Sigurjonsson, in “The Last First: Winter K2.”

And she means it literally: He has to go live on the edge of a mountain.

In this case, it’s the most forbidding mountain on the planet: K2, on the border between Pakistan and China. Sigurjonsson, one of the main figures profiled in Amir Bar-Lev’s engrossing and sobering documentary, was already a celebrated climber when he returned to K2, the world’s second-highest peak after Mount Everest. He had scaled it in summertime. Now, four years later, Sigurjonsson aimed to scale it in winter.

That’s a feat no climber had ever achieved on what one expert calls a “savage mountain.” But that winter in 2021, as Pakistan eased pandemic-era border restrictions, dozens of climbers — veterans and novices alike — saw a chance to achieve that “last first” in extreme climbing.

Ultimately, 10 would make the summit. But Bar-Lev’s film is far from the usual inspiring look at

SEE **‘THE LAST FIRST’** ON **B2**

Spouse is sad that entertainment interests have diverged. Readers have advice.



Carolyn Hax

We asked readers to channel their inner Carolyn Hax and answer this question. Some of the best responses are below.

Dear Caro-lyn: How do I accept that my spouse's interests and desires for formerly shared activities have changed? We bonded early on over the arts — think independent films, thoughtful books and TV series, museums, and occasional ballet and symphony attendance squeezed in somehow despite a limited budget. We were so similar in outlook, we used to joke that we'd married our twin!

Over several decades, with the birth of our children, our priorities understandably shifted. But now, it seems the change is permanent. We still support each other's solo individual pursuits, but our common interests have dwindled. Shared movies (rare)

are hero action films or goofy comedies only. Spouse's books have narrowed to spy or detective lit. Any attempt to share a deeply meaningful movie, documentary or TV series that I've discovered is met with "meh" on their part.

Honestly, it's painfully lonely. I sometimes feel like I don't know who they are anymore, and that in a way, I've lost my best friend.

Remember in the movie "The Break-up" when Jennifer Aniston says it's not about whether Vince Vaughn loves the ballet, it's that "the person that he loves" loves the ballet? She's willing to do his stuff, and wants him to *want* to do her stuff, too, just for her sake. (Oof. No notes.)

Fruitlessly begging them to sit next to me to experience something meaningful that they claim they used to but no longer enjoy would diminish it for me and not bring us any closer. In other respects, they have been a good partner and parent over

the years. How do I reframe this to get over my sadness about this change?

— *Baby Wanted 12 Lemons, Got 3*

Baby Wanted 12 Lemons, Got 3: You describe your interests as "thoughtful" and "deeply meaningful" and your spouse's as "narrow" and "goofy." Leave aside the arrogance of your estimation of your own hobbies. Leave aside, even, the fact that some of history's greatest writers, from Sir Arthur Conan Doyle to John le Carré and Graham Greene, wrote detective and spy fiction.

The real question is: How can you fault your spouse for not taking an interest in your interests when you show such obvious contempt for theirs? Try learning more about what they love and why they love it. Only then will you have standing to request that they return the favor.

— *RTF*

Baby Wanted 12 Lemons, Got

3: Rather than trying to restart what you had in the past, I suggest exploring things that are new to both of you. Pick something; give it a try. No interest? Try something else.

Our interests change over time. My husband and I had symphony tickets for years, and then I realized I was zoning out during the orchestral music. I stopped going; he is still a subscriber. Yesterday we went to a concert by someone new who improvises and is truly gifted. We both enjoyed it. A few years ago, I never would have guessed I'd be raising butterflies. My husband has joined me in that new activity. You get the idea.

— *New*

Baby Wanted 12 Lemons, Got 3: You sound as if you haven't changed at all. Perhaps that's frustrating for your spouse?

— *Flip*

Baby Wanted 12 Lemons, Got 3: Hard to tell from your narra-

tive whether your spouse truly changed or if they just went along with what you wanted to do for years and now are no longer willing to do that. Both are possible, so ask the question.

If it is the former, well, such changes happen, even if they are rare. If it is the latter, you have a right to be somewhat miffed your spouse apparently deceived you about what they truly liked for years.

On the other hand, you got to do what you wanted for years and your spouse didn't. So maybe it is their turn.

— *Old Wine*

Baby Wanted 12 Lemons, Got 3: You're both older. A lot of life has happened. The world can be a dark place. Is it possible your spouse is more interested in "lighter" entertainment because they're exhausted? Did they spend decades focusing on child care and/or earning a living? Are they still doing the heavy lifting in keeping your shared lives organized and comfort-

able?

Think about why they might not be interested in working at engaging with the more serious pursuits you miss doing with them. It may be a combination of changing interests and a need to relax. Make sure you're pulling your weight and accept that you may have different needs for leisure activities.

— *CF*

Every week, we ask online readers to answer a question submitted to Carolyn Hax's live chat or email. New questions are typically posted on Thursdays, with a Monday deadline for submissions. Responses are anonymous unless you choose to identify yourself and are edited for length and clarity.

Write to Carolyn Hax at tellme@washpost.com. Get her newsletter delivered to your inbox each morning at wapo.st/gethax.

Join the discussion live at noon Fridays at washingtonpost.com/livechats.

Actor thinks he inherited father Kirk Douglas's tenacity, ambition and rage

Q&A FROM B1

Publishing on Tuesday, his memoir is framed around the making of some of his most notable movies, including "Basic Instinct," "Fatal Attraction," "Falling Down," "Romancing the Stone" and two films that brought him Oscars: as a producer of best picture winner "One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest" and as star of "Wall Street," when his turn as corporate raider Gordon Gekko brought him the prize for best actor and helped make "Greed is good" a catchphrase for the late 1980s.

Douglas himself was once enough a symbol of hedonism that he was rumored to be undergoing treatment for sex addiction. False, he says, but in his memoir he acknowledges that at the time he met Catherine Zeta-Jones, whom he married in 2000, he was dating five other women. They were all in different cities, he explained during his interview, and "as long as you weren't seeing somebody else in the same city that might embarrass her, they were all right."

He is now well settled with Zeta-Jones and satisfied enough with his career that he no longer has any great drive to top himself; he's just as happy taking a walk in the garden. But Douglas also sees the book as a baring of the most painful moments of his life: his near-archetypal quest to forge an identity apart from his father; a childhood damaged by violence and divorce that only was resolved in the latter part of Kirk's life; Douglas' own divorce from first wife, Diandra Luker; the substance abuse battles of Michael and son Cameron Douglas, who spent seven years in prison on drug charges; and the diagnosis of Stage 4 tongue cancer in 2010 that he at first assumed would kill him.

Wearing a dark blazer, blue shirt and no tie, Douglas is a warm and open conversationalist. During his interview, he spoke of the awesome burdens and privileges of being Kirk Douglas' son, his improbable decision to become an actor, too, and the single line of dialogue he says comes closest to the truth about himself.

This interview has been edited for length and clarity.

The way you describe your father in this book, it feels like something larger than just the two of you: the king and the heir who only wants to live up to him.

I looked at dad as just Superman. He was so dynamic. He was so strong. He has such tenacity. I watched him on the screen as Spartacus, saw him as Ulysses ... I never thought I could be the man my father was. I didn't think it was in the cards. It took me a long time to gain confidence and then to make a lot of the same mistakes he made.

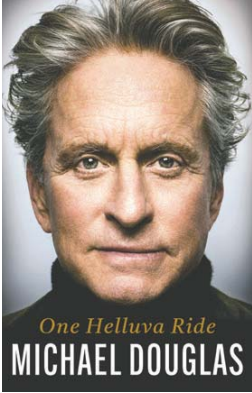
And still, perhaps against all common sense, you decide to become an actor.

I never thought about being an actor until I was in college. I had no major. And they called me into the office. "You got to declare a major. You can't just take general education courses." I was a bit of a hippie at the time. And I thought, "Well, my mother (Diana Douglas) is an actress, and I had seen her doing stage productions. And my father" So I thought it would be an easy course.

I started then performing in school. I had terrible, terrible stage fright, you know, (vomit-



Michael Douglas in 1976 at the Academy Awards ceremony, where he won a best-picture Oscar as producer for "One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest."



Douglas's memoir, "One Helluva Ride," which was released Tuesday, details the personal struggles he has faced.

ing in) wastebaskets off stage.

What made you decide to stick with it?

I wanted to overcome my stage fright. I wanted to fight the uncomfortable feeling I had of being in front of a camera.

In so much of the book, it seems like you're at war with yourself.

I think that's probably true. I think I inherited my father's tenacity, my father's ambition, and his rage. He had a big temper growing up. There must have been this desire to feel like I was somebody. Because growing up, I was always the son of ...

Your father used to say that the most personal words he ever spoke on screen were in "Lonely Are the Brave," when he said "I'm a loner clear down deep to my very guts." What a line. A two-part question: Do you think that was true of him? And is there a line from one of your movies that says the same about yourself?



Douglas and his wife, Catherine Zeta-Jones, in 2018. "I'm always saying to my kids or anybody else that will listen — get your career out of the way before you think about marrying and having kids," Douglas says. "That affected my first marriage, because I was consumed."

They [his parents] had good friends and everything, but there was always an isolation about him. And I find I have a bit of that, too.

As far as a line for myself, I always love in "Falling Down," when he (an unemployed defense worker who turns violent) says "I'm the bad guy?"

Why do you relate to that?

I'm fairly tough on myself in the book and, you know, honest. I tried to do the right thing but have found myself in situations

where it appears that I am the bad guy.

You write about how you regretted spending so much time away from home during your first marriage. But seeing all the movies you made and everything else you did, would you have done it differently if you had the chance?

I can't say I would. I do not believe that you can balance career with family. You just can't balance it. So I'm always saying

to my kids or anybody else that will listen — get your career out of the way before you think about marrying and having kids. That affected my first marriage, because I was consumed.

Could you have written this book if your father was still alive?

No.

Why not?

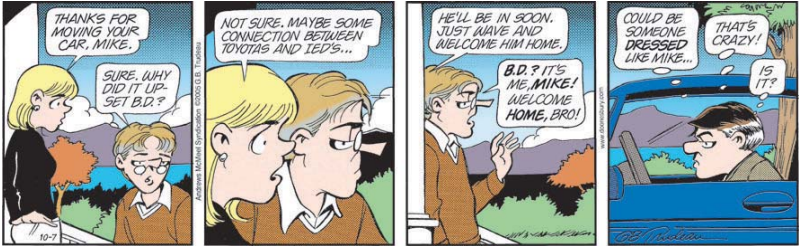
Because I was very uncomfortable talking about the early years and his physical abuse. He

was of a generation that hit; my mother used the hairbrush. He was tough. That was also one of the reasons it took a little time to warm up as we got older, and to forgive him.

What was that process like? There's a lot to forgive.

Time heals, you know. Hopefully. Life moves on. Dad had that great line right after I won (the Oscar) for "Wall Street." He said to me, "You know, I would have been nicer to you if I knew how successful you were going to be."

CLASSIC DOONESBURY



GARRY TRUDEAU

PICKLES



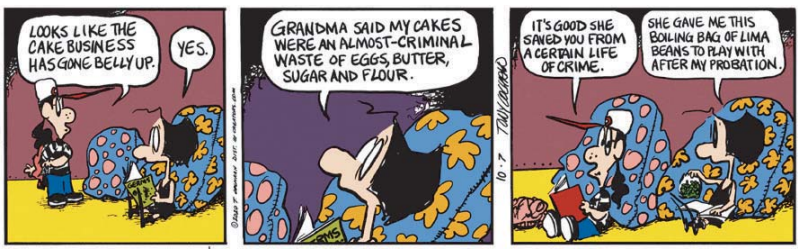
BRIAN CRANE

RED AND ROVER



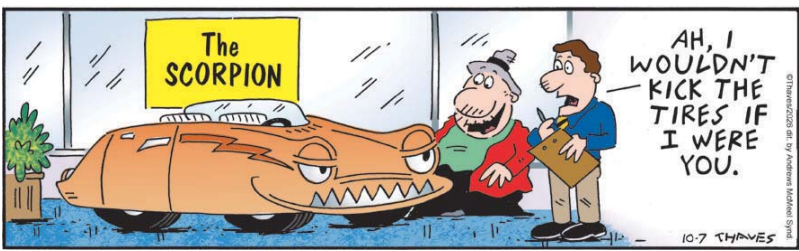
BRIAN BASSET

AGNES



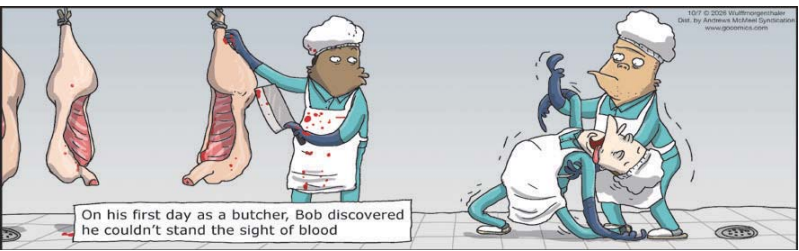
TONY COCHRAN

FRANK AND ERNEST



TOM THAVES

WUMO



MIKAEL WULFF & ANDERS MORGENTHAER

CLASSIC PEANUTS



CHARLES SCHULZ

CRABGRASS



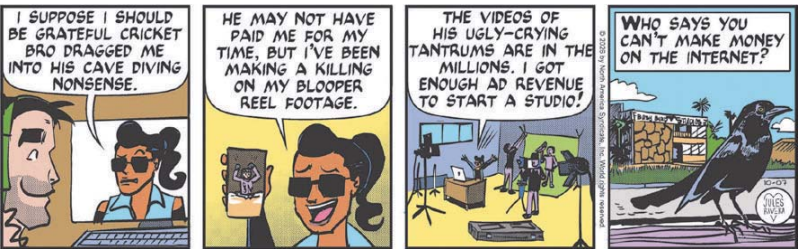
TAUHIID BONDIA

RHYMES WITH ORANGE



HILARY PRICE

MARK TRAIL



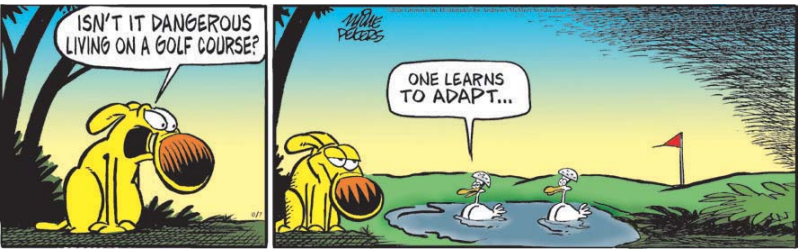
JULES RIVERA

LIO



MARK TATULLI

MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM



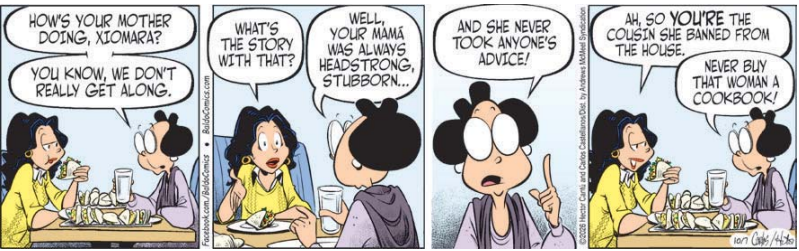
MIKE PETERS

HAGAR THE HORRIBLE



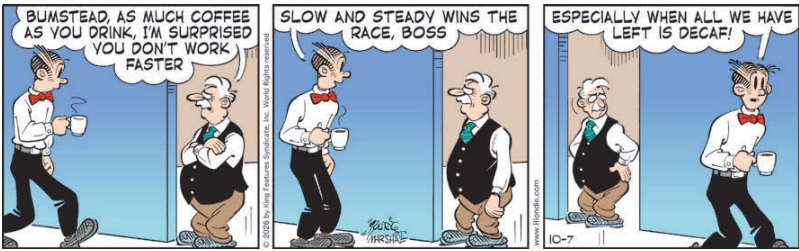
CHRIS BROWNE

BALDO



HECTOR CANTU & CARLOS CASTELLANOS

BLONDIE



DEAN YOUNG & JOHN MARSHALL

SALLY FORTH



FRANCESCO MARCIULIANO & JIM KEEFE

BREWSTER ROCKIT: SPACE GUY!



TIM RICKARD

SHERMAN'S LAGOON



JIM TOOMEY

PEARLS BEFORE SWINE



STEPHAN PASTIS

CURTIS



RAY BILLINGSLEY

MUTTS

BRRR... THERE'S AN AUTUMN CHILL IN THE AIR.

YES - JACK FROST WAS NIPPING AT MY NOSE.

HE WAS!!

OOF!

HE SHOULD BE MUZZLED.

PATRICK McDONNELL

10-7

ZITS

I'M HOME!

ARE YOU HUNGRY, JEREMY?

NAW. I ATE A BUNCH OF SNAP PEAS AND MANGOES AT WORK, SO I'M STUFFED.

JERRY SCOTT & JIM BORGMAN

10-7

HEART OF THE CITY

HAVE YOU SEEN THAT NEW KID THAT DRESSES IN ALL--

IN ALL GIR STUFF?! FROM 'INVADER ZIM'?! I KNEW THAT KID EXISTED!!

NO, I WAS TALKING ABOUT THE KID WHO WEARS ALL HATSUNE MIKU STUFF.

AUGH! WHY DO ALL THE SIXTH GRADERS DRESS LIKE CARTOON CHARACTERS?!

HATSUNE MIKU IS A VOCALOID.

STEENZ

10-7

JUDGE PARKER

WE KNOW YOU MET WITH ARMS TRAFFICKERS IN NORWAY.

THAT'S LAST YEAR'S NEWS. AND YOU KNEW IT WAS HAPPENING. YOU LET IT HAPPEN TO SEE WHAT THEY WANTED. RANDY TOLD ME ABOUT YOUR LITTLE TALK WITH HIM LAST SUMMER.

AND DID RANDY TELL YOU THAT WE COULD IMPRISON YOU FOR LIFE FOR WHAT YOU DID?

YEAH, MY HUSBAND'S QUITE CHATTY. CAN I CALL MY DAUGHTER NOW?

FRANCESCO MARCIULIANO & MIKE MANLEY

10-7

FRAZZ

WOW. THIS ARTICLE SAYS IT'S NEVER BEEN EASIER TO BUY-AND DUMP AND REPLACE -THE LATEST FASHIONS.

AND THAT THAT'S A HUGE SOURCE OF THE WORLD'S POLLUTION.

I'M WHAT? I'M YOUR HERO NOW?

WELL, YOUR CARDIGAN IS.

JEFF MALLETT

10-7

SIX CHIX

Turns out what he really wanted was the Ruby Slippers.

BANNERMAN, XUNISE, KONAR, LAWTON, PATRINOS & PIRO

10-7

GARFIELD

BARK

BARK

JIM DAVIS

10-7

BARNEY AND CLYDE

Let's check her out and see if Cassiopeia is chipped.

Great.

So, Mr. Finster, do you WANT her to be chipped?

Of course. If she has an owner, she must be returned. That is fair, and best for everyone.

Well, then I am sorry to say she is not chipped.

Damn.

Yay.

WEINGARTENS & CLARK

10-7

DUSTIN

I'VE WANTED TO DO THIS MY WHOLE LIFE, AND NOW I FINALLY CAN.

HUH?

BARTENDER, A ROUND FOR THE HOUSE! ON ME!

YOU'RE THE ONLY ONE IN HERE.

MAKE MINE A LIGHT BEER.

STEVE KELLEY & JEFF PARKER

10-7

FLASH GORDON

BOOK TOLD FLASH ABOUT MING'S PERSONAL LIGHTNING FIELD.

FLASH HAD THAT IN MIND WHEN HE MADE HIS PLAY.

HE KNEW FIRST-HAND THAT HIS SHIELD SHIRT COULD TAKE THE GALVANIC BOLTS.

AND THAT THE SNOWBLADE WOULD BECOME A LIGHTNING ROD IN HIS HAND.

NOW FLASH HAS TO KEEP THE PRESSURE UP.

TRY TO DROP MING -- KNOCK HIM OUT, BREAK HIM DOWN --

--BEFORE HE CAN STRIKE BACK.

DAN SCHKADE

10-7

PRICKLY CITY

I HIRED AN ASSISTANT TO HANDLE MY NEWS ANXIETY. MEET BOBO.

RUSSIA MIGHT ATTACK NATO.

POOF

I THINK THAT'LL BE A WORKERS' COMP CLAIM.

MARSHALL RAMSEY

10-7

LOOSE PARTS

We'll have to run a few more scans. But we think it might be a tumor.

DAVE BLAZEK

10-7

NON SEQUITUR

OK, MEN...TIME TO MARCH OFF TO WAR OVER GEOPOLITICAL ISSUES YOU KNOW NOTHING ABOUT FOR THE BENEFIT OF OLD RICH GUNS HOLDING ON TO POWER!

THE BATTLE OF FULL DISCLOSURE

WILEY

10-7

BABY BLUES

OKAY, WHICH ONE OF YOU LEFT MY POWER DRILL IN THE YARD?

I PLEADED THE SIXTH COMMANDMENT.

YOU MEAN THE FIFTH AMENDMENT.

NO, HE'S AFRAID YOU MIGHT KILL HIM.

RICK KIRKMAN & JERRY SCOTT

10-7

WALLACE THE BRAVE

THE GENERAL DEBRIEFED ME ON THE SITUATION

THE FISH HAD HYPER-EVOLVED

THEY BECAME SMART. TOO SMART

SMART ENOUGH TO RECOGNIZE THE THREAT OF HUMANS

AND RUTHLESS ENOUGH TO DO SOMETHING ABOUT IT

once again, no one cares about the Polar bears...

WILL HENRY

10-7

SPEED BUMP

YEAH, I'D GO WITH THE COOL BLUE - YOUR FUR TONE IS DEFINITELY A SUMMER.

DAVE COVERLY

10-7

DENNIS THE MENACE

WHEN WAS THE LAST TIME YOU HAD TO DO SOMETHING FOR THE FIRST TIME?

H. KETCHAM

10-7

ON THE FASTTRACK

YES, PHINSTER TRIED TO MAKE ME SUSPICIOUS OF YOUR INTENTIONS.

...KNOWING THAT MY WEAK POINT IS MY ISSUE WITH TRUST.

...UNAWARE THAT I REALLY, REALLY, REALLY DON'T TRUST HIM.

"STRATEGY FAIL."

BILL HOLBROOK

10-7

FAMILY CIRCUS

I wish the air would stand still.

BIL KEANE

10-7

REPLY ALL LITE

Be strong. Be tough. Don't be a blubbering baby.

DONNA A. LEWIS

10-7

BEETLE BAILEY

THE GENERAL WOULD LIKE YOU TO KEEP IT DOWN

ROARRR

HE SAID IT'S AS "DOWN" AS HE CAN KEEP IT

GREG, BRIAN & NEAL WALKER

10-7



RON CHENOY/IMAGN IMAGES

A switch at quarterback has not paid dividends for fourth-year Coach Deion Sanders and the struggling Buffaloes (2-3), who are mired in a three-game losing streak.

A tough time for Coach Prime

Sanders made Colorado football matter again, but his fourth season has been a trying one

BY EDDIE PELLIS
Associated Press

BOULDER, COLO. — One of Colorado's biggest boosters loves him. One of his most daunting opponents does, too.

Deion Sanders is still capturing his share of hearts at the program he put back on the map when he arrived before the 2023 season. But wins aren't following.

Examining the before and after of the most recent loss — a 29-7 home setback against Texas Tech on Saturday that dropped Sanders to 18-24 at Colorado — shows there aren't any clear-cut answers for the Buffaloes, who are 2-3.

Yes, they could use more money to stay on pace in the college sports arms race. Even if they got it, though, there is mixed evidence as to whether "Coach Prime" and his staff are up to the task of winning big.

A valuable connection

A booster named Rob Wilhite was among the hundreds hanging out Saturday on a lawn in the shadow of Colorado's Folsom Field. On autumn Saturdays, the football-sized field becomes "Ralphie's Corral," named after the buffalo that leads the Buffs onto the gridiron. Wilhite is the official personal injury attorney for Colorado athletics.

"Look what he's done for our program," he says of Sanders as he points at the hundreds of people milling, sipping and waiting for a pregame appearance from Ralphie herself. "Before he came, there was no one out here. It was like half this crowd."

Wilhite grew up in Dallas watching Sanders play for the Cowboys on Sundays. On Saturdays, he loved watching Eric Bieniemy lead the Buffs to their only national title in 1990. The day the attorney officially fell in love with Colorado football was Jan. 1, 1996, at the Cotton Bowl.

"I got to see Rick Neuheisel play his
SEE SANDERS ON B10

Changes are likely for O's in offseason

Franchise begins process of self-examination after another lost season

BY MATT WEYRICH
Baltimore Sun

While the MLB playoffs are in full swing, the Baltimore Orioles' offseason is already well underway.

Baltimore was in mathematical contention until the regular season's final week, but the club never shook off its inconsistencies enough to secure a spot in the postseason. The Orioles finished 79-82, falling 4½ games short of a wild-card spot and landing in fourth in the American League East, just a half-game ahead of the last-place Toronto Blue Jays.

"It's a very bitter feeling, especially doing this two years in a row now," Mike Elias, the team's president of baseball operations, said in his end-of-season news conference Sept. 28. "It's a full organizational review, and that's how you kind of spend your October weeks. ... We want to be better, results-wise. The results need to be better. This is the second year in a row that they haven't been there to this degree. And we're tired of it."

Changes are expected this offseason, including in the front office, where the Orioles already parted ways with longtime player development executive Matt Blood and reassigned assistant general manager Sig Mejdal to a research-based role.

A long winter lies ahead, not just for the Orioles but MLB as a whole. With league owners expected to lock out the players Dec. 1 when their collective bargaining agreement expires, there's lots of uncertainty over whether and when the 2027 season will begin.

Here's everything you need to know about the Orioles' offseason:

Pending free agents (4)

Starting pitcher Trevor Rogers:

The Orioles' biggest free agent this winter is Rogers, the left-hander who resurrected his career with Baltimore. Rogers followed up his 1.81 ERA over 18 starts in 2025 with a 4.03 ERA in 30 outings this season, posting strong underlying numbers — 3.45 FIP, 3.60 xERA — that backed up his standing as a middle- to front-of-the-rotation starter.

Elias already voiced his interest in working out a long-term deal before free agency opens next month. Rogers, 28, is eligible for the qualifying offer, a one-year deal projected to be about \$23 million this year by MLB
SEE ORIOLES ON B11

Four ACC schools push for tweaks to legislation

Commissioner unfazed by lobbying efforts of FSU, Clemson, others

BY AARON BEARD
Associated Press

CHARLOTTE — ACC Commissioner Jim Phillips isn't publicly fretting about four member schools expressing support for tweaking realignment provisions in the Protect College Sports Act to make it easier for schools to change leagues.

Speaking Tuesday at preseason ACC basketball media days, Phillips touted the health and financial gains for the league while also saying schools "need direct access to state their case" when it comes to the proposed law to reform college athletics. The U.S. Senate approved a version of the measure and sent it to the House.

The presidents and chancellors of Clemson, Florida State, Miami and North Carolina sent a letter last week to House leaders seeking to increase the bill's membership cap for conferences from 20 to 22 schools. They also requested removing a requirement for a school to be independent for three years before joining another league.

Tomahawk Nation, a site covering Florida State athletics, was the first to obtain a copy of the letter. A North Carolina spokesman confirmed its authenticity when contacted by the Associated Press.

Phillips said he would continue to stay in touch with all ACC schools and noted most back the measure.

"We have 14 schools that feel really good about it that want to sign it, and we have four schools that have an issue with a portion of it," he said. "So that's what I'm going to continue to push towards the decision makers and
SEE ACC LETTER ON B10



RYAN HUNT/GETTY IMAGES

Pat Narduzzi said the fact that Pitt and Virginia Tech were both undefeated but unranked before Friday's game was "disrespectful."

Narduzzi: League still deserves more respect

Coach of 5-0 Pitt wants his team, and its rivals, on more voters' ballots

BY WILL GRAVES
Associated Press

PITTSBURGH — Pat Narduzzi is tired of ACC football being a punching bag in the polls and seemingly everywhere else.

The pathologically unfiltered Pittsburgh coach is ready for the league to start punching back.

Narduzzi landed the first but probably not the last salvo of the season just moments after the Panthers fended off Virginia Tech on the road Friday night, a game decided on a missed 36-yard field goal as time expired.

In the frantic aftermath, the longest-tenured coach in Panthers history encouraged Associated Press top 25 voters to "wake your [butts] up," just as Narduzzi

promised ACC Commissioner Jim Phillips he would after the Panthers improved to 5-0.

Narduzzi wasn't just stumping for Pitt, which did sneak in at No. 25 when the latest poll was released Sunday, but the entire conference.

What else is there to do after being told before the showdown with the Hokies that it marked the first time two Power Four programs entered a game with identical 4-0 records and neither was ranked?

"It's disrespectful to the ACC," Narduzzi said Monday.

If Narduzzi sounds a little touchy, maybe it's because he has grown increasingly annoyed about repeatedly hitting the same talking points to an audience not particularly interested in listening.

While he leans into the fight, part of him wonders why one always seems to be necessary.

Well, actually maybe he doesn't wonder.
SEE ACC FOOTBALL ON B10

THE DAY IN SPORTS

SPOTLIGHT: SOCCER

Ellis is the fitting hero for youthful Americans

U.S. 1,
CANADA 0

BY PATRICK DONNELLY
Associated Press

ST. PAUL, MINN. — Teenager Justin Ellis scored the only goal Tuesday as the United States completed a successful international window with a 1-0 victory over Canada.

It was the fourth victory in four friendlies for the Americans, who used the window to get a longer look at several young players who could play a role in the program's future. The U.S. starting lineup Tuesday had an average of just 21 caps, and the average age was 23 years, 156 days.

Ellis, a 19-year-old forward who plays professionally for Orlando of Major League Soccer, put the U.S. on the board in the 29th minute. A give-and-go between Alex Freeman and Malik Tillman created space down the right side before Freeman threw a cross in front of the net that Ellis tapped in for his second goal in three national team appearances.

Just 10 minutes earlier, Ellis — who also scored the opening goal

in a victory over Peru on Sept. 26 — was on the ground after a hard foul. He received treatment on the sideline but was still limping when he returned to the field shortly before he scored.

Canada is looking to build on its success after appearing in back-to-back World Cups for the first time. Earlier in this international window, the Canadians beat Chile, 2-1, in Toronto and blanked Peru, 2-0, in Montreal.

Meanwhile, in the past 10 days the U.S. beat Chile, Peru and Mexico by a combined total of 11-3.

U.S. Coach Mauricio Pochettino made six changes from the starting lineup in Friday's 3-0 win over Mexico in Glendale, Arizona. Seventeen-year-old phenom Cavan Sullivan, who became the youngest player to score for the Americans in that game, did not play against Canada.

Brian Schwake, who starts for Nashville, earned the clean sheet in goal. Schwake made three saves in his first start and second appearance for the U.S.

Schwake's biggest moment came in the 63rd minute when he tipped a close shot by Luc de Fougerolles off the crossbar.

The U.S. has 17 wins, 12 losses and 13 draws in all competitions against Les Rouges.



Teenager Justin Ellis, left, scored in the 29th minute for the United States. The team's lineup for the friendly had an average age of 23.

TELEVISION AND RADIO	
MLB PLAYOFFS – DIVISION ROUND	
4 p.m.	Game 3: Cleveland at Chicago White Sox • TBS
6 p.m.	Game 4: Los Angeles Dodgers at Atlanta • Fox Sports 1
8 p.m.	Game 3: Tampa Bay at New York Yankees • TBS
10 p.m.	Game 4 (if necessary): Milwaukee at San Diego • Fox Sports 1
WNBA PLAYOFFS – SEMIFINALS	
7:30 p.m.	Game 2: New York at Atlanta • ESPN
9:30 p.m.	Game 2: Las Vegas at Golden State • NBCSN, Peacock
NHL	
7:30 p.m.	Pittsburgh at Washington • TNT, WJFK (106.7 FM)
NBA PRESEASON	
7 p.m.	Minnesota vs. Indiana • NBA TV
10 p.m.	Golden State at Portland • NBA TV
COLLEGE FOOTBALL	
7 p.m.	Jacksonville State at Kennesaw State • CBS Sports Network
7:30 p.m.	New Mexico State at Florida International • ESPN2
GOLF	
11 p.m.	PGA Tour: Baycurrent Classic, first round • Golf Channel
SOCCER	
11 a.m.	Canadian Premier League: Supra du Québec at Inter Toronto • Fox Sports 2
7 p.m.	Canadian Premier League: Pacific FC at Forge • Fox Sports 2
TENNIS	
11:59 p.m.	ATP: Shanghai Masters, early rounds; WTA: China Open, quarterfinals • Tennis Channel
MEN'S COLLEGE SOCCER	
10 p.m.	Oregon State at Cal Baptist • ESPNU
WOMEN'S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL	
7 p.m.	SMU at Pittsburgh • ACC Network
7 p.m.	Texas A&M at Oklahoma • SEC Network

COLLEGE FOOTBALL Terps-Huskers error won't cost refs, Rhule

No disciplinary action will be taken against the Big Ten officials who worked the Maryland-Nebraska football game or against Cornhuskers Coach **Matt Rhule** for his postgame criticism of the crew, a conference spokesman said Tuesday.

The Big Ten said Monday that Nebraska's final point-after kick in Saturday's 48-23 home win was incorrectly officiated after a roughing-the-snapper penalty was called.

Because Nebraska missed the attempt, the penalty should have resulted in the Huskers retrying the attempt with the penalty yardage enforced as half the distance to the goal. However, the miss was allowed to stand, and the penalty yardage was incorrectly assessed on the ensuing kickoff.

"The Big Ten has been in contact with its officiating team from Saturday's game regarding the error and will continue to emphasize consistent application of the playing rules," the conference said in a statement.

Rhule indicated after the game that he expected to be fined for his criticism of officials. A combined 28 penalties were called, most in a game since 2021, and the Huskers were flagged 16 times.

"I thought it was ridiculous," Rhule said. "I thought it was poorly handled by the officials and poorly done by us. You've never heard me say that before, but I was frustrated today. There were things I've never had called before."

The officiating crew headed by referee **Jim Wharrie** also worked the controversial Western Michigan-Michigan game Sept. 5. ...

Missouri freshman offensive tackle **Johnnie "DJ" Jones** needs a heart transplant and is hospitalized at the Mayo Clinic in Jacksonville, Florida, Coach **Eli Drinkwitz** said. ...

Michigan tight end **Zack Marshall** apologized after messages attributed to him criticizing offensive coordinator **Jason Beck** leaked on social media following the Wolverines' 20-14 loss to Minnesota. ...

California Coach **Tosh Lupoi** confirmed he stripped offensive coordinator **Jordan Somerville** of play-calling duties and promoted passing game coordinator **Pat McCann** to the role at halftime of Saturday's loss to UNLV. ...

Dennis Franchione, the longtime coach who turned around TCU before stops at Alabama and Texas A&M, died at 75.

TENNIS In Tokyo, Alcaraz wins first title since return

Carlos Alcaraz required two tournaments after a 4½-month injury layoff to raise another trophy.

The third-ranked Alcaraz beat Jiri Lehecka, 7-6 (7-4), 6-4, on Tuesday to successfully defend his Japan Open title.

It was Alcaraz's third title of the year and his first since

winning in Doha, Qatar, in February. ...

Novak Djokovic was handed the China Open trophy after **Alex de Minaur** retired injured in the final.

Both players asked for medical timeouts after the opening set in Beijing. De Minaur had a groin issue and quit after winning the opening game of the second set.

With a 7-6 (7-3), 0-1 victory, the 39-year-old Djokovic extended his perfect record at the tournament to 34-0. ...

Top-ranked **Jannik Sinner** said he will be out for the rest of the year as he continues to deal with an injured right knee.

Sinner has not played since July, when he beat **Alexander Zverev** in the Wimbledon final.

PRO BASKETBALL Gray will be sidelined for Dream in Game 2

The Atlanta Dream ruled out guard **Allisha Gray** for Game 2 of the WNBA semifinals Wednesday night because of a hand injury.

Gray, a four-time all-star and Atlanta's leading scorer during the regular season, injured her left hand in the first quarter of Sunday's Game 1 victory over the New York Liberty. She briefly returned to action after going to the locker room but went down a second time after diving for a loose ball and did not return.

Dream Coach **Karl Smesko** said Gray is day-to-day and had an X-ray on her finger, though he said he had no information on it. ...

The Las Vegas Aces listed top reserve **Jewell Loyd** (leg) as doubtful for Game 2 of their semifinal series against the Golden State Valkyries, but **Stephanie Talbot** (leg) and **Dana Evans** (knee) might return to the lineup. ...

The Dream will play all of its home games in State Farm Arena, the home of the NBA's Atlanta Hawks, beginning next season after landing a multiyear agreement with the venue. ...

Europe's biggest basketball clubs snubbed an offer to team up with the NBA, raising the prospect of a battle for the continent's top teams, players and commercial riches. ...

Philadelphia 76ers center **Ariel Hukporti** tore his right Achilles tendon in Monday's preseason game against the New York Knicks. ...

Braiden Bell asked the Portland Trail Blazers, through his legal counsel, to reconsider their decision to fire him as their play-by-play announcer.

SOCCER Spain's unbeaten run is alive thanks to rally

Spain preserved its 2½-year unbeaten streak by rallying to beat host Croatia thanks to a clutch second-half double from super-sub **Mikel Merino**, while **Harry Kane** scored two more goals in another record-setting match for the England captain.

The marathon batch of Nations League matches ended with Merino — a star off the bench so many times for Spain in recent years — powering home an 88th-minute strike to complete the World Cup

champions' stirring recovery in a 2-1 win in Split.

Kane's brace in England's 3-0 win over the Czech Republic in London came during his record-tying 125th appearance for his country. It also took him to 91 international goals, extending his England record. ...

Son Heung-min became South Korea's all-time leading scorer when his 59th goal helped the team beat Uzbekistan, 2-0, in a home friendly in Yongin. ...

Cristiano Ronaldo said he will remain available to play for Portugal despite having walked out on the squad.

In a long statement issued through the Portuguese media, Ronaldo said recently hired coach **Jorge Jesus** had not been true to his word about when he would play the striker in the latest round of Nations League matches.

Still, the 41-year-old Ronaldo said he owed his teammates an apology and expects to receive a punishment. ...

A solution was found to keep **Giovanni Malagò** in charge of the beleaguered Italian soccer federation despite an irregularity in his election this year.

While Malagò was stripped of the presidency, he was named as the federation's emergency commissioner on an interim basis pending a new election. ...

FIFA knew before the World Cup that Congo goalkeeper **Lionel Mpassi** was ineligible when he played in multiple qualifying games and let him continue at the tournament, according to media reports.

HOCKEY Panthers' Barkov set to miss 6-8 weeks

Florida Panthers center **Aleksander Barkov** is expected to miss six to eight weeks with a left leg injury and will not require surgery, Coach **Paul Maurice** said.

Barkov was hurt in last week's overtime loss at the San Jose Sharks. It appeared his left knee — not the knee that needed to be surgically rebuilt last year — buckled on the play. ...

Montreal Canadiens forward **Ivan Demidov** will be out two to four weeks with a lower-body injury, the team said. ...

The winless Philadelphia Flyers signed gritty winger **Michael Bunting** in the hopes that he can give them a spark following some alarming early season struggles. ...

Dylan Larkin scored in his first game since asking for a trade, helping the Detroit Red Wings to a 5-3 home win over the Ottawa Senators.

Larkin was initially booed by the home crowd when he touched the puck on his first shift. The boos turned to cheers after his goal. ...

Nick Schmaltz scored his NHL-best fifth goal, and the Utah Mammoth relied on its proficient power play to beat the New Jersey Devils, 5-3, in Newark. ...

No. 1 draft pick **Gavin McKenna** scored his first NHL goal in the second period, and the host Toronto Maple Leafs turned back the Nashville Predators, 5-4, on **Auston Matthews**'s overtime goal.

BASEBALL McDowell, ex-all-star and counselor, dies

Sam McDowell, a six-time all-star who led the American League in strikeouts four times before becoming a counselor for athletes battling addiction issues and depression, died Monday at his home in The Villages, Florida. He was 84.

The left-hander's baseball career and post-career sobriety served as the inspiration for the character **Sam Malone** on the sitcom "Cheers."

McDowell spent his first 11 MLB seasons with Cleveland and also pitched for the San Francisco Giants, New York Yankees and Pittsburgh Pirates. He was 141-134 with a 3.17 ERA in 425 games (346 starts).

GOLF Furyk: Reed welcome to join Ryder Cup team

U.S. captain **Jim Furyk** said it would be "great" if **Patrick Reed** were among the 12 best Americans for the Ryder Cup next year in Ireland, even though Reed criticized Furyk's first captaincy after the 2018 loss in Paris.

Reed hasn't been on a Ryder Cup team since those 2018 matches, another debacle for the U.S. team that ended with Reed telling the New York Times that he should have been partners with **Jordan Spieth** and that Furyk should not have benched him twice that week. ...

Three-time Spanish Open champion **Jon Rahm** will not play in his home tournament this week as he waits for the birth of his fourth child.

WINTER SPORTS Giant slalom will be Shiffrin's new focus

Two-time Olympic slalom champion **Mikaela Shiffrin** will shift her focus from that discipline this season to turn more of her attention toward training for giant slalom and super-G events.

The ski racer announced her strategy in what she describes as a season of "exploration." She plans to push herself coming off a season where she won her second Olympic gold in slalom at the Milan Cortina Games and earned her ninth World Cup season title in the discipline.

The season kicks off Oct. 24 with a giant slalom race in Soelden, Austria.

OLYMPICS India and Qatar among bidders for '32 Games

India and Qatar finally got some clarity for their long-held ambitions to host the 2036 Olympics.

They are now in a formal contest with South Africa, South Korea, Germany, Hungary and Turkey. The International Olympic Committee set an Oct. 31 deadline for late arrivals to the contest.

In the open-ended process, the contenders also can target future Summer Games in 2040 and 2044.

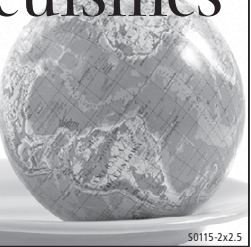
— From news services

Explore cuisines

Search our database of tested recipes by ingredient or name.

washingtonpost.com/recipes

The Washington Post



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NFL NOTES

Eagles tackle Johnson announces sudden retirement during his 14th season

FROM NEWS SERVICES

Philadelphia Eagles offensive lineman Lane Johnson announced his retirement from the NFL after 14 seasons.

“I have given it my all for 14 years,” Johnson said Tuesday in a statement, “season after season pushing my body to the max and tirelessly working my craft to not only live up to the legacy of the guys that came before me, but to set a new standard of success for the best franchise in all of sports.”

Johnson had been a late scratch for Sunday’s game against the Los Angeles Rams for personal reasons. He said Tuesday that despite wanting to finish the season, the “personal and family priorities in my life have changed.”

Johnson missed time in training camp for personal reasons before saying that this season would probably be his last.

“Lane Johnson is an all-time Eagle and one of the best players ever to play his position in NFL history,” Eagles owner Jeffrey Lurie said in a statement. “Lane was a major contributor to our team success for 14 seasons, helping to bring two Super Bowl championships and many other memorable moments to the organization and the city of Philadelphia.”

The 36-year-old Johnson was a first-round pick in 2013 and was a first-team all-pro in 2017 and 2022. He earned second-team honors in 2021, 2023 and 2024. Johnson has been a pillar at right tackle and won a pair of Super Bowls with the Eagles.



MATT ROURKE/AP

Lane Johnson had said 2026 would probably be his final NFL season, and he missed Sunday’s game against the Rams for personal reasons.

Johnson took a leave of absence during the 2021 season as he battled anxiety and depression and has since shared his story at mental health clinics in the area.

Johnson, a six-time Pro Bowl selection, said earlier this year his potential retirement came into focus last season after conversations with his family and an injury-filled season. He missed Philadelphia’s final seven regular season games and the first-round playoff loss to the

San Francisco 49ers.

“Right now, it is critical that I focus on my mental health,” Johnson said. “I owe it to my teammates, coaches, the organization and the fans to have my head and heart 100 percent in the game. And right now my heart is telling me that it’s time to say goodbye to football.”

•**SEAHAWKS:** Seattle decided against signing veteran running back Joe Mixon to its practice squad, ESPN reported.

Mixon worked out for the

Seahawks on Monday and underwent a physical. There is no word on what issue led them to reverse course on Mixon, who will remain a free agent.

Seattle’s only healthy running backs are Emanuel Wilson, George Holani and Velus Jones. Rookie running back Jadarian Price went on injured reserve last week, and Zach Charbonnet will work in team drills during practice this week but won’t play Sunday, Coach Mike Macdonald said.

Mixon, 30, is a two-time Pro Bowler who last played for the Houston Texans in 2024 following seven seasons with the Cincinnati Bengals. He missed the 2025 campaign with a foot injury and was released last March.

•**BRONCOS:** Cornerback Patrick Surtain II and wide receiver Pat Bryant’s injuries are less serious than first feared when the players each sprained an ankle during Denver’s loss at the San Francisco 49ers on Sunday, a person with knowledge of

the medical results told the Associated Press.

The person spoke on the condition of anonymity because the team hadn’t addressed the status of either player or the extent of their injuries. Either or both could end up on short-term IR, but the Broncos hadn’t made any moves yet.

•**GIANTS:** Wide receiver Braxton Berrios said he is having season-ending surgery on the injury that knocked him out of New York’s game Sunday against the Arizona Cardinals.

Coach John Harbaugh said Monday that Berrios was dealing with a foot or ankle injury from a punt return. Berrios was getting evaluated this week before the team needed to make the decision whether to put him on injured reserve.

•**RAVENS:** Tight end Durham Smythe will miss the remainder of the season after suffering a torn Achilles, NFL Network reported.

Smythe went down in Baltimore’s win over the Tennessee Titans on Sunday. The 31-year-old is primarily deployed as a blocker and had one catch for four yards this season.

•**MISC.:** The NFL Referees Association said it will challenge the severity of the suspensions of two officials for unprofessional conduct, which the officials union maintains went beyond appropriate punishment.

The league Monday suspended line judge Jeff Seeman for two games for swearing at the Arizona Cardinals’ Trey McBride and referee Adrian Hill for one game for yelling and gesturing at the Minnesota Vikings’ Eric Wilson.

Against their most bitter rival, Saints couldn’t do the ‘Domecoming’ justice

BY GUERRY SMITH

NEW ORLEANS — Quarterback Tyler Shough was “embarrassed.”

Second-year coach Kellen Moore was “disappointed” and “frustrated.”

And a day of festivities commemorating one of the most triumphant moments in New Orleans Saints history ended with boos and early exits.

Three plays into Monday night’s game against the Atlanta Falcons, running back Bijan Robinson silenced an electric Superdome crowd with a 59-yard touchdown run.

The Saints’ performance in a 45-24 loss to the Falcons bore no resemblance to their landmark 23-3 victory against the same team 20 years ago, when the Superdome finally reopened after being damaged by Hurricane Katrina.

On that made-for-TV night, Steve Gleason blocked a punt on the Falcons’ opening possession and Curtis DeLoatch recovered it for a touchdown, sending the Saints on their way.

This time, New Orleans held pregame ceremonies commemorating those magic moments two decades ago, with retired players Drew Brees, Scott Fujita, Scott Shanle, Deuce McAllister,



MORGAN SIMMONS/GETTY IMAGES

Quarterback Tyler Shough said the Saints’ 45-24 loss to the Falcons was “extremely disappointing.”

Devery Henderson and DeLoatch joining Gleason — now in a wheelchair because of ALS — on the field before kickoff to lead fans in the team’s familiar “Who dat!” chant.

Irma Thomas, a New Orleans native who sang the national anthem when the dome reopened,

reprised her role.

NFL Commissioner Roger Goodell even traveled to New Orleans to commemorate the “Domecoming” game he also attended in 2006.

Earlier in the day, New Orleans Mayor Helena Moreno (D) gave Gleason a key to the city.

Gleason later shared a moment with former Falcons punter Michael Koenen at the “Rebirth” statue outside the dome, which memorializes the famous punt block.

Then came the game itself — the first prime-time game in New Orleans in nearly two years.

“It’s extremely disappointing,” Shough said. “It’s embarrassing. I can’t say enough good things about fans showing up, the entire process, what this game meant and we fell short as a team. ... We’ve got to do better on all fronts.”

One of Gleason’s mottos is, “Never punt.”

The Falcons seemed to take that to heart, scoring their most points since a 48-33 victory against the Carolina Panthers in 2016. They didn’t punt after the first quarter and scored on their last six full possessions.

The Saints (1-3), who thought they had a breakthrough victory at the Baltimore Ravens two weeks ago, have followed that up with two straight losses at home.

“We’re all frustrated, all disappointed with where we’re at,” Moore said. “We’re going to have to learn from this one and move forward.”

Shough threw for 286 yards and wide receiver Chris Olave had eight catches for 116 yards, but New Orleans got points on only one of its five first-half drives, falling behind 24-7. After the Saints settled for a 27-yard field goal on their opening drive of the second half, the Falcons responded with a nine-play, 74-yard touchdown drive to go

ahead 31-10.

The dome started to empty out at that point, and it turned into a red-clan Atlanta fan celebration after the visitors scored another touchdown to go ahead 38-17 with 9:50 remaining.

“I love New Orleans. I love this place,” Shough said. “And you see the energy, the passion of everybody, the culture behind this place, and it sucks whenever you don’t come through on the field in that way, especially against our division rivals. It hurts me. I don’t want to feel like that ever again.”

Playing without injured defensive end Carl Granderson, linebacker Kaden Elliss and running back Travis Etienne, among others, New Orleans was no match for Atlanta. Bijan Robinson ran for 145 yards and two touchdowns, and Brian Robinson Jr. added three scoring runs.

After falling behind, New Orleans pretty much abandoned its ground game, finishing with 50 yards on 19 carries. Moore’s team fell a game behind NFC South coleaders Atlanta and Carolina.

“We squandered an opportunity, but we’ve got more opportunities,” Shough said. “You’ve got to kind of take it on the chin, and we’ll see them again.”

— Associated Press

Argentina marks final game for its greatest player

ARGENTINA 3, BENIN 0

BY ISABEL DEBRE

BUENOS AIRES — Argentina is confronting a once-unimaginable reality: a national team without soccer great Lionel Messi.

On Tuesday, 39-year-old Messi bid farewell to international soccer after 21 years, 126 goals, two Copa América titles and a World Cup championship, scoring a penalty and setting up Argentina’s other two goals for a 3-0 victory over Benin. What was otherwise an unremarkable friendly against the West African nation became a moment that this soccer-crazed country had long dreaded.

“Argentines often say, ‘Thank God I was born at a time when I could experience the miracle of watching Messi play,’” said Andrés Rabinovich, a University of Chicago scholar who has researched soccer’s role in Argentine culture. “It’s hard living in Argentina. Soccer is often one of the few things that offers you some respite, some joy.”

Argentines had an intense, often unforgiving relationship with the shy boy who left his hometown of Rosario at 13 for the youth academy of Spanish club Barcelona. As he grew into a global icon of near-mythical

stature, his compatriots adored and abused him, sometimes questioning his commitment to his home country and accusing him of indifference to it.

But by the time he ended his dazzling international career, his devotion to Argentina was no longer in question. Nor was Argentina’s devotion to its most famous export, whose triumphs reminded the country of its capacity for greatness through years of political and economic instability.

For years, Argentines had debated when and how Messi should leave the world stage. His Aug. 31 announcement that he would be retiring from the national team, weeks after Argentina’s loss to Spain in the World Cup final, prompted an outpouring of gratitude and grief — even as Messi will continue to light up MLS with Inter Miami.

“I don’t know if there has ever been a love story between a player and a nation as great as the one you built,” his teammate Rodrigo De Paul wrote on Instagram.

The Argentine soccer federation turned Tuesday’s game — Messi’s 208th — into a national farewell billed as “the last tango.” More than 85,000 tickets to Buenos Aires’ largest stadium sold out in 90 minutes, seats that were originally priced around \$60-\$300 later fetching more than \$2,500 on resale sites. Players from Argentina’s 1978, 1986

and 2022 World Cup-winning squads returned to see him off.

After the final whistle, Messi’s eyes glistened as his teammates gathered around him, applauding. A rumbling chorus of “Olé, olé, olé, olé, Messi, Messi” rose from the stands as tens of thousands of fans jumped, sang and bowed toward him as if in worship. A banner at midfield proclaimed him the “Eternal Captain.”

“Even through the worst moments we went through, I never stopped fighting, battling, giving everything I had, wanting to always be here,” Messi told the crowd, which roared as if he had scored. “I love all of you, and I will miss all of you. I am proud to be Argentine.”

During the 2000s and 2010s, Messi amassed trophies with his club and won die-hard fans from Barcelona to Bangladesh. Yet a major title for his own country eluded him. After Argentina lost a third straight final in 2016, he briefly quit the national team.

“There’s some resentment by the people that stay in Argentina for those who leave, this sense of, ‘They think they’re better than us,’” said Rabinovich, adding that he identifies with Messi as a fellow teenage migrant. Rabinovich said he moved to Canada during Argentina’s 2001 economic crisis, around the time Messi left for Europe.

The turning point came in 2021, when Argentina beat Bra-

zil to win the Copa América, South America’s championship, for the first time in 28 years. Messi collapsed to the turf as his teammates, delirious, ran to hug him. The player long accused of feeling too little could not stop sobbing.

“Winning clearly disarmed his critics. That’s how soccer works in Argentina,” said Diego Murzi, a sports sociologist at Conicet, Argentina’s national scientific research council. “Criticism of things off the field goes hand in hand with defeats on it.”

The World Cup victory the following year in Qatar sealed his place as a national hero. Messi had delivered the one prize that had eluded him, and millions of Argentines poured into the streets in collective ecstasy.

Across Argentina, fans who grew up watching Messi as their parents watched Diego Maradona have covered their skin with tattooed tributes to the soccer great, portraits of him kissing the World Cup trophy. It was easy to believe the world’s greatest player would always be one of their own.

“I don’t think we’ll have somebody like him again, somebody with that sort of enduring power,” said Pablo Brescia, a University of South Florida professor who writes about Argentine culture and soccer. “Like Maradona, he’ll be unique — a figure that can’t be repeated.”

— Associated Press



GUSTAVO GARELLO/AP PHOTO/GUSTAVO GARELLO

Argentina’s Lionel Messi converted a penalty in his final game for the national team, a blowout friendly victory in Buenos Aires.



“We’re as healthy as we’ve ever been,” Commissioner Jim Phillips said Tuesday afternoon at ACC basketball media days in Charlotte.

ACC head preaches calm amid schools’ lobbying

ACC LETTER FROM B7

those that have written the bill to date.”

Florida State and Clemson filed lawsuits against the ACC in 2023 and 2024, respectively, to challenge the league’s ability to levy hundreds of millions in exit fees on members that want to leave. The conference counter-sued. The parties ultimately settled the case in early 2025 with a deal that revised long-term exit costs while also revamping the ACC’s revenue-distribution model as a way for schools generating the highest TV ratings to earn more money.

That has been part of a series of changes by the league to bolster the financial picture while facing a growing gap behind the Big Ten and SEC, though still finishing ahead of the Big 12 among the Power Four. The ACC reported about \$826.5 million in total revenue in tax filings covering the 2024-25 sports season, with schools earning a full distribution share getting an average of \$47.1 million.

That continued an upward trajectory from \$617 million for 2021-22 in Phillips’s first full season, good for a full-share average of \$39.4 million. Meanwhile, the Big Ten and SEC both crossed the \$1 billion mark in total revenue in their 2024-25 filings, with the Big Ten paying an average of nearly \$80 million to full-share members while the SEC came in at

more than \$73 million.

The ACC’s legal settlement with Clemson and Florida State helped make 2030-31 a significant marker. The ACC’s exit fee will decline each year before leveling off around \$75 million per school that year, while media deals for other leagues are expiring around that time to create at least the potential for another wave of broad realignment.

Provisions in any new law could make that harder, starting with membership caps that could limit the available landing spots. In addition, requiring a school to operate as an independent for a defined period after leaving a league would mean missing formerly guaranteed media payouts before being able to cash in elsewhere.

“I’ve been very consistent about I have always tried to make sure that this was a conference that people wanted to be in, and I’m really proud of what we’ve done,” Phillips said. “We’re as healthy as we’ve ever been.”

Phillips declined to discuss “hypotheticals” when asked whether he was concerned about whether this was a sign of multiple schools intending to leave.

“The conference is in a good place,” he said. “Healthy, functioning, achieving at a high level. We’ll see where all this takes us. So you have to be ready. You have to be ready for anything. But I feel good about where we’re at, and we’ll see what this bill ends up doing.”

Pittsburgh’s Narduzzi comes to his league’s defense

ACC FOOTBALL FROM B7

“I think it’s all the brands,” Narduzzi said, seemingly alluding to the Big Ten and the SEC. “Everybody wants to look at the logo and gets all infatuated with logos and all that stuff.”

The Big Ten has six teams ranked this week. The SEC has nine. The ACC? Just three: No. 4 Miami, with SMU at 24, one spot ahead of the Panthers.

Narduzzi knows a part of him is trying to have it both ways. He repeatedly said in September that the early-season polls don’t matter. Yet he knows he’s in the minority, and it’s much easier for him now at 60 to put the poll in what he considers the proper perspective.

As if to prove a point, he made a not-so-veiled reference to an unnamed program that had a number next to its name earlier in the season, a number that has since vanished.

“I mean, you look at the school down the road gets into the top 25, and what did they really do to get into the top 25?” he said.

Asked later whom he was referring to, Narduzzi just laughed, though longtime rivals West Virginia and Penn State both fit the profile.

The Nittany Lions and first-year coach Matt Campbell started the season ranked 18th and rose after opening with three uneventful wins against lesser competition. Two conference losses later, and Penn State is out of the polls and Campbell’s honeymoon at his alma mater is over.

West Virginia made a cameo in the top 25 after throttling Virginia on Sept. 18, only to have its defense implode in back-to-back weeks.

There’s still plenty of time for narratives to change, particularly at Pitt. Narduzzi’s team will have to play the rest of the season without quarterback Mason Heintschel, who tore the ACL in his right knee in the third quarter against the Hokies.

Still, the Panthers are hardly the only ACC team off to a promising start yet unable to make serious inroads in an effort to change the perception of the league.

Wake Forest is 4-1, with its lone loss a game effort against the Hurricanes. The Demon Deacons edged an improved Purdue team by two on the road earlier in the season, did the same



Coach Pat Narduzzi and the Panthers are 5-0 but ranked just 25th in the latest Associated Press poll.

to disappointing Louisville and crushed Stanford by 54 points on Saturday, the biggest blow-out win in conference play for a charter member in ACC history. Duke is unbeaten at 4-0 with a victory at Illinois on its résumé.

Neither the Demon Deacons nor the Blue Devils are ranked.

Narduzzi tried to spend a rare Saturday off seeing how the other half lives, intending to watch some Big Ten and SEC games. His remote kept finding its way to some of the remaining teams on Pitt’s schedule, including North Carolina, which visits Pitt on Saturday.

What he sees, admittedly with some bias, is good football in a league that will spend the next two months beating up on each other trying to keep pace with the Hurricanes, the CFP runner-up last season who look even better this fall.

“Your stomach starts to turn, and you’re like, ‘Golly, we’ve got a lot of work ahead,’” Narduzzi said.

The ACC would like the conversation around the league to

evolve to the point in which an in-conference loss doesn’t send a team’s stock tumbling. Voters extended that courtesy to Mississippi State this week, which dropped just one spot after getting drilled at home by SEC rival Alabama by 33.

It doesn’t appear to be there yet, as the bid for national relevance instead of national curiosity drones on.

Three years ago, the CFP committee left unbeaten Florida State out of the then-four-team playoff after quarterback Jordan Travis was hurt late in the season. Two years ago, SMU received the lone ACC bid as the 11th seed when the CFP expanded to 12 teams. Last year, Miami shook off a pair of midseason losses to SMU and Louisville that cost the Hurricanes a spot in the ACC championship to make the CFP as the 10th seed and make it all the way to the title game.

By the time the Hurricanes reached the final, the nip/tuck nature of their at-large bid was largely forgotten.

Yet instead of Miami’s success

serving as a stamp of approval that the league as a whole is legit, it seems to merely have certified the impression that “The U” is back. The rest of the conference it plays in, seemingly not so much.

So Narduzzi will keep banging the drum, even while facing a stretch run that looks far more daunting without the promising Heintschel.

Maybe Pitt remains in the mix to the end with well-traveled senior Holden Gernier behind center. Maybe it doesn’t. The one thing Narduzzi is sure of is that whoever emerges at the top of the ACC standings come early December is worthy of consideration and then some, be it in the polls or anywhere else.

Asked whether he feels his almost defiant stance is as much about saying the quiet part out loud for an entire league as it is for the program he has run for 146 games and counting, he nodded.

“Absolutely,” the fourth-longest tenured Power Four coach said. “Absolutely.”

Sanders made Colorado matter again, but sustained success has been elusive

SANDERS FROM B7

guitar,” Wilhite said of the magnetic former coach. “My mom was so mad I wouldn’t go to Emory or Georgia or anywhere else. I wanted to go to Colorado.”

Colorado is lucky he came.

Wilhite didn’t want to disclose and, frankly, probably couldn’t even nail down how much money he has poured into the school’s athletic department over the years.

But when the referee uses replay to review close calls at Buffaloes games, the massive scoreboards inside Folsom Field — enlarged as one of the school’s first big projects after Sanders’s arrival — kill time by reminding fans that replays are brought to them by none other than Wilhite’s law firm.

Generous as he is, Wilhite is also well aware Colorado football could use 10 or 20 more folks just like him.

He loves Sanders, whose .429 winning percentage at Colorado would get a coach fired at Michigan or Alabama, no questions asked. But in the hours before the Texas Tech game, Wilhite was talking about getting more help for the coach, not firing him.

“We need more people to come out and understand that we’re a young program, and we need to develop it more,” Wilhite said. “I think part of the problem is, we can’t get a lot of donors to donate.”

The NIL arms race

Wilhite knows what name, image and likeness payments to players in this new era of college sports have done not only to his own experience but to the Colorado roster and college football itself.

“The problem is, at Colorado, as soon as we have a player who does really well, they get bought,” he said.

He ticks off a few: Dylan Edwards left for Kansas State. Jordan Seaton went to LSU. DJ McKinney is now at Notre Dame. More bankroll might have helped Sanders stop some of those departures.

Either way, the coach has made Colorado football matter



Buffaloes Coach Deion Sanders lost several prominent players to the transfer portal in the offseason.

again and stoked a new energy on campus. It impacts the way so many people think and act and, yes, spend at the school and on the athletic program.

For example, one of the reasons now-retired athletic director Rick George gave for ripping out grass and installing artificial turf at Folsom Field before this season was that it would make it easier if Colorado might someday host a College Football Playoff game.

It won’t happen this year.

A billionaire’s son visits

No one seemed surprised to see Cody Campbell hugging it out with Sanders on the visitors’ sideline before the game.

Campbell is the billionaire head of the Texas Tech board of regents and also one of college football’s most influential voices. He has worked tirelessly to promote a bill in Congress — the Protect College Sports Act — that could shift the out-of-control spending dynamics in college sports.

If the bill passes and puts guardrails around what schools can spend, that would most likely help the Colorados of the world — the schools that don’t have billionaire donors — at the expense of the Texas Techs, the schools that do.

Campbell was wearing more than his regent’s hat at this one. He was here with the family. His son, Carson, an offensive lineman at All Saints’ Episcopal in Fort Worth, was on a recruiting visit.

Part of the beauty of Sanders — whose most recent contract extension was worth \$54 million through 2029 and who got Colorado to revamp its admission policies so he could recruit a wider range of players — is that he stirs the pot and generates almost endless headlines about the once-lost brand known as Colorado football. He is also okay with taking the heat when things go bad, which has been a lot lately.

But then something such as Saturday happens: A formidable

leader from a conference rival — a man who should want Sanders and Colorado to flounder, if not outright fail — shows up with his kid.

“I love him,” Campbell says of Sanders.

Why?

“I think he understands the part of developing boys into men,” Campbell said. “Ninety-plus percent of these guys aren’t going to go play in the NFL. They’ll go on and do something else. He’s preparing them for that. I wouldn’t have brought my son to a place where they didn’t have that vision.”

A failing experiment at QB

The Texas Tech score sounds like a blowout but was, in fact, something quite different for more than three quarters.

This game did not play out like the physical mismatch that some might have expected when one team, with every resource in the world available to recruit top talent, plays another with a star coach but not as much money to

spend.

Colorado, a 14-point underdog, did not get blown off the line of scrimmage. The Buffs actually gained 60 more yards than Tech.

Sometimes, the best coaches figure a way to lead their teams to upsets in games such as these, especially at home. A deeper dive into the stat sheet and the play calls makes clear this was not the Colorado coaching staff’s finest moment.

The Buffaloes were penalized eight times for 84 yards, including one for taunting and two personal fouls. They averaged 82.6 penalty yards a game to lead the Big 12, 15 more than the next-worst team.

They also missed two field goals, came up short on a strangely timed fake punt and committed four turnovers, including an interception thrown by a wide receiver on a trick play that looked bad from the start.

Most of Colorado’s problems, however, stem from one issue: quarterback. Sanders started Isaac Wilson, a transfer from Utah, in an offense designed for five-star recruit Julian Lewis, who was supposed to be the heir to the position that Sanders’s son, Shedeur, revived at Colorado.

Sanders hired Brennan Marion from Sacramento State as offensive coordinator and Marion brought his “Go-Go Offense” to Boulder. But Lewis struggled at times over his first three and a half games, and Sanders made a change that, so far, has not worked.

“We’ve got one glaring problem,” Sanders said after the game. “You guys know darn well what it is. Let’s stop the foolishness. You better play better in one specific position.”

Buffaloes risk backsliding

During his 20 minutes with the media after the game, Sanders was unflinching about the quarterback issue, somehow identifying the obvious problem without throwing his quarterbacks directly under the bus. The Buffaloes are on a three-game skid in which they have scored seven, 13 and seven points.

“We’ve been horrible,”

Sanders said. “Don’t sugarcoat it anymore, just tell what it is. You’re not going to win. You know darn well what it is. Write it yourselves. You know what it is. It’s blatant. Ain’t no ifs ands or buts about it.”

What Sanders didn’t know at the time was that Colorado’s quarterback crisis was the runner-up for the biggest college football trainwreck in the state Saturday.

An hour northeast of Boulder in Fort Collins, first-year Colorado State coach Jim Mora relieved his defensive coordinator, Tyson Summers, of play-calling duties while a 56-26 trouncing at the hands of Oregon State was still going on. Summers walked off the field, then got fired after the game.

Meanwhile, 45 minutes south in Denver, the Broncos and their fans were making sense of an exciting 2-1 start and getting ready for Sunday’s game against the San Francisco 49ers. (They lost, 24-14.)

Those headlines served as a reminder of what Colorado is at heart: a state that loves the Broncos, and where it takes something large, intriguing, magnetic — or, like a trainwreck — to shift the attention of its sports fans.

All those elements lined up when Sanders arrived. With the Broncos coming off their sixth straight losing season, “Coach Prime” brought celebrities to the sideline and his sons and a Heisman Trophy winner in the making, Travis Hunter, to the field. He injected life into a program that had been ignored and irrelevant for a decade or more.

Over a lifetime in football, Sanders has been a lot of things — electric, divisive, a game-changer. “Ignored” has never been part of that list.

That’s what made the scene toward the end of Saturday night’s game all the more jarring. Fans were streaming up the stairs and bailing out of Folsom Field. With half the fourth quarter left to play, they were turning their backs on Colorado football and Coach Prime.

“I can’t blame them,” Sanders said. “They deserve more than this bullshit we give them.”

GOLF NOTES

LPGA Tour plants its flag in Kapalua as the Lotte Championship relocates

BY DOUG FERGUSON

The PGA Tour lost Kapalua on Maui as a season opener when a water dispute left the Plantation course unplayable, and then it played the Sony Open in Honolulu for the last time to avoid having one tournament in the middle of the Pacific Ocean.

But that's hardly the end of professional golf in Hawaii.

Kapalua is back in the fold with the announcement that the Lotte Championship is moving from Hoakalei on Oahu to the Plantation course, which had hosted a PGA Tour event starting in 1999.

The Lotte Championship moves from October to March 18-21, one week after the new Nanea Cup on the Big Island, which will have 95 players from the LPGA Tour and 25 players from five colleges competing concurrently in separate tournaments.

"As we continue to strengthen the LPGA Tour schedule, venues with deep-rooted heritage like Kapalua are exactly what we look for," LPGA Commissioner Craig Kessler said.

The LPGA was at Kapalua for one year in 2008, won by Morgan Pressel on the Bay course. The Plantation course has more than 25 years of memories, from Tiger Woods beating Ernie Els in a playoff in 2000 to Hideki Matsuyama setting the PGA Tour's record score to par at 35 under in 2025, the final year it was played.

March also is the last month before the humpback whales — Kapalua is famous for its views of them breaching in the Pacific — head north toward Alaska.

"Kapalua is an incredible venue to showcase the beauty of Hawaii and everything that makes the islands so special," said Alisen Corpuz, a Hawaii native and the 2023 U.S. Women's Open champion.

The PGA Tour Champions also has a two-week Aloha swing. It picked up the Sony Championship at Waialae to go along with its Mitsubishi Electric Championship on the Big Island.

Big names in the Motor City

The newest team for the indoor golf league TGL at SoFi Center in South Florida is al-



GREGORY SHAMUS/GETTY IMAGES

The Plantation course on Kapalua, which had hosted a PGA Tour event for more than 25 years, will host the Lotte Championship in March.

ready off to a big start in filling the roster.

The Motor City Golf Club started with Brooks Koepka, a five-time major champion who returned to the PGA Tour this year. This week, it announced the addition of Jackson Koivun, who in four months led Auburn to the NCAA golf title, won his first PGA Tour title in his third start as a pro and then went unbeaten in the Presidents Cup.

The Detroit-based club is the first expansion team for TGL and makes its debut early next year.

"With Jackson and Brooks, we have an amazing foundation for what we are trying to build," said Michael Hamp, the team governor of Motor City.

Meanwhile, TMRW Sports announced an extension of its U.S. media rights agreement with ESPN, which has been the network for TGL since it began two years ago.

Korn Ferry Tour finale

The Korn Ferry Tour ends its season with the Tour Championship, and eight of the 20 cards for the PGA Tour in 2027 already have been secured. Blades Brown, who turned pro while still in high school and has contended on the Korn Ferry Tour and PGA Tour this year, is at No. 14 and seemingly would be safe to be in the big leagues next year.

Holding down the 20th spot is Cole Hammer, who is just over five points ahead of Yuta Sugiura of Japan. Sugiura originally was in the field for the Baycurrent Classic in Japan, but he withdrew because of his position on the Korn Ferry points list.

Sugiura last week became the fourth player in Korn Ferry Tour history with a 58 or lower.

Also at stake this week is a fight for No. 1. Sandy Scott won in Oklahoma last week to overtake Ross Steelman on the points list by a mere 24 points. The leading player gets into The Players Championship and the

U.S. Open next year.

The ageless Langer

Bernhard Langer is in the field for the Constellation Fyrk & Friends on the PGA Tour Championships, marking his return to the Ocean Course at the Hammock Beach Golf Resort.

But it's been a minute.

Langer was 50 when he won the Ginn Championship at Hammock Beach for his third career PGA Tour Champions title. Ginn dropped its sponsorship the following year.

The Fyrk & Friends, previously held at Timuquana Country Club in Jacksonville, Florida, moves to Hammock Beach about 60 miles down the Atlantic coast this year. Langer, the previous player to win on the Jack Nicklaus design, returns 18 years later at age 69 and goes for his 48th Champions title.

Following the Ryder Cup

The European tour schedule

for 2027 had one curious shift of tournaments. The BMW PGA Championship, the flagship event on the tour, is moving to the week after the Ryder Cup in Ireland.

The flagship event for years was held in May until it was moved to September in 2019. For the next three Ryder Cups — one in Italy in 2023, the other two in the United States — the BMW PGA Championship has been held two weeks before the matches.

The schedule change allows for the Ryder Cup at Adare Manor next year to be Sept. 17-19. It will be preceded by the European Masters in Switzerland and the French Open. It also means 12 very happy — or very sad — Europeans go to flagship events with a hangover, literal or figurative.

It's reminiscent of 2008, when the PGA Tour rearranged its schedule for the Ryder Cup at Valhalla. There were three FedEx

Cup playoff events, followed by a week off and then the Ryder Cup. The Tour Championship was the week after Valhalla.

The Americans won, there was a great celebration. And then the top 30 headed to East Lake. That was the year Vijay Singh only had to finish 72 holes to claim the FedEx Cup. It also was the year Kentucky native Kenny Perry showed how little he wanted to be there.

"I don't want to be here — don't want nothing to do with this deal," Perry said that week. "It's ruined the greatest week of my life coming here. I don't want to play golf. I want to go home and celebrate. I'm physically tired. I have no focus. I don't even care. I'm just trying to get my last-place check, post a 72-hole number and go home."

He tied for 24th, collected \$120,400 and went home.

Divots

Along with having world No. 1 Scottie Scheffler as its defending champion, The American Express will have the Zac Brown Band and Train performing on consecutive nights after the second and third rounds at PGA West in the California desert. ...

George McNeill is No. 7 on the Charles Schwab Cup and still needed an exemption to get into the Constellation Fyrk & Friends this week. The good news for McNeill? The top 36 at the end of the season are fully exempt for next year. ...

Xander Schauffele brought 1-year-old son Victor to the Baycurrent Classic in Japan for grandparents on both sides — his mother and his wife's mother grew up in Japan — to see him for the first time.

Stat of the week

Jeenno Thitikul of Thailand needed only 101 starts on the LPGA to surpass \$20 million in career earnings. She is \$30,163 ahead of Christie Kerr, who played in 609 tournaments.

Final word

"That means I need to pay more tax." — Thitikul on surpassing \$20 million in career earnings.

— Associated Press

Offseason autopsy could lead to change for Orioles

ORIOLES FROM B7

Trade Rumors. Should he decline it, the Orioles would receive draft pick compensation for 2027.

Starting pitcher Chris Bassitt: After joining the Orioles on a one-year, \$18.5 million deal early in spring training, Bassitt appeared in 20 games (18 starts) and put up a 4.59 ERA. He missed more than two months recovering from back surgery and responded well to the procedure, posting a 3.74 ERA after his return — more in line with his career statistics. Bassitt, 37, is mulling his future and whether to retire after pitching in parts of 12 seasons at the MLB level.

Reliever Andrew Kittredge: Baltimore's unlikely saves leader with 11 this season, Kittredge was a solid back-end reliever who was often thrust into ninth-inning situations because of injuries. The Orioles acquired Kittredge, 36, each of the past two offseasons, first by free agency then via trade, but it's unclear whether the club would be interested in another reunion with both closers Ryan Helsley and Félix Bautista expected to be fully healthy next spring.

Reliever Keegan Akin: Akin, 31, underwent Tommy John elbow reconstruction surgery in July, knocking him out for the rest of the 2026 season and most of 2027 as well. It was ill-timed for the left-hander, who is hitting free agency for the first time this offseason. Akin will probably be searching for a two-year deal this winter to see him through his recovery.

(Note: The Orioles also had several minor leaguers eligible for free agency, including catcher Sam Huff, infielder Luis Vázquez and left-hander Andrew Magno.)

Team options/opt-outs (5)

Reliever Ryan Helsley: Helsley's first season in Baltimore was derailed by injuries, making him a strong candidate to pick up his \$14 million player option for 2027. The 32-year-old appeared in only 17 games, and his 4.11 ERA didn't pop off the page, but he averaged 98.7 mph on his fastball and had a 30.9 percent strikeout rate. If healthy, he and Bautista could form a formidable late-inning duo in the back end of the Orioles' bullpen.

Starting pitcher Zach Eflin: Eflin's contract has a \$25 million mutual option for 2027 with a



DANIEL KUCIEN JR./IMAGN IMAGES

Impending free agent Trevor Rogers could be in line for a deal from the Orioles after pitching to a 4.03 ERA in 30 starts this season.

\$2 million buyout, and he's probably headed back to free agency after having Tommy John surgery in April. The right-hander made only one start for the Orioles this season after back surgery cut his 2025 campaign short, and while he should be ready for an MLB return by midseason next year, it might not be in Baltimore this time.

Outfielder Luis Robert Jr.: The Orioles claimed Robert off waivers from the New York Mets at the end of August, and he played just three games before a hamstring injury sent him to the injured list for good. Baltimore has a \$2 million buyout on a \$20 million team option, a hefty cost for a player who has been plagued with injuries while largely underperforming the past three seasons.

First baseman Ryan Mountcastle: Another player with bad injury luck, Mountcastle broke a bone in his foot running the bases April 11 and suffered a significant oblique strain warming up for his first rehabilitation game in July. He wound up playing only eight games after the Orioles avoided arbitration by

re-signing him to a one-year deal with a \$7.5 million team option for 2027. If he returns to the Orioles again this offseason, it will almost certainly be at a lower cost.

Reliever Dietrich Enns: The Orioles outrighted Enns to Class AAA Norfolk on May 31, but they still hold a team option for 2027 with a \$3.5 million salary in the majors and a \$125,000 buyout. Though he put up a serviceable 3.94 ERA in 13 appearances before going through waivers, Enns struggled mightily in Norfolk (5.80 ERA over 31 games) and didn't make it back to the majors.

Positions of need

The Orioles have needs all over the roster, and yet every position is filled. Unlike in previous seasons, in which the departure of players such as Ryan O'Hearn and Anthony Santander created clear holes Elias and his front office needed to fill, Baltimore might need to orchestrate a few roster shakeups to upgrade its on-field product.

Perhaps the most glaring area is in the outfield, where the

Orioles compiled 4.0 wins above replacement this season — 25th in the majors, according to FanGraphs. Colton Cowser, Leody Taveras, Tyler O'Neill, Dylan Beavers and Heston Kjerstad make up the Orioles' projected outfield, with O'Neill still owed \$16.5 million for 2027 and Kjerstad out of minor league options.

However, none of them showed enough this season for Baltimore to confidently pencil them into next year's Opening Day lineup. The group also skews left-handed, making a right-handed outfielder — preferably one who can play center field — a need, regardless of the ripple effects such a move might create.

Other than acquiring a backup catcher to help get Samuel Basallo off his feet, the Orioles would be hard-pressed to further upgrade their lineup if they stand pat on the infield. Pete Alonso and Gunnar Henderson are entrenched at first base and shortstop, respectively. Elias gave Jackson Holliday a public vote of confidence at second in the end-of-season news conference, and the Orioles will have several options to choose from at third between Blaze Alexander, Jordan Westburg, Coby Mayo and Christian Encarnacion-Strand.

What the Orioles do in the rotation hinges first on whether they retain Rogers, their Opening Day starter in 2026. This offseason's starting pitcher market is weaker than usual outside of Tarik Skubal, who could set records with his upcoming payday. The best starters behind him will be Rogers, Michael King, Sonny Gray, Freddy Peralta, Shota Imanaga, Kevin Gausman and perhaps Nick Martinez if his mutual option is declined.

Kyle Bradish, Shane Baz and Brandon Young are the only locks to open next season in the Orioles' rotation, with Trey Gibson, Cade Povich, Luis De León, Michael Porrett and Nestor German in the mix. Top pitching prospects Anthony Eyanson and Joseph Dzierwa aren't too far behind, either, after they both dominated Class AA this year.

The Orioles could also use another proven late-inning arm to pad the back end of their bullpen, but the unit as a whole was a bright spot in 2026, and it might even be a strength next season if Helsley and Bautista return to form.

MLB ROUNDUP

Yamamoto, Los Angeles seize 2-1 lead in NLDS

DODGERS 3,
BRAVES 1

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Yoshinobu Yamamoto struck out 10 in seven brilliant innings, Kiké Hernández hit a two-run homer, and the visiting Los Angeles Dodgers beat the Atlanta Braves, 3-1, on Tuesday night to take a 2-1 lead in their National League Division Series.

Yamamoto dominated the much-anticipated matchup with Atlanta ace Chris Sale, who allowed three runs and seven hits in five innings. Yamamoto, the MVP of the 2025 World Series, permitted only four hits with one walk while improving to 8-1 with a 2.14 ERA in 11 career postseason outings, including 10 starts.

His 10 strikeouts were a postseason high for the Japanese right-hander.

The Dodgers can win the best-of-five series and take another step in their attempt to become the first National League team to win three consecutive World Series titles by beating the Braves again Wednesday night in Game 4.

The Braves hoped giving Sale extra rest would be a winning formula in the pivotal third game. Instead, after stranding six runners in the first three innings, he gave up the two-run

homer to Hernández and a solo shot to former Braves star Freddie Freeman in the fourth.

Ozzie Albies opened the Atlanta ninth with a double off the right-center wall against Edwin Díaz and moved to third on Michael Harris II's groundout. Díaz stranded the runner when Mauricio Dubón fouled out to right field and Mike Yastrzemski grounded out to shortstop Mookie Betts.

Miller on paternity list

Closer Mason Miller went on the postseason paternity list with the San Diego Padres facing elimination against the Milwaukee Brewers in Game 3 of the NLDS, which ended too late for this edition.

The intimidating all-star reliever will miss at least one game, the Padres announced about 45 minutes before the first pitch. Wandy Peralta replaced Miller on the 26-man playoff roster.

Miller was one of the best closers in the majors this season for the Padres. With a fastball that regularly touches 104 mph, Miller converted 38 of his 41 save opportunities and went 5-2 with a 0.90 WHIP and 129 strikeouts over just 70 innings.

But Miller also blew the save in the ninth inning of the Padres' 4-3 loss to the Brewers in Milwaukee last Sunday, putting San Diego in an 0-2 hole in the best-of-five series.



MIKE STEWART/AP

Kiké Hernández, far left, returns to the dugout after blasting a two-run home run in the fourth inning Tuesday night in Atlanta.

SCOREBOARD

PRO FOOTBALL

NFL

NFC

EAST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
N.Y. Giants	1	0	0	.750	82	79
Philadelphia	2	2	0	.500	75	93
Dallas	2	2	0	.500	122	112
Washington	1	3	0	.250	88	122

SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
Carolina	2	2	0	.500	121	109
Atlanta	2	2	0	.500	96	92
New Orleans	1	3	0	.250	105	128
Tampa Bay	0	4	0	.000	76	96

NORTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
Minnesota	4	0	0	1.000	86	51
Cincinnati	3	1	0	.750	112	65
Detroit	2	2	0	.500	119	127
Green Bay	2	2	0	.500	73	105

WEST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
San Francisco	4	0	0	1.000	122	64
Seattle	3	1	0	.750	105	73
L.A. Rams	2	2	0	.500	85	83
Arizona	1	3	0	.250	87	117

EAST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
Buffalo	3	1	0	.750	127	107
New England	2	2	0	.500	65	77
N.Y. Jets	1	3	0	.250	76	84
Miami	0	4	0	.000	46	101

SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
Jacksonville	3	1	0	.750	104	53
Indianapolis	2	2	0	.500	104	104
Tennessee	0	4	0	.000	55	83
Houston	0	4	0	.000	84	109

NORTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
Cleveland	3	1	0	.750	81	95
Baltimore	2	2	0	.500	116	96
Pittsburgh	2	2	0	.500	77	87
Cincinnati	2	2	0	.500	97	85

WEST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
Kansas City	4	0	0	1.000	118	77
Las Vegas	3	1	0	.750	115	84
Denver	2	2	0	.500	74	94
L.A. Chargers	0	4	0	.000	67	106

THURSDAY'S RESULT

Cleveland 27, Pittsburgh 24

SUNDAY'S RESULTS

Indianapolis 30, Washington 13, London, GBR
at Baltimore 24, Tennessee 18
at Chicago 23, N.Y. Jets 12
Dallas 34, at Houston 30
New England 17, at Tampa Bay 14
Jacksonville 27, at Cincinnati 17
L.A. Rams 24, at Philadelphia 20
at N.Y. Giants 36, Arizona 24
New England 29, at Buffalo 26
at Minnesota 15, Miami 10
Kansas City 30, at Las Vegas 27
at San Francisco 24, Denver 14
at Seattle 30, L.A. Chargers 23
at Carolina 32, Detroit 26

MONDAY'S RESULT

Atlanta 45, New Orleans 24

THURSDAY, OCT. 8

Tampa Bay at Dallas, 8:15 p.m.

SUNDAY, OCT. 11

Philadelphia vs Jacksonville at London, GBR, 9:30 a.m.
Chicago at Green Bay, 1 p.m.
Cincinnati at Miami, 1 p.m.
Cleveland at N.Y. Jets, 1 p.m.
Houston at Tennessee, 1 p.m.
Indianapolis at Pittsburgh, 1 p.m.
Las Vegas at New England, 1 p.m.
Minnesota at New Orleans, 1 p.m.
N.Y. Giants at Washington, 1 p.m.
Denver at L.A. Chargers, 4:05 p.m.
Oakland at Arizona, 4:25 p.m.
San Francisco at Seattle, 4:25 p.m.
Baltimore at Atlanta, 8:20 p.m.
Open: Kansas City, Carolina

MONDAY, OCT. 12

Buffalo at L.A. Rams, 8:15 p.m.

Falcons 45, Saints 24

LATE MONDAY

ATLANTA	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA
NEW ORLEANS	14	0	7	3	14	45

FIRST QUARTER

Atlanta: Bl. Robinson 59 run (Folk kick), 13:24. Drive: 4 plays, 80 yards, 1:26. Key Play: Penix 12 pass to D. London.
Atlanta: Bl. Robinson 4 run (Folk kick), .48. Drive: 5 plays, 22 yards, 2:05. Key Play: Bl. Robinson 3 run on 3rd-and-7.

SECOND QUARTER

New Orleans: Kamara 3 run (Carlson kick), 14:57. Drive: 4 plays, 54 yards, 00:48. Key Plays: Price kick return to New Orleans 46; Shough 44 pass to Olave.
Atlanta: Bl. Robinson 4 run (Folk kick), 8:59. Drive: 11 plays, 45 yards, 5:58. Key Plays: Bl. Robinson 3 run on 3rd-and-1; Penix 27 pass to D. London.
Atlanta: FG Folk 29, 30:7. Drive: 10 plays, 75 yards, 4:45. Key Play: Penix 37 pass to D. London; Bl. Robinson 11 run; Penix 10 pass to Pitts.

THIRD QUARTER

New Orleans: FG Carlson 27, 7:38. Drive: 14 plays, 59 yards, 7:22. Key Plays: B. Brown kick return to New Orleans 35; Shough 11 pass to Olave; Shough 9 pass to Johnson 48; Shough 10 pass to Olave on 3rd-and-7.
Atlanta: Bl. Robinson 8 run (Folk kick), 2:11. Drive: 10 plays, 74 yards, 5:27. Key Plays: Branch kick return to Atlanta 26; Penix 23 pass to Dotson; Bl. Robinson 10 run; Penix 14 pass to D. London on 3rd-and-10.

FOURTH QUARTER

New Orleans: Kamara 5 run (Carlson kick), 13:00. Drive: 14 plays, 68 yards, 4:11. Key Plays: B. Brown kick return to New Orleans 32; Shough 18 pass to Veale on 4th-and-10; Shough 17 pass to Veale on 3rd-and-18; Kamara 2 run on 4th-and-1.
Atlanta: Dotson 31 pass from Penix (Folk kick), 9:48. Drive: 6 plays, 72 yards, 3:10. Key Plays: Branch kick return to Atlanta 26; Penix 28 pass to Pitts; Bl. Robinson 5 run on 3rd-and-2.
Atlanta: Bl. Robinson 11 run (Folk kick), 6:52. Drive: 3 plays, 21 yards, 1:31.
New Orleans: Veale 3 pass from Shough (Carlson kick), 1:13. Drive: 14 plays, 76 yards, 5:38. Key Plays: B. Brown kick return to New Orleans 24; Shough 5 pass to Veale on 3rd-and-4; Shough 23 pass to Olave on 4th-and-7. A 70:007.

FIRST DOWNS	AH	NO
Rushing	13	6
Passing	9	13
Penalty	2	3
THIRD DOWN EFF.	4-8	3-15
FOURTH DOWN EFF.	0-4	6-4
TOTAL NET YARDS	420	320
Total Plays	69	69
Avg Gain	7.5	4.6
NET YARDS RUSHING	205	50
Net Yds. per Rush	2.9	0.7
Avg per rush	5.857	2.632
NET YARDS PASSING	215	270
Sacked-Yds Lost	1-8	216
Gross-Yds. passing	223	286
Completed-Att.	15-20	30-48
Had Intercepted	0	0
Yards-Pass Play	10,226	5,4
KICKOFFS-EndZone-TB	5-2-0	5-2-0
PUNTS-Avg	2-36.0	3-49.667
Punts blocked	0	0
FGs-60-Yds blocked	0-0	0-0
TOTAL RETURN YARDAGE	90	211
Punt Returns	1-25	1-2
Kickoff Returns	3-65	8-209
Interceptions	0-0	0-0
PENALTIES-Yds.	8-70	8-49
FUMBLES-Lost	0-0	1-1
TIME OF POSSESSION	30:45	29:15

RUSHING

Atlanta: Bl. Robinson 19-145, Bl. Robinson 14-62, Bl. Robinson 2-2. New Orleans: Kamara 7-123, Donaldson 3-18, K. Miller 6-9, Shough 2-5, Brown 1-minus 5.

PASSING

Atlanta: Penix 15-20-0-223. New Orleans: Shough 30-48-0-286.

RECEIVING

Atlanta: D. London 5-96, Pitts 3-47, Dotson 2-54, Branch 2-10, Hooper 1-9, Bl. Robinson 1-9, Bl. Robinson 1-2. New Orleans: Olave 8-116, Johnson 6-59, Veale 6-54, Kamara 5-35, K. Miller 2-10, Donaldson 2-5, Lance 1-7.

PUNT RETURNS

Atlanta: Branch 1-25. New Orleans: Brown 1-2.

KICKOFF RETURNS

Atlanta: Branch 3-65. New Orleans: Brown 5-130, Price 3-79.

TACKLES-ASSISTS-SACKS

Atlanta: Henderson 9-1-0, Perkins 6-2-5, Watts 5-3-5, Hughes 3-1-0, Daniels 3-0-0, Dealbo 3-0-0, Thomas 2-3-0, Bowman 2-0-0, Doris 1-1-0, Eukam 1-0-1, Brown 1-0-0, Harrison 1-0-0, Hellams 1-0-0, L. London 1-0-0, M. Smith 1-0-0, Dexter 0-2-0, Bates 0-1-0, Woods 0-1-0, New Orleans: Bletcher 5-0-0, T. Wilson 4-2-1, Sanker 4-2-0, J. Reid 3-1-0, Riley 2-0-0, Young 2-0-0, Stutsman 1-0-0, Diggs 1-1-0, Werner 1-3-0, Boyd 1-2-0, McKintyre 1-1-0, Shepherd 1-1-0, Jordan 0-2-0, Wooden 0-2-0, Brenton 0-1-0, Godchaux 0-1-0, Ridgeway 0-1-0.

INTERCEPTIONS

Atlanta: None. New Orleans: None.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

New Orleans: Carlson 52.

OFFICIALS

Referee Land Clark: Ump Mark Pellis, HL Dale Keller, LJ Stephen Ray, FJ Jabir Walker, SJ Dave Hawkshaw, BJ Brad Freeman, Replay Gavin Anderson.

NCAA

WEEK 6

TUESDAY'S RESULT

SOUTH

Southern Miss. (1-3) at Troy (2-2), 8 p.m.

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 7

SOUTH

Jacksonville St. (3-2) at Kennesaw St. (1-3), 7 p.m.
New Mexico St. (2-3) at FIU (2-2), 7:30 p.m.

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8

SOUTH

San Houston St. (1-3) at Liberty (4-1), 7 p.m.
Missouri St. (1-3) at W. Kentucky (1-4), 7 p.m.

SOUTHWEST

South Florida (4-1) at UTSA (4-1), 7:30 p.m.
South Alabama (3-2) at Arkansas St. (2-3), 7:30 p.m.

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9

EAST

Columbia (2-1) at Marist (3-2), 7 p.m.

SOUTH

Florida St. (3-2) at Louisville (2-3), 7 p.m.

FAR WEST

Wyoming (2-3) at San Jose St. (3-2), 9 p.m.
Iowa (4-1) at Washington (3-2), 9 p.m.
Washington St. (1-4) at Utah St. (1-4), 9 p.m.
Iowa St. (3-2) at BYU (4-0), 10:15 p.m.

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 10

EAST

North Carolina (2-2) at Pittsburgh (5-0), 12 Noon
Dartmouth (1-2) at Yale (2-1), Noon
Tulane (2-2) at Army (2-2), Noon
Brant (4-1) at Brown (1-2), Noon
Stonewall (1-4) at Sacred Heart (2-3), Noon
Robert Morris (2-3) at Morgan St. (4-1), Noon
Arizona (4-1) at West Virginia (3-2), Noon
Princeton (2-1) at Wagner (3-0), Noon
Burdell (1-4) at Georgetown (4-0), 12:30 p.m.
LIU Brooklyn (1-5) at Duquesne (1-3), 1 p.m.
Harvard (3-0) at Cornell (2-1), 1 p.m.
American International (0-0) at CSU (1-3), 1 p.m.
Howard (2-3) at Penn (2-1), 1 p.m.
Franklin Pierce (0-1) at Delaware St. (3-3), 1 p.m.
Miami (Ohio) (2-3) at UMass (4-1), 2 p.m.
Richmond (5-1) at Fordham (1-5), 3:30 p.m.
Tulsa (3-2) at Navy (1-3), 3:30 p.m.
UConn (2-3) at Temple (2-3), 3:45 p.m.
Tony Brook (3-2) at Towson (0-4), 4 p.m.
Coastal Carolina (1-4) at Marshall (5-2), 7 p.m.
Southern Cal (5-1) at Penn St. (3-2), 7:30 p.m.

SOUTH

Wake Forest (4-1) at NC State (3-2), Noon
New Hampshire (2-4) at NC A&T (5-1), Noon
South Carolina (2-3) at Florida (4-1), 12:45 p.m.
William & Mary (2-4) at NC Central (2-4), 1 p.m.
Old Dominion (1-4) at Appalachian St. (3-1), 1 p.m.
Samford (1-4) at Chattanooga (3-3), 1 p.m.
Wofford (3-3) at Elon (4-2), 2 p.m.
Va. Lynchburg (0-3) at Davidson (2-3), 2 p.m.
Northeastern St. (0-2) at West Florida (3-2), 2 p.m.
ETSU (4-2) at the Citadel (2-3), 2 p.m.

Arkansas Baptist (0-1) at Alcorn St. (3-3), 3 p.m.
Carolina (3-3) at North Carolina (4-2), 3 p.m.
E. Illinois (1-4) at Gardner-Webb (2-4), 3:30 p.m.
Duke (4-1) at Georgia Tech (1-3), 3:30 p.m.
Mississippi (3-1) at Mississippi Southern (2-3), 3:30 p.m.
UT Martin (1-4) at Tennessee St. (1-4), 3:30 p.m.
Furman (2-4) at Tennessee Tech (4-1), 3:30 p.m.
Florida A&M (1-4) at Alabama St. (3-2), 4 p.m.
Rich (1-4) at East Carolina (2-3), 4 p.m.
Michigan St. (5-0) at Grambling St. (3-2), 5 p.m.
Jackson St. (4-2) at Presbyterian (2-3), 5:30 p.m.
SC State (5-1) at Davidson (2-3), 5:30 p.m.
West Georgia (1-4) at E. Kentucky (1-4), 6 p.m.
Tarleton St. (0-0) at Austin Peay (5-1), 7 p.m.
UAB (3-2) at Memphis (4-1), 7 p.m.
Bethune-Cookman (2-2) at Alabama A&M (4-2), 7 p.m.
LSU (4-1) at Kentucky (4-1), 7 p.m.
James Madison (5-0) at Georgia Southern (2-3), 7:30 p.m.
Syracuse (2-2) at Virginia (3-2), 7:30 p.m.
Louisiana-Lafayette (4-1) at Louisiana Tech (2-2), 7:30 p.m.
Michigan (5-0) at Alabama (5-0), 7:30 p.m.

MIDWEST

Indiana (5-0) at Nebraska (5-0), Noon
Sacramento St. (1-4) at Bowling Green (1-4), Noon
Texas A&M (3-2) at Missouri (4-1), Noon
Morehead St. (1-4) at Dayton (3-1), Noon
Ball St. (1-4) at Northwestern (5-1), 12:30 p.m.
San Diego (2-3) at Butler (0-1), 1 p.m.
Youngstown St. (4-2) at Indiana St. (2-4), 1 p.m.
S. Illinois (3-3) at South Dakota (4-2), 2 p.m.
Drake (2-3) at Valparaiso (2-3), 2 p.m.
SE Missouri (2-3) at Lindenwood (Mo.) (1-3), 2 p.m.
Stetson (1-4) at St. Thomas (Minn.) (4-2), 2 p.m.
E. Michigan (3-3) at Akron (1-4), 3:30 p.m.
Stanford (2-3) at Notre Dame (5-0), 3:30 p.m.
Houston (4-1) at Kansas St. (3-2), 3:30 p.m.
Illinois (2-3) at Michigan St. (2-3), 3:30 p.m.
Kent St. (3-3) at W. Michigan (3-2), 3:30 p.m.
Buffalo (2-3) at Toledo (4-1), 3:30 p.m.
Cent. Michigan (3-2) at Ohio (3-2), 3:30 p.m.
Maryland (2-3) at Ohio St. (4-1), 4:15 p.m.
North Dakota (5-1) at N. Iowa (2-2), 5 p.m.
Air Force (3-1) at N. Illinois (0-4), 5:30 p.m.
Minnesota (4-1) at Purdue (2-3), 8 p.m.

SOUTHWEST

UCF (2-2) at Oklahoma St. (3-1), Noon
MVSU (2-4) at Texas Southern (1-4), 3 p.m.
Southern U. (2-4) at Prairie View (2-4), 3 p.m.
Oklahoma (2-2) vs. Texas (5-0) at Dallas, 3:30 p.m.
Charlotte (0-5) at North Texas (3-2), 3:30 p.m.
Incarnate Word (2-3) at Lamar (4-1), 3:30 p.m.
Tennessee (4-1) at Arkansas (2-3), 4:15 p.m.
Nevada (1-3) at UTEP (0-1), 7 p.m.
Cent. Arkansas (2-3) at Abilene Christian (2-4), 8 p.m.
SE Louisiana (3-2) at UT Rio Grande Valley (2-3), 8 p.m.

FAR WEST

Idaho (1-4) at Weber St. (3-3), 3 p.m.
Virginia Tech (4-1) at California (2-3), 3:30 p.m.
UCLA (4-0) at Oregon (3-1), 3:30 p.m.
Utah Tech (2-3) at Portland St. (1-4), 4 p.m.
Montana (5-1) at N. Arizona (2-4), 5 p.m.
Cal Poly (3-3) at Idaho St. (4-1), 6 p.m.
San Diego St. (2-3) at Oregon St. (3-2), 6 p.m.
N. Dakota St. (5-0) at UNLV (3-2), 7 p.m.
N. Colorado 2-2) at E. Washington (1-5), 7 p.m.
Kansas (2-4) at Utah (4-0), 10:15 p.m.
Hawaii (3-4) at Arizona St. (2-2), 10:30 p.m.
Boise St. (4-1) at Butler St. (4-1), 10:30 p.m.

NASCAR Cup Series

POINTS LEADERS

Through Sunday.
1. Kyle Larson, 2318.
2. Denny Hamlin, 2278.
3. Christopher Bell, 2263.
4. Joey Logano, 2247.
5. Ryan Blaney, 2235.
6. Chase Briscoe, 2224.
7. Tyler Reddick, 2212.
8. Ty Gibbs, 2206.
9. Austin Cindric, 2190.
10. Bubba Wallace, 2181.
11. Carson Hoover, 2160.
12. William Byron, 2149.
13. Chase Elliott, 2155.
14. Daniel Suarez, 2123.
15. Chris Buescher, 2122.
16. Ryan Preece, 2114.
17. Shane Van Gisbergen, 688.
18. Brad Keselowski, 654.
19. Ross Chastain, 623.
20. Michael McDowell, 597.
21. Erik Jones, 582.
22. AJ Allmendinger, 551.
23. Todd Gilliland, 542.
24. Austin Dillon, 528.
25. Josh Berry, 514.
26. Alex Bowman, 503.
27. John H. Nemechek, 497.
28. Zane Smith, 484.
29. Ricky Stenhouse Jr., 460.
30. Riley Herbst, 446.
31. Noah Gragson, 394.
32. Cole Custer, 387.
33. Ty Dillon, 339.
34. Connor Zilisch, 327.
35. Cody Ware, 229.
36. Casey Mears, 13.
37. Kevin Magnussen, 11.
38. Jimmie Johnson, 9.
39. Katherine Legge, 8.
40. BJ McLeod, 4.

NASCAR O'Reilly Series

POINTS LEADERS

Through Monday.
1. Sheldon Creed, 2259 (3).
2. Carson Knepp, 2240 (2).
3. Jesse Love, 2238 (1).
4. Justin Allgaier, 2229 (6).
5. Uch Tech (3-1) at Portland St. (1-4), 4 p.m.
6. Sam Mayer, 2207 (0).
7. Taylor Gray, 2169 (1).
8. Sammy Smith, 2165 (0).
9. Austin Hill, 2160 (2).
10. Parker Retzlaff, 2142 (0).
11. Brandon Jones, 2122 (1).
12. Rajah Caruth, 2113 (0).
13. Brent Cross, 750 (0).
14. William Sawalich, 711 (1).
15. Ryan Siep, 650 (1).
16. Anthony Alfredo, 616 (0).
17. Brennan Poole, 535 (0).
18. Dean Thompson, 528 (0).
19. Jeremy Clements, 481 (0).
20. Harrison Burton, 467 (0).
21. Jeb Burton, 441 (0).
22. Blaine Perkins, 398 (0).

PRO BASKETBALL

WNBA playoffs

FIRST ROUND

Best of three

DREAM ELIMINATED MYSTICS, 2-0

Game 1: at Atlanta 92, Washington 77
Game 2: Atlanta 93, at Washington 75

LIBERTY ELIMINATED LYNX, 2-0

Game 1: New York 91, at Minnesota 75
Game 2: at New York 87, Minnesota 71

VALKYRIES ELIMINATED WINGS, 2-1

Game 1: at Golden State 104, Dallas 80
Game 2: at Dallas 108, Golden State 100 (OT)
Game 3: at Golden State 77, Dallas 73

ACES ELIMINATED FEVER, 2-1

Game 1: at Las Vegas 102, Indiana 85
Game 2: at Indiana 99, Las Vegas 89
Game 3: at Las Vegas 94, Indiana 83

SEMIFINALS

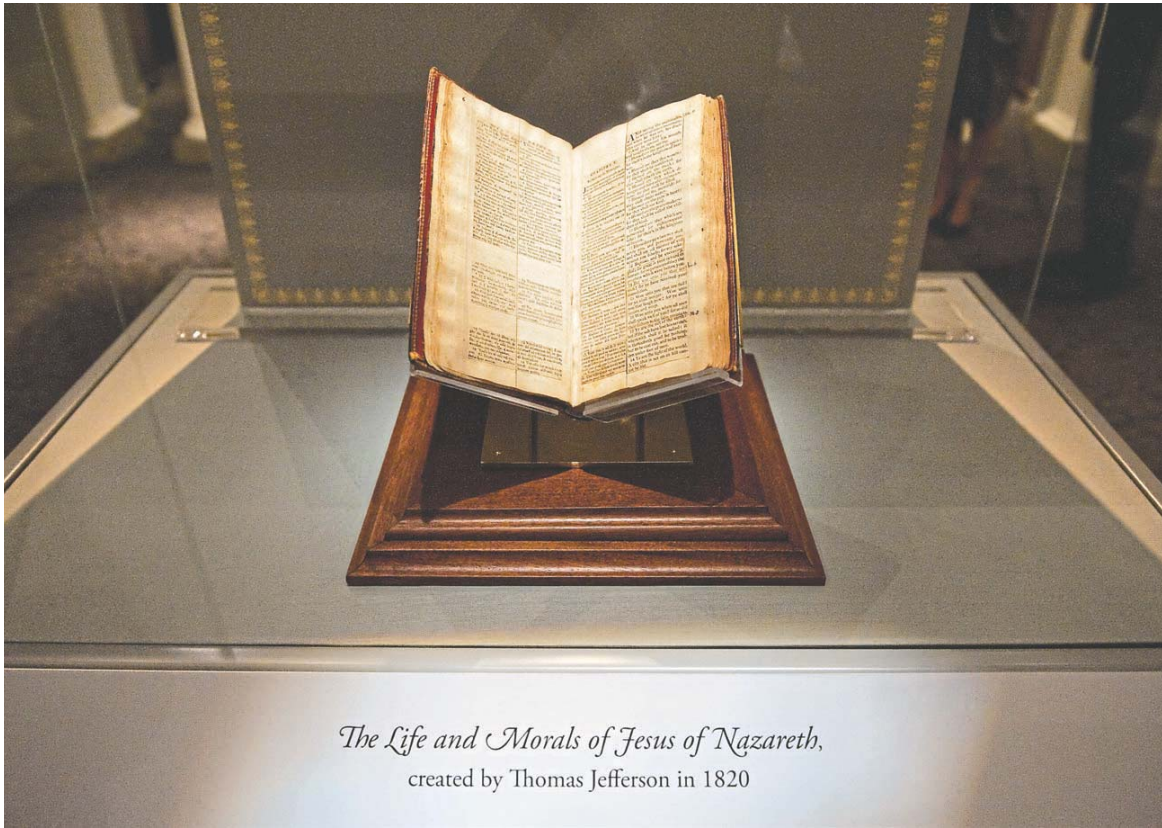
Best of five; x-If necessary

VALKYRIES LEAD ACES, 1-0

Game 1: at Golden State 71, Las Vegas 60
Wednesday's game: Las Vegas at Golden State, 9:30
Friday's game: Golden State at Las Vegas, 9:30
x-Sunday's game: Golden State at Las Vegas, TBA
x-Wednesday, Oct. 14: Golden State at Las Vegas, TBA

DREAM LEAD LIBERTY, 1-0

Game 1: at Atlanta 92, New York 82
Wednesday's game: New York at Atlanta, 7:30
Friday's game: Atlanta at New York, 7:30
x-S



The Life and Morals of Jesus of Nazareth,
created by Thomas Jefferson in 1820

TOM WILLIAMS/CQ ROLL CALL

A Bible that Thomas Jefferson assembled using four translations also contained a strand of hair Richard Kurin thinks is the key to settling the debate.

Quest to determine Jefferson's link to Hemings endures

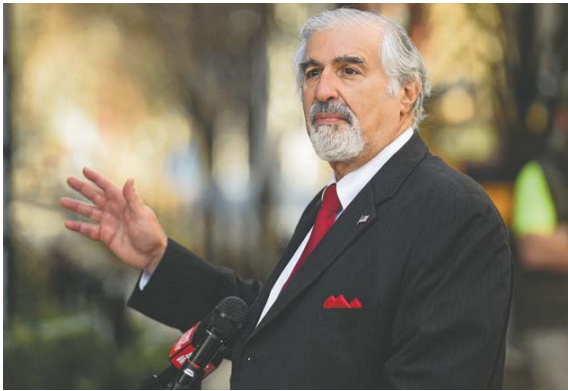
Smithsonian official found a strand of hair that might finally be the end of a quintessential American saga

BY GREGORY S. SCHNEIDER

As with any good mystery, the crucial clue was something easy to overlook: a single hair stuck to a page in a 200-year-old manuscript.

Richard Kurin was previewing an exhibit at the Smithsonian Institution, where he was a top administrator, in 2011 when the hair caught his eye in a copy of Thomas Jefferson's handmade version of the Bible. Light red or blond, the strand was stuck in glue that Jefferson had used to piece together this Bible from text cut out of other books.

If this was Jefferson's hair, Kurin thought, maybe its DNA could be analyzed. And maybe that would finally solve what Kurin considered one of the great mysteries of American history: whether Jefferson fa-



BEN HASTY/MEDIANEWS GROUP/GETTY IMAGES

Kurin enlisted help from Monticello, which had other samples of what was purported to be Jefferson's hair. "People wanted certainty," he said.

thered children with Sally Hemings, the enslaved half sister of his late wife.

Most historians already accept that the author of the Declaration of Independence fathered children with Hemings, but the DNA testing done over the years to settle the case did not involve samples from Jefferson himself. There was enough wiggle room that some skeptics continue to believe it could have been another male relative, such as one of Jefferson's nephews, who fathered the children.

"People wanted certainty," Kurin, now the Smithsonian's distinguished scholar and ambassador at large, said in an interview. So he undertook a 15-year effort to see whether advances in DNA science could make that possible.

The results, chronicled in his new

SEE JEFFERSON ON B14

Abrego hearing abruptly canceled

POSTPONEMENT
IS NOT EXPLAINED

Government seeks
to vacate injunction

BY GARY FIELDS
AND REBECCA SANTANA
Associated Press

A hearing for Kilmar Abrego García which was expected to determine whether the man mistakenly sent by the Trump administration to El Salvador would be deported to Liberia was abruptly canceled Tuesday for reasons that were not immediately clear.

The government is moving to vacate a preliminary injunction put in place by U.S. District Judge Paula Xinis preventing U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement from detaining and deporting Abrego to the West African country of Liberia. His legal team is seeking to make the injunction permanent. The judge left previous orders in place last December and ordered him released from custody.

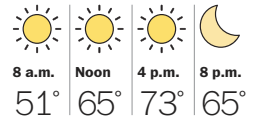
Abrego was in the courtroom Tuesday but Xinis never took the bench. Instead attorneys for both sides left the courtroom about five minutes before the hearing was supposed to begin. They held a 15-minute conference and then the hearing was canceled. No announcement was made in court as to why the hearing was canceled.

Simon Sandoval-Moshenberg, a lawyer for Abrego, told media outside the courthouse simply that the hearing could not happen Tuesday and that an update to the case would be posted on the court docket in the next few days. He shed no light as to why the hearing was cancelled.

"Unfortunately the court was

SEE HEARING ON B16

TODAY'S WEATHER



High today at approx. 4 p.m.: 73°

Precip: 0% Wind: S 7-14 mph

For weather news, go to B18

THE DISTRICT

Episcopalian bishop who implored Trump to have "mercy" retires. B18

VIRGINIA

General Assembly will convene to celebrate 250 years. B18

OBITUARIES

Dodgers GM Fred Claire, 91, built the 1988 World Series champion. B17

Ex-Olympian's lawyers: IGs should investigate the Reflecting Pool case

Letter is sent to the watchdogs at the Justice and Interior departments

BY JASMINE GOLDEN
AND MEG KELLY

Attorneys for the former Olympian who had been accused of damaging the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool have called for inspectors general to investigate alleged misconduct by the Interior and Justice departments in the handling of the since-dismissed case.

In a letter Tuesday to the watchdog offices of the two de-

partments, David Hearn's attorneys said a joint investigation is needed after the departments allegedly rushed to complete a renovation of the pool despite warnings of installation failures, charged Hearn based on incomplete and false information, and publicly shamed him despite having information showing another cause for the damage.

The letter — signed by six attorneys representing Hearn, including Michael Bromwich, a former Justice Department inspector general — asked the government to gather facts as to what happened in the case, which they described as a "nightmare" for their client.

"Anything less than a full and fair review would be a betrayal of

your mission and perpetuate the outrageous mistreatment of Mr. Hearn," the attorneys wrote.

In a statement, a spokesperson for the Justice Department said, "The Office of the Inspector General operates independently and makes its own decisions about what to review."

An Interior Department spokesperson did not respond to questions about the requested investigation. But in a statement, they said Hearn had "admitted to officers that he was tampering with the Reflecting Pool."

Hearn's attorneys denied the claim, saying "the government is continuing the kind of misconduct that triggered this complaint."

SEE LETTER ON B15



ROD LAMKEY/AP

"Anything less than a full and fair review would be a betrayal of your mission and perpetuate the outrageous mistreatment of Mr. Hearn," attorneys for David Hearn, center, wrote in their letter.



PHOTOS BY MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Leaders of the organization that runs Thomas Jefferson's Monticello responded to the book by pointing out that the institution accepted the likelihood of Jefferson's paternity more than a quarter-century ago.

Even with advancements, Jefferson-Hemings relationship sparks skepticism

JEFFERSON FROM B13

book, “History by a Hair,” suggest with 99.9 percent certainty that Jefferson himself was the father of at least one of Sally Hemings’s sons.

The release comes as the Trump administration has vowed to purge “improper ideology” from the Smithsonian and the president has said the institution was too focused on slavery. Kurin said he is operating on the faith that his effort is something the nation will welcome.

So far, Kurin said, he hasn’t heard from the White House on the book.

The foundation that runs Monticello, Jefferson’s historic home outside Charlottesville, responded to the book with an essay headlined “Thomas Jefferson and Sally Hemings, Again” that points out the institution accepted the likelihood of Jefferson’s paternity more than a quarter-century ago.

Kurin’s findings are one more step in a long line of historical and scientific evidence, Thomas Jefferson Foundation president Jane Kamensky writes with Andrew Davenport, vice president for research and director of the Robert H. Smith International Center for Jefferson Studies.

“Is there room for doubt? The scientific method, like the historical method, insists there is, always,” they write. “The frontiers of knowledge can only move forward with humility.”

Many descendants of both Jefferson and Hemings participated in the study and have accepted the findings as further confirmation of what they knew. A few have pushed back, noting that the test results have not yet been substantiated by a scientific peer review committee. Mary Brady-Atkins, 98, a retired professor and the oldest living descendant of Hemings, asked to be removed from the study and told the Chronicle of Higher Education that Kurin had lost her trust by publishing before validating the science.

And still others continue to doubt.

The Thomas Jefferson Heritage Society, formed as a skeptical response to the earlier DNA reports, posted an analysis of Kurin’s findings that praised the recovery of Jefferson’s genome



Many descendants of Jefferson and Sally Hemings participated in the study and said the findings confirmed what they already believed.

as “a genuine achievement” but stopped short of endorsing the conclusion.

“The fair reading is that their study raises the question well and recovers remarkable material, but has not yet answered it,” John H. Works Jr. wrote in the analysis. Works has been active in the Jefferson descendant community for years and said in an email to The Washington Post that he is awaiting peer review of his own analysis of another line of the Jefferson family.

“My own view is that restraint is warranted,” Works said in the email. “Until the genome and underlying data from Dr Kurin’s study are released and the findings survive independent testing, I would not describe the

question as settled.”

Kurin said a scientific panel has completed a review of the methods and conclusions and had it accepted by “a major journal,” which is just completing the editing process.

When Kurin got his big idea in 2011, he reached out to Lonnie G. Bunch III, now the Smithsonian’s top official but at the time working to assemble the National Museum of African American History and Culture. Kurin said he told Bunch that if they succeeded in sequencing Jefferson’s DNA, it could prove that the former president was the father of Hemings’s children or it could prove that he was not.

“Lonnie told me straight up — the museum has to be built on

a foundation of truth, whatever it is. That was the whole aim of the study, just follow the truth,” Kurin said.

The question of Jefferson’s relationship with Hemings has been in the public eye at least since 1802, when a muckraking journalist named James Callender — who had once slung dirt on Jefferson’s behalf but came to feel betrayed by him — wrote in a Richmond newspaper about the president having mixed-race children by an enslaved woman at Monticello.

Jefferson never responded directly to the accusations, which reverberated among his political opponents for the rest of his life and beyond. Even then, the idea that the Founding Father who

penned the words “all men are created equal” without freeing his slaves might have had an illicit relationship with an enslaved woman and kept his own children in bondage was seen as shockingly hypocritical.

Jefferson did free Sally Hemings’s children upon his death — but not the rest of Monticello’s enslaved population — and the story of their true parentage passed down through the generations. In the late 1990s and early 2000s, DNA testing made it possible to finally attempt a scientific answer, and since then Monticello has depicted the relationship as accepted fact.

Taking the science further turned out to be complicated. The hair that inspired Kurin was

one of three found in that manuscript, which was not actually a Bible but was Jefferson’s attempt to cut-and-paste a volume of the moral teachings of Jesus without reference to miracles or the supernatural.

Without follicles, the hairs would not have been testable under earlier versions of DNA science. Advances had made it possible to consider using them, but eventually scientists at the University of California at Santa Cruz determined that the samples did not provide enough material.

Kurin enlisted help from officials at Monticello, who said they had other samples of what was purported to be Jefferson’s hair. In the end, it was a clump that a doctor clipped from Jefferson on his death bed in 1826 that proved to be the most promising source.

Testing took years, and during that time Kurin reached out to families descended from Jefferson and from Hemings, who had four children who lived to adulthood. They provided their own DNA for comparison.

The descendants, he said, were generous and ready to accept whatever the science told them. “It gave me great faith in the American people,” Kurin said.

The testing identified the hairs as belonging to Jefferson and provided what’s likely to be the best confirmation possible of his paternity, short of exhuming the former president’s remains. Because of the complex nature of the testing — which the book goes to great lengths to explain — the results are strongest for two of Hemings’s sons.

After 50 years at the nation’s premier set of public museums, Kurin couldn’t help viewing the project through a grand lens: bringing together Americans Black and White, bloodlines literally divided by slavery, but possibly sharing family ties woven into the roots of the nation.

“I take that as a metaphor for our larger country,” he said. “We have a lot of different ancestries, different origins, but we’re one country. There are some rocky relations but somehow we Americans are all one family and we share one future together. Figuring out how we live together is better than being divided.”



The Guide to Offers
The Washington Post

Enter for the chance to win a pair of tickets to book talk with Adam Grant moderated by Daniel Pink October 14

Adam Grant is an organizational psychologist at the Wharton School and has been one of its top-rated professors for seven consecutive years. His bestselling books have sold millions of copies worldwide. In his new book, *Vibe*, Grant explores the surprising science behind meaningful human connection—and offers a fresh perspective on how we relate to one another. No matter how skilled you are at connecting with others, there is always room to grow—and to help those around you grow, too.

See details at [washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388](https://www.washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388)



MARYLAND

State leaders absent from Trump shipbuilding event

BY DAN DIAMOND,
ERIN COX AND
PRANSHU VERMA

Maryland Gov. Wes Moore (D) and other state lawmakers did not participate in President Donald Trump's announcement of a multibillion-dollar investment in submarine manufacturing in Maryland on Tuesday.

Trump visited Baltimore for an announcement with Anduril Industries, which will invest \$3.7 billion in a new shipyard. The company has also struck a \$2.9 billion deal with the U.S. Navy to help support the project.

Moore and Maryland's congressional delegation did not attend the event after being told they could not participate in the announcement.

Asked about Trump blocking Moore from participating in the event, a spokesperson for the governor said that Moore "will work with anyone when

it comes to delivering for Marylanders but bow to no one when it comes to standing up for them."

A White House spokesperson disputed that Trump barred Moore from participating in the event and accused the governor of "throwing a tantrum" because he was not scheduled to deliver remarks.

"President Trump is willing to work with anyone to revitalize our manufacturing sector, which is why the White House graciously invited Governor Moore to attend today's event as a guest," the spokesperson said.

An Anduril spokesman referred questions to the White House and Moore's office.

Trump earlier this year moved to revoke Moore's invitation to a bipartisan dinner of governors.

The White House and Maryland officials have released dueling press statements that touted their separate roles in



The federal government is investing \$3.7 billion to manufacture U.S. Navy submarines in Maryland.

Anduril's investment.

"This delivers on President Trump's promise to bolster America's defense industrial base while revitalizing our manufacturing industry, creating over 13,000 direct and indirect jobs and driving \$2 billion in annual economic output," White House deputy press secretary Anna Kelly told reporters on a press call Tuesday morning.

"This new project will become the largest single private investment in Maryland and the largest job creator in Maryland in over a decade," Maryland officials said in a news release, also issued Tuesday morning. The 939-word release did not mention Trump.

MARYLAND

Poll: Incumbent Moore leads Cox, the GOP candidate, in gubernatorial race

BY TINASHE CHINGARANDE
Baltimore Sun

Gov. Wes Moore holds a 27-point lead over Republican challenger Dan Cox with less than a month until Election Day, according to a new UMBC poll of likely Maryland voters.

Fifty-one percent of likely voters said they would vote for Moore if the election were held today, compared with 24 percent for Cox. Fourteen percent were undecided, while Green Party candidate Andy Ellis and Working Class Families Party candi-

date Cathy White each received 3 percent. Five percent said they would vote for "some other candidate."

UMBC's poll came ahead of Moore and Cox's Tuesday gubernatorial debate, hosted by Maryland Public Television. Earlier this year, Cox asked for at least two more debates before the general election. Moore's campaign has not agreed to additional debates.

Spring UMBC polling has shown signs of slipping support for Moore: His approval rating dropped to 48 percent in April

from about 52 percent in November, while nearly 60 percent of Marylanders said the state was headed in the wrong direction and 76 percent rated economic conditions as "poor" or "fair."

Still, this month's results show Moore with a commanding advantage but a smaller margin than the one he posted against Cox four years ago. Moore defeated Cox by about 32 percentage points in 2022.

The poll of 776 likely voters was conducted Sept. 22-27 and has a margin of error of plus or minus 3.5 percentage points.

Sixty-five percent of respondents completed the survey online, 28 percent by cellphone with live interviewers and 7 percent by landline with live interviewers.

Among those who self-identified as Democrats, 72 percent said they would vote for Moore, 4 percent for Cox and 13 percent were undecided. Among Republicans, 75 percent said they would vote for Cox, 6 percent for Moore and 10 percent were undecided.

Eighty-one percent of Democrats said they were very or somewhat enthusiastic about voting, compared with 80 per-

cent of Republicans and 75 percent of unaffiliated voters.

Unaffiliated voters were the least likely of the three groups to describe themselves as enthusiastic about voting, with 25 percent saying they were "not at all" or "a little" enthusiastic about voting in November.

The poll also asked voters how they viewed the two major parties.

Forty-seven percent of respondents said the Democratic Party was organized, compared with 43 percent who said so of the GOP. Seventy-two percent of re-

spondents said the Democratic Party was more effective at winning elections, compared with 25 percent who said the same of the Republican Party. More voters said the Democratic Party was more welcoming of opposing viewpoints than the Republican Party, 47 percent to 27 percent, respectively. More voters — 66 percent — also said the average voter did not relate to the Republican Party, while 54 percent said the same of the Democratic Party.

Olympian's lawyers: Inspectors general should investigate Reflecting Pool case

LETTER FROM B13

The letter comes days after a judge agreed to a request from Hearn's defense to dismiss his case with prejudice, meaning the charge can't be brought back, a rare move the judge said aimed to protect Hearn from a "meritless, politically driven prosecution in the future."

The Justice Department has said prosecutors acted "in good faith" in bringing the charge against Hearn based on the information they had at the time from the Interior Department.

In a court filing to dismiss the case, prosecutors wrote that the Interior Department later provided additional evidence that suggested the damage to the Reflecting Pool was from a "botched" installation.

Interior Secretary Doug Burgum maintained that "vandals" were responsible for damage to the pool immediately after the charges were dismissed. He also wrote on social media that the department provided "expert and eyewitness testimony" to the U.S. attorney's office, as well as "every piece of evidence they asked for in the requested time line detailing each area of damage at the pool."

President Donald Trump announced plans earlier this year to renovate the Reflecting Pool as part of work ahead of the country's 250th anniversary celebrations. The Interior Department awarded a no-bid contract to Atlantic Industrial Coatings for the project. The contractor did not respond to a request for comment Tuesday.

By June, problems at the site arose, as algae bloomed and the pool's new "American flag blue" coating peeled.

On June 19, Hearn, 67, went on a bike ride and stopped at the Reflecting Pool. He said he reached into the basin to feel the water temperature and touched a partially detached piece of coating.

He said he released the coating when a National Park Service employee asked him to and "left the pool in the same condition as he found it," according to the new letter from his attorneys.

In the letter sent Tuesday, his attorneys said the government's charging documents show that National Guard members stopped and detained Hearn before bringing him to U.S. Park Police. They said body-camera footage showed a Guard member telling Hearn "he was not free to leave when he asked."

His attorneys claim Hearn was not read his rights, nor allowed a telephone call or provided any details of the charges against him, until he was re-



PETE KIEHART/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Attorneys for David Hearn have called for inspectors general to investigate alleged misconduct by the Interior and Justice departments in the handling of the dismissed case.

leased later that night with two misdemeanor citations.

Less than two weeks later, on July 2, a grand jury indicted Hearn on a charge of felony destruction of property valued at \$1,000 or more. He pleaded not guilty.

On July 31, U.S. Attorney Jeanine Pirro filed to dismiss the charge citing, in part, an email from a National Park Service engineer that suggested the pool was peeling days before Hearn visited.

In the Tuesday letter seeking "coordinated, independent investigations," Hearn's attorneys — who also include Steven Levin, Jason Weinstein, Mary Dohrmann, Norm Eisen and Joshua Kolb — said they want Interior's inspector general to investigate the department's no-bid selection process of the contractor and why Burgum and other officials accused Hearn of vandalism if there had been documented concerns about the in-

stallation, among other alleged failures.

Hearn's attorneys allege the contractor for the Reflecting Pool renovations was "unqualified and inexperienced." In a memo justifying the contract, the Interior Department found Atlantic Industrial Coatings, the primary contractor, had the required technical expertise and could finish the work within the allotted time.

As the renovation progressed, the National Park Service documented blistering, Hearn's attorneys said. An engineer working for the agency found areas "vulnerable to peeling" in the days immediately after the pool was refilled with water, the attorneys said, but the pool was still re-opened.

"NPS was warned of the risks, and it nevertheless proceeded," Hearn's attorneys said. "Together these decisions reflect a failure that was not merely foreseeable but expressly foreseen

— and completely ignored."

Hearn's attorneys said there was "a mountain of evidence" that the pool was failing from faulty installation, yet the U.S. attorney's office "misled" the court about when it learned of such defects "in order to cover up its own misconduct and incompetence."

For example, they said, Pirro's office had received a damage assessment from the National Park Service showing the liner had been failing before it presented its case to a grand jury.

The U.S. attorney's office said in court filings that it was unaware of or in possession of "any of the extensive documentation of installation issues" collected by the Interior Department at the time the indictment was returned.

In addition to examining when Pirro's office knew of problems with the lining, Hearn's attorneys want the Justice Department watchdog to investigate

whether the U.S. attorney violated policy through statements she made at a news conference announcing his indictment and allegations that she improperly pressed a defense expert to discuss his work during a July visit to the Reflecting Pool.

The government's motion to dismiss the case mentions Pirro visiting the site at the same time as the defense expert but does not mention the interaction.

The attorneys also said in the letter that the government's key witness, a National Park Service employee, falsely claimed that they took a photo of the liner just before Hearn touched it. But they say evidence shows the photo was taken by someone else about two hours before Hearn was at the pool.

The U.S. attorney's office "blindly parroted" the witness's account without "taking the minimal investigative steps necessary to determine who took this photo," Hearn's attorneys

said in the letter.

His attorneys further allege prosecutors did not produce crucial evidence, including the metadata for the photos that led to the charge, the identities of Hearn's accusers or the contents of his phone.

Attorneys said the administration did, however, distribute surveillance footage to Fox News and on officials' social media accounts that it claimed showed vandalism at the pool.

The effort was intended to "reinforce" a narrative, the attorneys said. But prosecutors have since dismissed vandalism cases against Hearn and three others.

"Dropping the case is not justice or accountability," Bromwich, one of Hearn's attorneys, said in a message to The Washington Post. "The IGs have the power and the authority to discover the details of what happened, who was responsible, and who should be held accountable."

VIRGINIA

Hampton Roads outages leave residents feeling salty

NaCl caused power issues, which surprisingly isn't all that uncommon

BY GAVIN STONE
Virginian-Pilot

The widespread power outages across Hampton Roads over the weekend caused by salt buildup on electrical infrastructure caught many in the region by surprise — including the National Weather Service — but it

is a fairly common problem for utility providers. There were about 45,000 outages as a direct result of salt buildup over the course of the storm, according to Dominion Energy, with a peak of about 20,000 at one time Saturday and about 8,000 on Sunday. As of 2 p.m. Monday, there were about 700 outages remaining. The salt buildup and subsequent electrical issues were caused by a unique set of circumstances. The nor'easter lingered for several days, blowing salt into the air consistently which allowed it to reach farther

inland, and there was a long period without steady rain to wash it away, according to Dominion Energy and the weather service. “We had just enough moisture in the air that it activated the salt,” Dominion spokesperson Cherise Newsome said. “For our community we recognize that this is frustrating because [the power is] on again-off again, at the same time for utility companies in coastal regions we deal with this a lot.” Newsome explained the salt buildup this weekend was only a “film” that utility workers can see up close but is not visible

from the ground, though it's possible to hear a crackling or buzzing noise from the ground. When the misting rain mixed with the salt, it became a conductor of electricity and instead of flowing through the power lines, the electricity was attracted to other parts of the utility poles that aren't meant to handle electrical current. Adding to the abnormal nature of the outages was that salt-related outages were reported farther inland in Portsmouth and Chesapeake. Newsome explained this was due to the nor'easter also blowing salt

from the Elizabeth River. Power outages from salt buildup are more common in northeastern North Carolina than in Hampton Roads, according to Newsome. Dominion expected the weekend's salt-related outages because of daily reports provided by staff meteorologists who focus on how weather conditions will impact utility equipment. NWS meteorologists found out about the ongoing issue at about 1 p.m. Saturday when staff from Norfolk's Department of Emergency Management contacted them, the city

and weather service confirmed. Ryan Rogers, who's been a NWS meteorologist for 12 years, said they expect salt to be an issue in terms of corroding metal in coastal areas, but he didn't know this level of damage from salt buildup was a “possibility.” “We have never seen that before, honestly surprised it happened [this weekend] versus when the winds were a lot stronger the previous week with all the coastal flooding,” Rogers said. “It was not really a noteworthy day at all meteorologically for something like that to happen.”



Kilmar Abrego García, center, arrives with supporters at the U.S. District Court for the District of Maryland in Greenbelt. But his hearing was postponed when Judge Paula Xinis failed to appear on the bench.

Abrego’s hearing is abruptly canceled, but the reason is a mystery

HEARING FROM B13

unable to go forward today,” Sandoval-Moshenberg said. The Salvadoran national's case became a focal point in the immigration debate after he was mistakenly deported to his home country last year. Since his return, he has been fighting a second deportation to an African country as proposed by Department of Homeland Security officials. Abrego argued that if he were to be deported, it should be to Costa Rica, which had previously agreed to accept him. But Todd Lyons, the former

acting director of ICE, said in a March 2026 memo that deporting Abrego to Costa Rica would be “prejudicial to the United States,” because the U.S. had expended resources and political capital negotiating with Liberia to accept third-country nationals. The push for deportation to Liberia continued even after the U.S. signed an agreement with Costa Rica to accept deportees who cannot legally be returned to their home countries. “The government is leading the same rodeo as many times before. Sending Kilmar to Costa Rica is on the table. However,

the government continues to punish him for pursuing his constitutional rights and seeks to ship him to Liberia,” said Jossie Flor Sapunar, the national communications director for We Are CASA, an activist group that has supported Abrego García and his family and intends to be at the courthouse. “Kilmar has become an international symbol of due process, a symbol which the Trump administration wants to silence.” Supporters of Abrego gathered outside the courthouse in Greenbelt, some wearing green vests that said “CASA.” Nadine Seiler, 61, held a banner

supporting Abrego while a choir sang “We Shall Not Be Moved.” Seiler said she emigrated from Trinidad nearly 39 years ago. “I’m an immigrant. I have come to represent for my immigrant community,” said Seiler. She said Abrego said months ago that he was willing to leave the country, but the government hasn't agreed. “It’s not about policy. It’s about cruelty.” She added in an email that the family deserves privacy, either at home in Maryland or in Costa Rica. Abrego, 31, has an American wife and child and has lived in

Maryland for years, but he immigrated to the U.S. illegally as a teenager. In 2019, an immigration judge ruled that he could not be deported to El Salvador because he faced danger there from a gang that had threatened his family. He was arrested in Baltimore in March 2025 after picking up his then-5-year-old son, who has autism and other disabilities, from his grandmother's house, according to court papers. Abrego was then sent to a mega-prison in El Salvador known as CECOT, which activists say is rife with abuses and where inmates are packed into cells and

never allowed outside. ICE officials admitted in court filings that his deportation there was an “administrative error.” Facing public pressure and a court order, President Donald Trump's Republican administration brought him back in June 2025, but only after securing an indictment charging him with human smuggling in Tennessee. A federal judge dismissed that case in May 2026, finding that the Justice Department's pursuit of criminal charges was designed to punish Abrego for challenging his deportation. The government is appealing.

The Washington Post

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OBITUARIES

FRED CLAIRE, 91

Ex-Dodgers general manager played big role in 1988 World Series victory

BY BETH HARRIS
Associated Press

Fred Claire, who parlayed early jobs as a sportswriter and editor into a 30-year career with the Los Angeles Dodgers in public relations and as a World Series-winning general manager, has died. He was 91.

Mr. Claire died Monday, on his 91st birthday, in Pasadena, the team announced Tuesday. Mr. Claire had entered hospice care recently.

In January 2015, at age 80, Mr. Claire was diagnosed with squamous cell skin cancer on his lip. He had the cells removed, but the cancer later returned in his jaw and again in his neck. He had surgery to remove a nerve on the left side of his face along with several lymph nodes. He underwent radiation, chemotherapy and immunotherapy as part of his 11-year journey with cancer.

He would jog regularly during his years on the road as the Dodgers general manager and said he was diligent about wearing sunscreen except on his lips.

“Fred brought many victories and Dodger legends to our franchise, as well as the 1988 World Series title,” team president and chief executive Stan Kasten said in a statement, “and we are forever grateful for his leadership during such a memorable era.”

From sportswriting to PR

Mr. Claire was covering the Dodgers during spring training in Florida for the Long Beach Press-Telegram in 1969 when one of the team's public relations assistants was fired.

He expressed interest in the job and was hired that July. He was promoted to vice president of public relations and promotions in 1975.

During his tenure, Mr. Claire was instrumental in creating the Dodger Blue branding and Think Blue campaign. The club drew 3.3 million fans in 1978, the first MLB team to exceed 3 million. He also hired announcer Ross Porter, who worked for the team from 1977 until being let go in 2004.

In 1976, Chicago Cubs outfielder Rick Monday ran over and saved an American flag from being burned on the Dodger Stadium field by two spectators. Mr. Claire directed the message board operator to type the words: “Rick Monday..... You Made a Great Play” on the board.

Patching up a scandal

In April 1987, a public relations firestorm occurred over comments 70-year-old general manager Al Campanis made on ABC's “Nightline.”

Campanis, who was white, was asked by host Ted Koppel about the lack of Black people in significant positions of authority in baseball.

“I truly believe they may not have some of the necessities to be, let's say, a field manager, or perhaps, a general manager,” Campanis said. “Why are Black people not good swimmers? Because they don't have buoyancy.”

Campanis had agreed to the interview without telling anyone in the Dodgers organization. Mr. Claire awoke the next day to a story about Campanis's comments in the newspaper.

“I couldn't believe what I was reading,” he wrote in his 2004 memoir.

Campanis had been Jackie

Robinson's roommate when the two were in the minor leagues in 1946, and he tutored Robinson in transitioning from shortstop to second base. Robinson broke baseball's color barrier with the Brooklyn Dodgers in 1947.

“Those who knew Al expressed shock. There had never been a hint of bigotry in anything he had ever said or done,” Mr. Claire wrote. “In my view, what Al had attempted to do that night was to defend his beloved game of baseball in an area where there was no defense.”

Campanis was fired after two decades as GM. Team owner Peter O'Malley handed control of one of the most storied teams in baseball to Mr. Claire. He accepted on the condition that he would have total and complete responsibility for baseball operations.

Mr. Claire wasn't intimidated, either, having been involved in discussions regarding free agents, arbitration and team payroll since becoming a team vice president in 1975.

In Mr. Claire's first full season as GM, the Dodgers finished with a 73-89 record in 1987. O'Malley informed Mr. Claire he was considering bringing in a more experienced person for the job. He called the New York

“Fred brought many victories and Dodger legends to our franchise, as well as the 1988 World Series title, and we are forever grateful for his leadership during such a memorable era.”

Stan Kasten, Dodgers president

Mets and asked for permission to speak to Joe McIlvaine, but was denied. O'Malley decided to stick with Mr. Claire.

“Fred was a talented team player and everyone in the organization enjoyed working with him,” O'Malley said in a statement.

Unforgettable season

In January 1988, Mr. Claire signed Kirk Gibson and the outfielder made a huge difference in the Dodgers winning the World Series in five games over the heavily favored Oakland Athletics that fall. An injured Gibson hobbled to the plate as a pinch-hitter in the bottom of the ninth inning with the Dodgers trailing 4-3 in Game 1. He launched a two-strike, two-run homer — one of the most dramatic moments in baseball history — off closer Dennis Eckersley into the right field seats to win the game, 5-4.

Mr. Claire was named baseball's executive of the year, an award previously won by such Dodger greats as Larry MacPhail, Branch Rickey, Walter O'Malley and Buzzie Bavasi.

The Dodgers returned to the playoffs just twice over the next decade, losing in the first round both times. It would be another

32 years before the Dodgers won the World Series again.

Mixed bag on trades

Among the trades that Mr. Claire was most proud of during his tenure as GM were those that brought John Shelby, Tim Belcher, Alfredo Griffin, Jay Howell, Jesse Orosco and John Tudor to Los Angeles — all of which had a connection with the 1988 World Series championship. He also traded for future Hall of Famer Eddie Murray in 1988 and again in 1997.

Two trades that Mr. Claire regretted were sending pitcher Pedro Martinez to the Montreal Expos and acquiring Eric Davis from Cincinnati. Martinez went on to win three Cy Young Awards with the Boston Red Sox, while Davis played two injury-plagued seasons in Los Angeles.

Beginning of the end

The O'Malley family sold the team to Rupert Murdoch's Fox Entertainment Group in March 1998.

Two months later, future Hall of Fame catcher and fan favorite Mike Piazza was traded to the Florida Marlins in a stunning seven-player deal struck without Mr. Claire's knowledge. It was pulled off by Fox television executive Chase Carey, who Mr. Claire said, was pursuing a regional TV sports channel in Florida and wanted the Marlins to be part of it.

“The seven-player trade was, first and foremost, a television deal. The new team owner simply did not understand the structure of a baseball team and the importance of a franchise player,” Mr. Claire wrote. “My reaction to the trade cost me my position with the Dodgers.”

Mr. Claire, along with manager Bill Russell, was fired by Fox on June 21, 1998, the same day Campanis died. Former Dodgers manager Tommy Lasorda took over as interim GM.

Mr. Claire never took another full-time job in baseball but stayed connected with the sport through a column and radio show for MLB.com, as a consultant for sports-related companies and by co-founding a baseball analytics company. He taught sports business courses at Caltech, the University of Southern California and Long Beach State.

A lifelong love affair

Born Fredic Marston Claire on Oct. 5, 1935, in Jamestown, Ohio, he cultivated his love of baseball while attending Cincinnati Reds games with his family at Crosley Field. He moved to Torrance, California, at age 15. He graduated from Torrance High, where he played junior varsity baseball and basketball. He graduated from San Jose State University with a journalism degree.

His first job out of college was as a sports writer for the Whittier Daily News at \$65 a week. During his time with the Progress-Bulletin in Pomona, he wrote the game story on the Dodgers winning Game 3 of the 1959 World Series against the Chicago White Sox, the team's first World Series win after moving to Los Angeles.

He later covered the then-California Angels for the Long Beach Press-Telegram and became the paper's beat writer for the Dodgers in 1969.

Mr. Claire is survived by wife Sheryl and children Jeff, Jennifer and Kim.

DEATH NOTICE

DEATH NOTICE

AVON



CANDACE JEAN AVON (Age 76)
Candace Jean Avon passed away on August 31, 2026, in Bonita Springs, Florida, while under the care of Hope Hospice.

Born on September 12, 1949, in Stockton, California, Candace was the daughter of Dorothy Fox and Jean Thomas Fox. She shared 50 years of marriage with her husband, Mark Avon, and her family also includes her brother, David Fox; her son, Michael Avon; daughter in law Diana Avon; and her three grandsons, Henry, Noah, and Gordon Avon.

Candace Jean Avon will be remembered with love by those who knew her and by the family members who were central to her life. Her passing leaves a lasting absence for her husband, son, brother, and grandchildren, as well as for others who held her dear.

A celebration of life will be held in Key West. Candace will be greatly thought of there, especially at the sight of pelicans and a sunset, a remembrance that was meaningful to her loved ones.

She will be sorely missed and lovingly remembered.

HARVEY



LARRY KEITH HARVEY
Larry Keith Harvey, 62, husband of Shelby Lynne (Fierazzo) Harvey, of Herndon, Virginia, passed away on Sunday, October 4, 2026 after a long battle with Early-Onset Alzheimer's Disease. Larry was born in Fairfax County, Virginia, on August 7, 1964 to Keith Jackson Harvey and Phyllis Jean (Connor) Voultsides. Larry was many things: a devoted Virginia Tech fan and alum, a Washington Redskins and Capitals fan, an enthusiast of food and red wine, and a wonderful son and friend. More than anything, he was a loving husband and father to his wife and children. He is survived, in addition to his wife, by his three children, Paige Quinn and her husband Liam Quinn, Lauren Smith and her husband

Zachary Smith, and Benjamin Harvey, by his four grandchildren, Nora Jean Smith, Austin Mark Quinn, Brooks Highland Smith, and Hannah Lynne Quinn, by his parents Keith Harvey and Phyllis Voultsides, by his sister Debra Joyce Moreland and her husband Dave, and by his dog, Bailey.

Larry was a recognized global real estate financial leader with extensive background in hospitality ownership, operation, and capital markets transactions. Larry was also a Certified Public Accountant. He had a strong work ethic and his career included time at Price Waterhouse/ PricewaterhouseCoopers, Host Marriott Corporation, Crestline Capital Corporation, eventually working his way up to Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer at Playa Hotels and Resorts B.V. from 2015-2017. In addition, Larry also served on numerous boards of directors of public companies, including: American Capital Agency, American Capital Mortgage, and American Capital Funding. Larry also served as a director of Helping Children Worldwide.

A Celebration of Life service will be held at Floris United Methodist Church in Herndon on Friday, October 9, at 10 am. A reception at International Country Club in Fairfax will follow at 11:30 am.

In lieu of flowers, please consider donating to the Alzheimer's Association in Larry's memory.

Friends and relatives may offer condolences online at:

www.moneyandking.com

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The Washington Post

IN MEMORIAM

BROWN



MARION E. BROWN (Age 98)
Happy heavenly 100th, Marion Brown My mom, Marion E. Brown left this life on October 20, 2024, 13 days after celebrating her 98th birthday. Mom was a loving matriarch to her sons and our wives, grandchildren and great grandchildren. She was a true friend that you could depend on. She brightened the day of anyone she met. She was a career pioneer as the first black administrative officer at the Bureau of Engraving and Printing. She was loved by all who knew her. She loved god and will live in our hearts always.

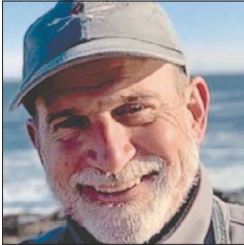
DEATH NOTICE

KOGOD



BONNIE ELLEN KOGOD
Bonnie Ellen Kogod of Boynton Beach, FL, and Washington, DC passed away on October 5, 2026, surrounded by family. She is preceded by her devoted husband, Bernie Kogod, and beloved daughter, Michele. She is survived by her loving daughter, Jamie Kogod Levin, and cherished grandchildren, Jackson and Charlotte Levin; Sister, Barbara Susan Kogod (late Dr. Melvin Kogod); as well as nieces, nephews, and many loving friends. The family will receive guests on Wednesday, October 7, 2026, 6-8pm at the home of her daughter Jamie Kogod Levin with Minyan at 7pm. Memorial contributions may be made in Bonnie's memory to The Michele Susan Kogod Memorial Foundation, via Hope Connections, 10100 Laureate Way, Bethesda, MD 20814 (hopeconnectionsforncare.org). Services entrusted to Sagel Bloomfield Danzansky Goldberg Funeral Care. www.sagelbloomfield.com

KOSNIK



CHRISTOPHER PAUL KOSNIK
Christopher Paul Kosnik ("Chris"), 64, of Quechee, VT, died peacefully on September 23, 2026, surrounded by his family after a long battle with early-onset Alzheimer's disease.

Chris devoted his career to international development and public service with the US Peace Corps and USAID. Above all, he was a devoted husband to Lindsay and father to Connor, Ian and Lucas.

A celebration of life will be held in early 2027 in Silver Spring, MD. Details will follow. Full obituary and memorial information available at rand-wilson.com.

KRAFT

JANE N. KRAFT (Age 95)
Jane N. Kraft of McLean, Va., passed away on October 4, 2026, surrounded by loving family, both two-and-four-legged, after suffering a stroke. Born May 23, 1931, in Chicago, to Dr. Emanuel Newman and Babette Newman, the family moved to Falls Church, Va., where she grew up. Jane was dedicated to her family and leadership roles in various Jewish organizations, including NOVA Brandeis National Committee and Beth El Hebrew Congregation in Alexandria, Va., where she served terms as president of both organizations.

Known as the “Enerziger Bunny” to her family, in addition to her volunteer work Jane was an astute businesswoman who for 20 years in the pre-online banking days operated a check cashing business in Ocean City, Md.

Jane was predeceased by her beloved husband Marvin Burstein and the youngest of her four children, David Kraft (Theresa). Jane is survived by her son Dr. Burton Kraft (Joanie), Andrea Tulla (David) and Cyndie Singer (Mitch). She also is survived by her two stepdaughters Susan Rashkin (Sam) and Sharon Franca (Jeff Davis).

Affectionally called “Gammmy,” she was the family matriarch who embraced modern technology, especially Facetime, to stay in touch with her 13 grandchildren and seven great-grandchildren. Services are private.

When the need arises, let families find you in the Funeral Services Directory.

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The Washington Post

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THE WEATHER

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Good day, sunshine

It will be sunny, with a high near 71 degrees and clear skies. Light wind from the south will increase throughout the morning, moving from 5 to 9 mph. It will be clear in the evening with a low around 55 degrees. Wind near 6 mph will blow in from the southwest steadily overnight.

● AccuWeather FORECAST

Today

Sunny

73°56°

REALFEEL®: 73°

CHANCE PRECIP: 0%

WIND: S 7-14 mph

HUMIDITY: Moderate

Thursday

Mostly sunny

83°55°

REALFEEL®: 83°

CHANCE PRECIP: 5%

WIND: WSW 6-12 mph

HUMIDITY: Moderate

Friday

Sunny

76°56°

REALFEEL®: 77°

CHANCE PRECIP: 5%

WIND: NNW 6-12 mph

HUMIDITY: Low

Saturday

Partly sunny

74°57°

REALFEEL®: 75°

CHANCE PRECIP: 10%

WIND: SSE 6-12 mph

HUMIDITY: Moderate

Sunday

Rain possible

71°64°

REALFEEL®: 70°

CHANCE PRECIP: 35%

WIND: NW 4-8 mph

HUMIDITY: High

Monday

Rain possible

73°61°

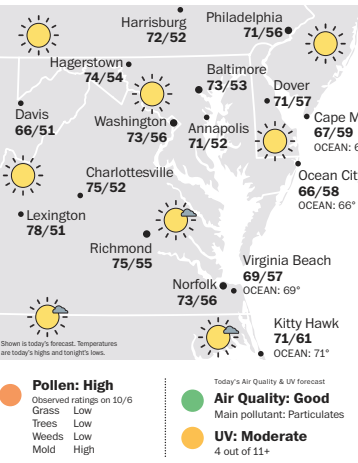
REALFEEL®: 74°

CHANCE PRECIP: 35%

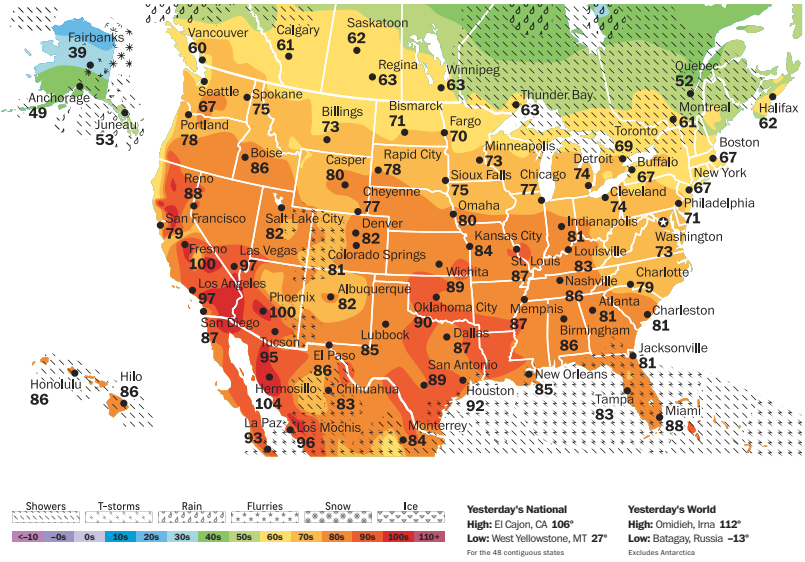
WIND: NW 4-8 mph

HUMIDITY: High

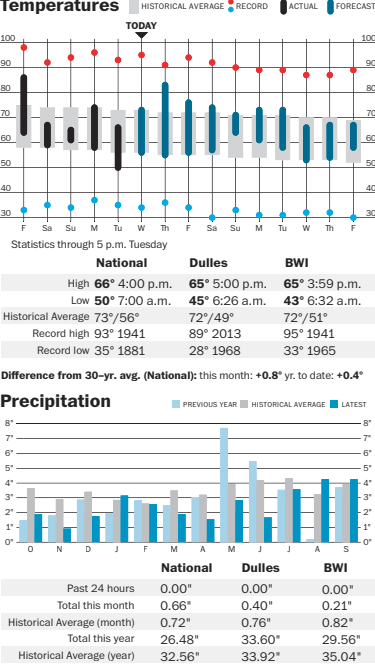
REGION TODAY



NATION TODAY



OFFICIAL RECORD



VIRGINIA

Assembly convenes in Williamsburg to celebrate 250 years of governance

BY MICHAEL MARTZ
Richmond Times-Dispatch

The General Assembly will revisit its birth on Wednesday, convening in Williamsburg exactly 250 years after the first meeting of the newly constituted legislature of the independent Commonwealth of Virginia.

Instead of a room full of men in powdered wigs, the assembly will meet in the reconstructed Capitol of Colonial Williamsburg in a commemorative session led by Virginia's first Black Speaker of the House of Delegates and feature a speech by the first woman elected governor, as well as a keynote address by a woman who ran for the United States presidency and now leads the Colonial Williamsburg Foundation.

The House invocation will be delivered by the pastor of one of the oldest African American churches in the United States, which also is celebrating its 250th anniversary this year.

But some things remain the same, especially the principles that guided Virginiato join 12 American colonies to declare their independence from Britain months earlier.

"Gathering where the foundations and cornerstones of American democracy were laid allows us to reflect deeply on the stewardship of our shared constitutional heritage," the assembly states in its program for the 250th anniversary. "As we walk the halls and stand in the appropriate chambers of the carefully reconstructed Capitolwhere the transition from subjects to citizens took place, we reaffirm our commitment to the representative ideals that continue to guide the Commonwealth of Virginia."

The joint meeting of the assembly is one of the signature events of Virginia250, a bipartisan commission to oversee the state's commemoration of American independence. The session is co-sponsored by Virginia250 and the Colonial Williamsburg Foundation, working with the House and Senate clerks.

As Virginia250 planned events for the sesquicentennial year, "We said, 'Why not do a commemorative session of where it all started?'" said Sen. Mamie Locke (D-Hampton), who is vice chair of the commission.

"It's part of Virginia history," said Locke, who said the commission wants to "see how we can reconnect people to civic education."

Virginia declared its independence from Britain with the adoption of its first Constitution on June 29, 1776, five days before the Continental Congress signed the Declaration of Independence. The State Constitution created an elected General Assembly out of what had been, since 1619 in Jamestown, a representative House of Burgesses and a Privy Council of 12 men who were handpicked by the royal governor on behalf of the King of England.

On Oct. 7, 1776, an elected House of Delegates and Senate convened in what had been the Colonial Capitol in Williamsburg for a legislative session that House Clerk Paul Nardo said "marked Virginia's transition from Colony to Commonwealth." The session ended on Dec. 21, 1776.

The bicameral legislature then didn't consist of 100 delegates and 40 senators, as it does now. Instead, it consisted of 120 delegates who had already been elected to serve in the Fifth Virginia Convention— which had adopted the Constitution, a Declaration of Rights and moved for independence from Britain— and more than 20 newly elected senators.

On Wednesday, the House of Delegates will meet at 2:30 p.m. in the House of Burgesses chamber, beginning with an invocation by the Rev. Dr. Reginald L. Davis, pastor of the Historic First Baptist Church of Williamsburg, founded in 1776 by enslaved and free Black people, initially under a "brush arbor" on a nearby plantation.

The Senate will come into session at the same time in the upstairs room where the for-

mer royal council would have met before independence. The Senate will come downstairs to the House chamber for a joint session of the General Assembly, expected to begin at about 2:45 p.m.

House Speaker Don Scott (D-Portsmouth) will gavel the assembly into session. Nardo and Senate Clerk Susan Clarke Schaarwill call the rolls of their respective chambers. A bipartisan committee of delegates and senators will invite "distinguished guests" onto the House floor.

Those guests will include two former governors: Gov. L. Douglas Wilder, a Democrat and the country's first Black elected governor, who served from 1990 to 1994; and Gov. Jim Gilmore, a Republican who served from 1998 to 2002.

They will also include Carly Fiorina, president and chief executive officer of the Colonial Williamsburg Foundation. Fiorina, a former corporate business executive who ran for the Republican nomination for president in 2016, will deliver the keynote address.

She will be followed by Gov. Abigail Spanberger (D), elected last year as Virginia's first female governor, who will speak to the joint assembly.

The joint assembly will end after the formal presentation of a ceremonial mace — an ornamental staff used to signify when the House is in session — that the Colonial Williamsburg Foundation had crafted to the specifications of the mace that each of the colonies received from the English Crown to signify their authority to legislate on its behalf. Virginia sold its colonial mace after declaring independence and did without one until 1974, when it received a mace from the Jamestown-Yorktown Foundation, which the House still uses at each session.

The public will be able to watch it all by livestream on the websites of Virginia250 (va250.org/general-assembly-250) and the General Assembly vga.virginia.gov).



The Right Rev. Mariann Edgar Budde plans to move back to her home state of Minnesota.

THE DISTRICT

Episcopalian bishop who implored Trump to 'have mercy' resigns post

Spiritual leader says this is not goodbye, but it's time to pass the torch

BY JASMINE GOLDEN

The Right Rev. Mariann Edgar Budde, the Episcopal bishop of Washington who became a well-known figure in large part for her disputes with President Donald Trump, has announced

her resignation.

Budde said in a letter addressed to friends of the Diocese of Washington that "it is time to begin preparing for the election of your next bishop."

"This is not a goodbye — it's the beginning of a sacred process," Budde said in the statement.

She told Religion News Service that she plans to move back to her home state of Minnesota.

The first woman to be elected as the spiritual leader of the Episcopal Diocese of Washing-

ton, Budde has served since 2011. In recent years, her profile became synonymous with resisting Trump.

Perhaps most notably, during the interfaith inauguration prayer service to mark Trump's second term, she pleaded with him to "have mercy" on immigrants, LGBTQ children and others.

"In the name of God, I ask you to have mercy upon the people in our country who are scared now," she said.

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Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Reginald H. Bryant and Cindy O. Bryant, dated October 20, 2006 and recorded in Liber 26579, folio 148 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 AT 11:08 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with the buildings and improvements thereon situated in Prince George's County, MD and described as follows: Being known and designated as Lot No. 41, Block 18, as shown on Plat entitled "Section Two, Plat Two, Belhaviour Estates", which Plat is recorded among the Land Records of Prince George's County in Plat Book WJ 183 at Plat 41. Tax ID #13-3166261.

The property, which is improved by a dwelling, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$30,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for Prince George's County. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received in the office of the Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. **TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER.** There will be no reduction of interest due to overpayment of deposit. Adjustment of all real property taxes (excluding recapture of previously reduced or exempt taxes) and any other public charges or assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, and ground rent to be adjusted to date of sale and paid at execution of the deed, except where the secured party is the purchaser, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All due and/or unpaid private utility, water and sewer facilities charges, condo/HOA assessments and Columbia Assoc. assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, are payable by the purchaser without adjustment. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes, recaptured taxes (including but not limited to agricultural taxes), and settlement expenses shall be borne by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. Additional terms to be announced at the time of sale. **THIS TRANSACTION MAY BE SUBJECT TO THE FINCEN RESIDENTIAL REAL ESTATE REPORTING RULE ("RRE RULE"). INFORMATION NECESSARY TO COMPLY WITH THE RRE RULE MUST BE PROVIDED TO THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEES PRIOR TO CLOSING. FAILURE TO PROVIDE REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION FOR FINCEN REPORTING WILL BE CONSIDERED A DEFAULT. ADDITIONALLY, FAILURE TO PROVIDE THE REQUIRED INFORMATION UNDER SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES COULD RESULT IN THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEE NOT EXECUTING THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEES DEED. INTEREST WILL CONTINUE TO ACCRUE AND REMAIN THE SUCCESSFUL BIDDER'S RESPONSIBILITY UNTIL THE INFORMATION IS PROVIDED.**

If the Trustees are unable to convey good and marketable title, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, subject to order of the court, the entire deposit (including any amount received over the advertised deposit amount) shall be forfeited to the Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulting purchaser and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorney's fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the resale. Defaulting purchaser waives personal service of any document filed in connection with such a motion on him/ herself and/or any principal or corporate designee, and expressly agrees to accept service of any such document by regular mail directed to the address provided by said purchaser at the time of the foreclosure auction. Trustees' file number 22-001199-MD-F-1.

Diane S. Rosenberg, Mark D. Meyer, et al., Trustees



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www.alexcooper.com

Oct 7,14,21, 2026

0012527914

TRUSTEE'S SALE
8420 Canning Terrace, Greenbelt, MD 20770

Trustee's Sale of valuable fee simple property improved by premises known as 8420 Canning Terrace, Greenbelt, MD 20770. By virtue of the power and authority contained in a Deed of Trust, dated June 25, 2007, and recorded in Liber 28249 at Page 432 among the land records of the County of Prince George's, in the original principal amount of \$233,750.00. Upon request for sale, the undersigned trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Courthouse for the COUNTY OF PRINCE GEORGE'S, at the front of the Duval Wing of the Courthouse complex located at 14735 Main Street, Upper Marlboro, Maryland 20772, on **October 13, 2026 at 2:00 PM**, all that property described in said Deed of Trust including but not limited to:

Tax ID# 21-2415073

Said property is in fee simple and is improved by a dwelling and is sold in "as is condition" and subject to all superior covenants, conditions, liens, restrictions, easement, rights-of-way, as may affect same, if any.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of 10% of the sale price, cash or certified funds shall be required at the time of sale. The balance of the purchase price will be interest at 6.00% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale.

Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser.

If applicable, condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is the return of the deposit. Trustee's File No. 18-279230.

If this transaction is subject to the Fincen Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within fifteen days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale.

William M. Savage, et al., Substitute Trustees.

LOGS LEGAL GROUP LLP
Mailing Address: 8520 Cliff Cameron Dr., Suite 330,
Charlotte, North Carolina 28269
(410) 769-9797



Oct 23,30,Oct 7, 2026 0012525645

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Prince Georges County

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Prince Georges County

Rosenberg & Associates, LLC
4340 East West Highway, Suite 600
Bethesda, MD 20814
(301) 907-8000
www.rosenberg-assoc.com

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY**

**14812 DUNBARTON DRIVE
UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772**

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Reginald Jackson dated October 5, 2022 and recorded in Liber 48209, folio 269 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 AT 11:06 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with the buildings and improvements thereon situated in Prince George's County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. Tax ID #03-0204721.

The property, which is improved by a dwelling, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$30,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for Prince George's County. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received in the office of the Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. **TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER.** There will be no reduction of interest due to overpayment of deposit. Adjustment of all real property taxes (excluding recapture of previously reduced or exempt taxes) and any other public charges or assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, and ground rent to be adjusted to date of sale and paid at execution of the deed, except where the secured party is the purchaser, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All due and/or unpaid private utility, water and sewer facilities charges, condo/HOA assessments and Columbia Assoc. assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, are payable by the purchaser without adjustment. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes, recaptured taxes (including but not limited to agricultural taxes), and settlement expenses shall be borne by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. Additional terms to be announced at the time of sale. **THIS TRANSACTION MAY BE SUBJECT TO THE FINCEN RESIDENTIAL REAL ESTATE REPORTING RULE ("RRE RULE"). INFORMATION NECESSARY TO COMPLY WITH THE RRE RULE MUST BE PROVIDED TO THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEES PRIOR TO CLOSING. FAILURE TO PROVIDE REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION FOR FINCEN REPORTING WILL BE CONSIDERED A DEFAULT. ADDITIONALLY, FAILURE TO PROVIDE THE REQUIRED INFORMATION UNDER SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES COULD RESULT IN THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEE NOT EXECUTING THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEES DEED. INTEREST WILL CONTINUE TO ACCRUE AND REMAIN THE SUCCESSFUL BIDDER'S RESPONSIBILITY UNTIL THE INFORMATION IS PROVIDED.**

If the Trustees are unable to convey good and marketable title, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, subject to order of the court, the entire deposit (including any amount received over the advertised deposit amount) shall be forfeited to the Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulting purchaser and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorney's fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the resale. Defaulting purchaser waives personal service of any document filed in connection with such a motion on him/ herself and/or any principal or corporate designee, and expressly agrees to accept service of any such document by regular mail directed to the address provided by said purchaser at the time of the foreclosure auction. Trustees' file number 23-001422-MD-F-3.

The property will be sold subject to a 120 day right of redemption by the Internal Revenue Service.

Diane S. Rosenberg, Mark D. Meyer, et al., Trustees



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Oct 7,14,21, 2026

0012527913

TRUSTEE'S SALE
202 Manor Terrace, Hyattsville, MD 20785

Trustee's Sale of valuable fee simple property improved by premises known as 202 Manor Terrace, Hyattsville, MD 20785. By virtue of the power and authority contained in a Deed of Trust, dated December 28, 2006, and recorded in Liber 27048 at Page 637 among the land records of the County of Prince George's, in the original principal amount of \$208,000.00. Upon request for sale, the undersigned trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Courthouse for the COUNTY OF PRINCE GEORGE'S, at the front of the Duval Wing of the Courthouse complex located at 14735 Main Street, Upper Marlboro, Maryland 20772, on **October 13, 2026 at 2:00 PM**, all that property described in said Deed of Trust including but not limited to:

Tax ID# 18-2075109

Said property is in fee simple and is improved by a dwelling and is sold in "as is condition" and subject to all superior covenants, conditions, liens, restrictions, easement, rights-of-way, as may affect same, if any.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of 10% of the sale price, cash or certified funds shall be required at the time of sale. The balance of the purchase price will be interest at 6.00% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale.

Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser.

If applicable, condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is the return of the deposit. Trustee's File No. 24-29744.

If this transaction is subject to the Fincen Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within fifteen days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale.

William M. Savage, et al., Substitute Trustees.

LOGS LEGAL GROUP LLP
Mailing Address: 8520 Cliff Cameron Dr., Suite 330,
Charlotte, North Carolina 28269
(410) 769-9797



Oct 23,30,Oct 7, 2026 0012525617

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Rosenberg & Associates, LLC
4340 East West Highway, Suite 600
Bethesda, MD 20814
(301) 907-8000
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**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY**

**704 QUARRY AVENUE
CAPITOL HEIGHTS, MD 20743**

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Jasper Lee Brown dated March 17, 2005 and recorded in Liber 21972, folio 208 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 AT 11:04 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with the buildings and improvements thereon situated in Prince George's County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. Tax ID #18-1997717.

The property, which is improved by a dwelling, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$20,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for Prince George's County. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received in the office of the Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. **TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER.** There will be no reduction of interest due to overpayment of deposit. Adjustment of all real property taxes (excluding recapture of previously reduced or exempt taxes) and any other public charges or assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, and ground rent to be adjusted to date of sale and paid at execution of the deed, except where the secured party is the purchaser, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All due and/or unpaid private utility, water and sewer facilities charges, condo/HOA assessments and Columbia Assoc. assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, are payable by the purchaser without adjustment. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes, recaptured taxes (including but not limited to agricultural taxes), and settlement expenses shall be borne by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. Additional terms to be announced at the time of sale. **THIS TRANSACTION MAY BE SUBJECT TO THE FINCEN RESIDENTIAL REAL ESTATE REPORTING RULE ("RRE RULE"). INFORMATION NECESSARY TO COMPLY WITH THE RRE RULE MUST BE PROVIDED TO THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEES PRIOR TO CLOSING. FAILURE TO PROVIDE REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION FOR FINCEN REPORTING WILL BE CONSIDERED A DEFAULT. ADDITIONALLY, FAILURE TO PROVIDE THE REQUIRED INFORMATION UNDER SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES COULD RESULT IN THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEE NOT EXECUTING THE SUBSTITUTION TRUSTEES DEED. INTEREST WILL CONTINUE TO ACCRUE AND REMAIN THE SUCCESSFUL BIDDER'S RESPONSIBILITY UNTIL THE INFORMATION IS PROVIDED.**

If the Trustees are unable to convey good and marketable title, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, subject to order of the court, the entire deposit (including any amount received over the advertised deposit amount) shall be forfeited to the Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulting purchaser and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorney's fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the resale. Defaulting purchaser waives personal service of any document filed in connection with such a motion on him/ herself and/or any principal or corporate designee, and expressly agrees to accept service of any such document by regular mail directed to the address provided by said purchaser at the time of the foreclosure auction. Trustees' file number 22-000956-MD-F-1.

The property will be sold subject to a 120 day right of redemption by the Internal Revenue Service.

Diane S. Rosenberg, Mark D. Meyer, et al., Trustees



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Oct 7,14,21, 2026

0012527912

TRUSTEE'S SALE
8829 Fairhaven Avenue, Upper Marlboro, MD 20772

Trustee's Sale of valuable fee simple property improved by premises known as 8829 Fairhaven Avenue, Upper Marlboro, MD 20772. By virtue of the power and authority contained in a Deed of Trust, dated January 15, 2015, and recorded in Liber 36713 at Page 583 among the land records of the County of Prince George's, in the original principal amount of \$203,978.00. Upon request for sale, the undersigned trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Courthouse for the COUNTY OF PRINCE GEORGE'S, at the front of the Duval Wing of the Courthouse complex located at 14735 Main Street, Upper Marlboro, Maryland 20772, on **October 27, 2026 at 2:00 PM**, all that property described in said Deed of Trust including but not limited to:

Tax ID# 15-1724178

Said property is in fee simple and is improved by a dwelling and is sold in "as is condition" and subject to all superior covenants, conditions, liens, restrictions, easement, rights-of-way, as may affect same, if any.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of 10% of the sale price, cash or certified funds shall be required at the time of sale. The balance of the purchase price will be interest at 6.00% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale.

Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser.

If applicable, condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is the return of the deposit. Trustee's File No. 23-292847.

If this transaction is subject to the Fincen Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within fifteen days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale.

William M. Savage, et al., Substitute Trustees.

LOGS LEGAL GROUP LLP
Mailing Address: 8520 Cliff Cameron Dr., Suite 330,
Charlotte, North Carolina 28269
(410) 769-9797



Oct 7,14,21, 2026 0012524988

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Prince Georges County

Aldridge Pile LLP
6001 Everlong Road, Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
(301)-961-6555

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON**

**16102 PARKLAWN PLACE
BOWIE, MD 20716**

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated April 14, 2025, recorded in Liber 50891, Folio 411 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$463,334.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 AT 10:49 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Prince George's County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$47,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. **TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER.** Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any other public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 380642-1).



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Sep 30,Oct 7,14, 2026

0012526953

Friedman Vartolo LLP
1325 Franklin Avenue Suite 160
Garden City, NY 11530
212-471-5100

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY**

**10137 PRINCE PLACE, UNIT #301
UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20774**

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Forlunoso Allan Olunrolusa and Juliet O. Olunrolusa, dated March 23, 2007 and recorded in Liber 27493, folio 297 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof and at the request of the parties and the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 AT 10:45 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON situated in Prince George's County, Maryland and described as Unit No. 301-6B in a Condominium known as "Treetop Condominium" and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. The property is improved by a dwelling.

Property Address (for Informational Purposes): 10137 Prince Place, Unit #301, Upper Marlboro MD 20774

Tax ID Number: 13-1421361

The foreclosure sale advertised herein has been docketed in the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, Maryland, as Case No. C-16-CV-26-001907

The property, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, encumbrances and agreements of record affecting the subject property, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit in the form of cashier's or certified check, or in such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine, at their sole discretion, for \$15,000 at the time of sale. If the noteholder and/or servicer is the successful bidder, the deposit requirement is waived. Balance of the purchase price is to be paid within fifteen (15) days of the final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, Maryland. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase price at the rate of 4.00000% per annum from date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Substitute Trustees, if the property is purchased by an entity other than the noteholder and/or servicer. If payment of the balance does not occur within fifteen days of ratification, the deposit will be forfeited and liquidated damages. The purchaser agrees that the property may be resold pursuant to an order of court, waives personal service upon themselves and/or any principal or corporate designee of any documents filed regarding the failure to pay the purchase price within ten (10) days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail of said documents at the address provided by the purchaser in the Memorandum of Sale. This transaction may be subject to the Fincen Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE Rule") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, effective March 1, 2026. Purchaser will be responsible for obtaining the information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule and for providing the necessary information to the Reporting Person, as defined in the RRE Rule within (10) ten days following Ratification of the Sale or Purchaser's deposit will be forfeited and property resold. The purchaser will not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from a resale even if they are the result of improvements made by the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event settlement is delayed for any reason. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, and all other public charges and assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, and front foot benefit charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to the date of sale, and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes (including agricultural transfer taxes, if applicable), and all settlement charges shall be borne by the purchaser. The sale is subject to a post sale audit of the loan, including but not limited to an analysis of whether the borrower entered into a loan modification agreement, filed bankruptcy, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. The Substitute Trustees will convey either insurable or marketable title. If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey insurable or marketable title or, the post sale audit concludes that the sale should not have occurred, or the sale is not ratified by the court for any reason, the purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the deposit without interest even if the purchaser has made improvements to the property. Upon refund of the deposit, the sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. The purchaser at the foreclosure sale shall assume the risk of loss for the property immediately after the sale. (Matter #252520-1).

The property will be sold subject to a 120 day right of redemption by the Internal Revenue Service.



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Oct 7,14,21, 2026

0012527908

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Prince Georges County

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Prince Georges County

GREENSPOON MARDER, LLP
201 International Blvd, Suite 230
Hunt Valley, MD 21030

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
9010 TOCCA DRIVE
Clinton, MD 20735**

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from LUTHER C. SUMMERS AND JEAN P. SUMMERS, dated June 26, 2008 and recorded in book 29838, page 237 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-16-CV-26-000922. Tax ID No. 09-0977314) the Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY courthouse located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772 .

OCTOBER 22, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 56,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at five percent (5%) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey marketable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 24-000834-01)

NICOLE LIPINSKI, GABRIELE GIOVINAZZO, ERIN KENNEDY, Substitute Trustee (s)



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Oct 7,14,21, 2026

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

12217 LISBOROUGH ROAD

BOWIE, MD 20720

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated June 8, 2012, recorded in Liber 32420, Folio 457 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$494,250.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 AT 10-45 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Prince George's County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$22,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 372984-2)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al, Substitute Trustees



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Sep 30,Oct 7,14, 2026

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

14401 WOODMORE OAKS COURT

BOWIE, MD 20721

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated March 8, 2006, recorded in Liber 25302, Folio 588 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$1,120,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 AT 10-41 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Prince George's County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$74,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 309027-3)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al, Substitute Trustees



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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

9002 CONTINENTAL PLACE

HYATTSVILLE, MD 20785

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated May 25, 2007, recorded in Liber 34123, Folio 118 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$211,650.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 AT 10-37 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Prince George's County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$21,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 354836-2)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al, Substitute Trustees



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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

184 LEEDS CREEK CIRCLE

ODENTON, MD 21113

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated December 15, 2004, recorded in Liber 16155, Folio 315 among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$152,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County, at the Court House Door, 8 Church Circle, Annapolis, MD 21401, on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 AT 9:24 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Anne Arundel County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind. The property will be sold subject to a prior mortgage, the amount to be announced at the time of sale.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$6,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 1212-0438)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al, Substitute Trustees



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Oct 7,14,21, 2026

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

4514 EDEN PARK LANE

UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated Jimmie Lee Williams and Monica E. Cooke-Williams dated January 13, 2022 and recorded in Liber 47023, Folio 316 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 AT 10-32 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with the buildings and improvements thereon situated in Prince George's County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. Tax ID #06-5535211.

The property, which is improved by a dwelling, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$30,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for Prince George's County. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received in the office of the Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. There will be no reduction of interest due to overpayment of deposit. Adjustment of all real property taxes (excluding recapture of previously reduced exemption) and any other public charges or assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, and ground rent to be adjusted to date of sale and paid at execution of the deed, except where the secured party is the purchaser, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All due and/or unpaid private utility, water and sewer facilities charges, condo/HOA assessments and Columbia Assoc. assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, are payable by the purchaser without adjustment. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes, recaptured taxes (including but not limited to agricultural taxes), and settlement expenses shall be borne by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. Additional terms to be announced at the time of sale. THIS TRANSACTION MAY BE SUBJECT TO THE FINCEN RESIDENTIAL REAL ESTATE REPORTING RULE ("RRE RULE"). INFORMATION NECESSARY TO COMPLY WITH THE RRE RULE MUST BE PROVIDED TO THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES PRIOR TO CLOSING. FAILURE TO PROVIDE REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION FOR FINCEN REPORTING WILL BE CONSIDERED A DEFAULT. ADDITIONALLY FAILURE TO PROVIDE THE REQUIRED INFORMATION UNDER SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES COULD RESULT IN THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES NOT EXECUTING THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' INTEREST WILL CONTINUE TO ACCRUE AND REMAIN THE SUCCESSFUL BIDDER'S RESPONSIBILITY UNTIL THE INFORMATION IS PROVIDED.

If the Trustees are unable to convey good and marketable title, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, subject to order of the court, the entire deposit (including any amount received over the advertised deposit amount) shall be forfeited to the Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulting purchaser and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorney's fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the resale. Defaulting purchaser waives personal service of any document filed in connection with such a motion on him/ herself and/or any principal or corporate designee, and expressly agrees to accept service of any such document by regular mail directed to the address provided by said purchaser at the time of the foreclosure auction. Trustees' file number 23-000963-MD-F-2.

Diane S. Rosenberg, Mark D. Meyer, et al., Trustees



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Sep 30,Oct 7,14, 2026

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TRUSTEE'S SALE

217 5th Avenue SW, Glen Burnie, MD 21061

Trustee's Sale of valuable fee simple property improved by premises known as 217 5th Avenue SW, Glen Burnie, MD 21061. By virtue of the power and authority contained in a Deed of Trust, dated September 15, 2006, and recorded in Liber 18439 at Page 689 among the land records of the County of Anne Arundel, in the original principal amount of \$316,800.00. Upon default and request for sale, the undersigned trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Courthouse for the COUNTY OF ANNE ARUNDEL, at 8 Church Circle, Annapolis, Maryland, on **October 27, 2026 at 4:00 PM**, all that property described in said Deed of Trust including but not limited to:

Tax ID# 03-362-90077026

Said property is in fee simple and is improved by a dwelling and is sold in "as is condition" and subject to all superior covenants, conditions, liens, restrictions, easement, rights-of-way, as may affect same, if any.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of 10% of the sale price, cash or certified funds shall be required at the time of sale. The balance of the purchase price with interest at 6.00% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale.

Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser.

If applicable, condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveying, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is the return of the deposit. Trustee's File No. 26-301492.

If this transaction is subject to the FINCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within fifteen days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale.

William M. Savage, et al., Substitute Trustees.



300 E. Joppa Road
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Beltsville, MD 21718
410-769-9797

LOGS LEGAL GROUP LLP

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A181, A316, A311, A183, A425, A426, A461, A463, A508

Sep 23,Oct 7, 2026

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Bethesda, MD 20814

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

15312 MAPLE DRIVE

ACCOCKKEE, MD 20607

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Leroy Williams Jr, dated April 26, 2010 and recorded in Liber 31666, folio 257 and re-recorded in Liber 48596, Folio 82 among the Land Records of Prince George's County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Prince George's County, 14735 Main St., Upper Marlboro, MD, 20772 (Duval Wing entrance, located on Main St.), on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 AT 10-30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with the buildings and improvements thereon situated in Prince George's County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. Tax ID #05-0386763.

The property, which is improved by a dwelling, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$20,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for Prince George's County. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received in the office of the Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. There will be no reduction of interest due to overpayment of deposit. Adjustment of all real property taxes (excluding recapture of previously reduced exemption) and any other public charges or assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, and ground rent to be adjusted to date of sale and paid at execution of the deed, except where the secured party is the purchaser, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All due and/or unpaid private utility, water and sewer facilities charges, condo/HOA assessments and Columbia Assoc. assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, are payable by the purchaser without adjustment. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes, recaptured taxes (including but not limited to agricultural taxes), and settlement expenses shall be borne by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. Additional terms to be announced at the time of sale. THIS TRANSACTION MAY BE SUBJECT TO THE FINCEN RESIDENTIAL REAL ESTATE REPORTING RULE ("RRE RULE"). INFORMATION NECESSARY TO COMPLY WITH THE RRE RULE MUST BE PROVIDED TO THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES PRIOR TO CLOSING. FAILURE TO PROVIDE REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION FOR FINCEN REPORTING WILL BE CONSIDERED A DEFAULT. ADDITIONALLY FAILURE TO PROVIDE THE REQUIRED INFORMATION UNDER SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES COULD RESULT IN THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES NOT EXECUTING THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' INTEREST WILL CONTINUE TO ACCRUE AND REMAIN THE SUCCESSFUL BIDDER'S RESPONSIBILITY UNTIL THE INFORMATION IS PROVIDED.

If the Trustees are unable to convey good and marketable title, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, subject to order of the court, the entire deposit (including any amount received over the advertised deposit amount) shall be forfeited to the Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulting purchaser and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorney's fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the resale. Defaulting purchaser waives personal service of any document filed in connection with such a motion on him/ herself and/or any principal or corporate designee, and expressly agrees to accept service of any such document by regular mail directed to the address provided by said purchaser at the time of the foreclosure auction. Trustees' file number 22-002387-MD-F-1.

Diane S. Rosenberg, Mark D. Meyer, et al., Trustees



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Sep 30,Oct 7,14, 2026

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TRUSTEE'S SALE

342 Dameron South, Laurel, MD 20724

Trustee's Sale of valuable fee simple property improved by premises known as 342 Dameron South, Laurel, MD 20724. By virtue of the power and authority contained in a Deed of Trust, dated March 29, 2007, and recorded in Liber 19230 at Page 497 among the land records of the County of Anne Arundel, in the original principal amount of \$268,000.00. Upon default and request for sale, the undersigned trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Courthouse for the COUNTY OF ANNE ARUNDEL, at 8 Church Circle, Annapolis, Maryland, on **October 13, 2026 at 4:00 PM**, all that property described in said Deed of Trust including but not limited to:

Tax ID# 04-472-03488000

Said property is in fee simple and is improved by a dwelling and is sold in "as is condition" and subject to all superior covenants, conditions, liens, restrictions, easement, rights-of-way, as may affect same, if any.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of 10% of the sale price, cash or certified funds shall be required at the time of sale. The balance of the purchase price with interest at 6.00% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale.

Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser.

If applicable, condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveying, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is the return of the deposit. Trustee's File No. 24-297097.

If this transaction is subject to the FINCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within fifteen days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale.

William M. Savage, et al., Substitute Trustees.



300 E. Joppa Road
Harford Parkdale, Suite 103
Beltsville, MD 21718
410-769-9797

LOGS LEGAL GROUP LLP

Mailing Address: 8520 Cliff Cameron Dr., Suite 330,
Charlotte, North Carolina 28269

(410) 769-9797

A181, A316, A311, A183, A425, A426, A461, A463, A508

Sep 23,Oct 7, 2026

0012526616

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Anne Arundel County

Aldridge Pite LLP

6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200

Rockville, MD 20852

301-961-6555

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Anne Arundel County

Aldridge Pite LLP

6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200

Rockville, MD 20852

301-961-6555

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

7965 FOSTER AVENUE
SEVERN, MD 21144

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated March 28, 2014, recorded in Liber 27164, Folio 354 among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$212,500.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County, at the Court House Door, 8 Church Circle, Annapolis, MD 21401, on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 at 9:22 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Anne Arundel County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$20,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 1113-1043B)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al, Substitute Trustees
LICENSE NOS. A000113, A000176, A000177, A000193, A000424, A000479, A000507, A000508

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Oct 7,14,21, 2026 0012527399

874

Fairfax County

TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
1550 Moorings Drive 2C,
Reston, VA 20190

874

Spotsylvania County

TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
5063 LARRY LAKE,
FREDERICKSBURG, VA 22407

In execution of a Deed of Trust in the original principal amount of \$332,405.00 dated August 10, 2021 recorded in the Land Records of the Circuit Court for Fairfax County, Virginia, as instrument No. 2021126218-02, the undersigned appointed Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction, at the Main entrance of the courthouse for the Circuit Court of Fairfax County, 4110 Chain Bridge Rd., Fairfax, VA 22030 on **November 23, 2026 at 11:30 AM** the property described in said deed of trust, located at the above address and briefly described as condominium Unit Numbered 1550-2C, LAKEVIEW CONDOMINIUM as described in that certain Declaration establishing a Condominium with attached plans and plan designating the relative location and identification of each unit recorded in Deed Book 4425 at Page 795, and any and all subsequent amendments recorded thereon, among the Land Records of Fairfax County, Virginia, as follows:

TOGETHER WITH the use and enjoyment of the Common Elements appurtenant thereto, as shown in the Record of Reservations for said Condominium, as amended, Tax ID: 0172 251A002C.

TERMS OF SALE: A bidder's deposit of \$12,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required in the form of cash or cashier's check. Cash will not be accepted as a deposit of the sale price. Within fifteen (15) days of sale, otherwise Trustee may forfeit deposit. FIDEN requirement will be required on all successful purchasers, absent full payment upon sale. The sale is subject to the terms and conditions to be announced at sale. This is a communication from a debt collector and is not an attempt to collect on a debt and no communication should be used for that purpose. (Trustee # 26-007982)

Substitute Trustee: ALG Trust-Lite, LLC C/O Oriana Law Group PLLC PO Box 2548, Leesburg, VA 20177 (703) 777-7101 website: www.oriangelaw.com. The auction will be used in conjunction with this sale. Potential bidders: For sale information, please visit www.Auction.com or call (800) 280-2652.

Oct 7,14,21, 2026 0012502887

This is a communication from a debt collector and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. The sale is subject to seller confirmation. Substitute Trustee: Equities Trustes, LLC, 8100 Three Chopt Road, Suite 240, Richmond, VA 23229. If you have any questions or concerns, please contact the Virginia Pre-Sale Department of counsel for Equities Trustes, LLC at 301-961-6555, website: www.alexdrpide.com.VA-385406-1

Oct 7,14,21, 2026 0012501513

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Anne Arundel County

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Laurel, MD 20707

www.mwc-law.com

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Anne Arundel County

McCabe, Weisberg & Conway, LLC

312 Marshall Blvd., Suite 800

Laurel, MD 20707

www.mwc-law.com

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

213 FRANKLE STREET
BROOKLYN, MD 21225

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Allan Creek and Almira F. Creek, dated May 17, 2006 and recorded in Liber 17948, folio 201 among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof and at the request of the parties secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County, at the Court House Door, 8 Church Circle, Annapolis, MD 21401, on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 at 9:15 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON situated in Anne Arundel County, Maryland and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. The property is improved by a dwelling.

The property, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, encumbrances and agreements of record affecting the subject property, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit in the form of cashier's or certified check, or in such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine, at their sole discretion, for \$18,000 at the time of sale. If the bidder is not the successful bidder, the deposit requirement is waived. Balance of the purchase price is to be paid within ten (10) days of the final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County, Maryland. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase price at the rate of 5% per annum from date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Substitute Trustees, if the property is purchased by an entity other than the noteholder and/or servicer. If payment of the balance does not occur within ten (10) days of ratification, the deposit will be forfeited as liquidated damages. The purchaser agrees that the property may be resold pursuant to an order of court, waives personal service upon themselves and/or any principal or corporate designee of any documents filed regarding the failure to pay the purchase price within ten (10) days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail of said documents at the address provided by the purchaser in the Memorandum of Sale. This TRANSACTION MAY BE SUBJECT TO THE FIDEN RESIDENTIAL REAL ESTATE REPORTING RULE ("RRE Rule") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, effective March 1, 2026. Purchaser will be responsible for obtaining the information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule and for providing the necessary information to the Reporting Person, as defined in the RRE Rule within (10) ten days following Ratification of the Sale or Purchaser's deposit with the noteholder and/or servicer. The purchaser will not be entitled to any surplus or profits arising from the resale even if they are the result of improvements made by the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event settlement is delayed for any reason. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, and all other public charges and assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, and front foot benefit charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the time of sale and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes (including agricultural transfer taxes, if applicable), and all settlement charges shall be borne by the purchaser. The sale is subject to a post sale audit of the loan, including but not limited to an analysis of whether the borrower entered into a loan modification agreement, filed bankruptcy, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. The Substitute Trustees will convey either insurable or marketable title. If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey insurable or marketable title or, the post sale audit concludes that the sale should not have occurred, or the sale is not ratified by the court for any reason, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, subject to order of the court, the entire deposit (including any amount received over the advertised deposit amount) shall be forfeited to the Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulting purchaser and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorney's fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the resale. Defaulting purchaser waives personal service of any document filed in connection with such a motion on him/herself and/or any principal or corporate designee, and expressly agrees to accept service of any such document by regular mail directed to the address provided by said purchaser at the time of the foreclosure auction. Trustees' file number 22-002638-MD-F-1.

Laura H. G. O'Sullivan, et al.,
Substitute Trustees
LICENSE NOS. A000113, A000176, A000177, A000193, A000424, A000479, A000507, A000508

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Oct 7,14,21, 2026 0012527695

874

Spotsylvania County

TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
7000 TOWLES MILL ROAD,
SPOTSYLVANIA, VA 22551

878

Stafford County

TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
211 MIDSHIPMAN CIR,
STAFFORD, VA 22554

In execution of a certain Deed of Trust dated February 25, 2004, in the original principal amount of \$200,000.00 recorded in the Land Records of the Circuit Court for Stafford County, Virginia, as instrument No. 2004002694-1, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction in the front of the Circuit Court building for the City of Fredericksburg, 701 Princess Anne St., Fredericksburg, Virginia, or any such temporary alternative circuit court location designated by the judges of the Circuit Court, on **November 23, 2026, at 9:00 AM**, the property described in said deed of Trust, located at the above address, and more particularly described as follows:

ALL THAT CERTAIN LOT OR PARCEL OF LAND, CONTAINING 1.07 ACRES, OR LESS, DESCRIBED AS PARCELS "A" ON PLAT OF SURVEY PREPARED BY RICHARD H. BARTLETT, JR., DATED OCTOBER 12, 1995, AND DESIGNATED LOT NUMBER TWENTY ONE (21), ON PLAT OF SURVEY SECTION 6, OF AQUIA HARBOUR SUBDIVISION, RECORDED IN THE CLERK'S OFFICE OF THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR STAFFORD COUNTY, VIRGINIA IN PLAT BOOK 5, AT PAGE 17, TO WHICH REFERENCE IS HEREBY MADE, AND THE PARTICULAR DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY HEREIN REVEALED, THIS CONVEYANCE ALSO INCLUDES THE RIGHT TO USE IN COMMON WITH OTHER EASEMENTS OF ACCESS OVER AND UNDER THE PROPERTY AS SHOWN ON A PLAT RECORDED IN PLAT BOOK 4, PAGES 63 THROUGH 64, BOTH DATED AS WASHINGTON DISTRICT.

TERMS OF SALE: ALL CASH. A bidder's deposit of ten percent (10%) of the sale price or ten percent (10%) of the original principal balance of the subject deed of trust, whichever is lower, in the form of cash or cashier's check, shall be due at the time of sale. The balance of the purchase price will be due within fifteen (15) days of sale, otherwise Purchaser's deposit may be forfeited to Trustee. Time is of the essence. If the sale is set aside for any reason, the Purchaser at the sale shall be entitled to a return of the deposit. The Purchaser may, if provided by the terms of the Deed of Trust, be entitled to a \$50 cancellation fee from the Substitute Trustee, but shall have no further recourse against the Mortgagee, the Mortgagee or the Mortgagee's attorney. A form copy of the Deed of Trust and contract to purchase real property is available for viewing at www.alexdrpide.com. Additional terms, if any, to be announced at the sale and the Purchaser may be given the option to execute the contract of sale electronically.

This is a communication from a debt collector and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. The sale is subject to seller confirmation. Substitute Trustee: Equities Trustes, LLC, 8100 Three Chopt Road, Suite 240, Richmond, VA 23229. If you have any questions or concerns, please contact the Virginia Pre-Sale Department of counsel for Equities Trustes, LLC at 301-961-6555, website: www.alexdrpide.com.VA-385406-1

Oct 7,14,21, 2026 0012502539

This is a communication from a debt collector and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. The sale is subject to seller confirmation. Substitute Trustee: Equities Trustes, LLC, 8100 Three Chopt Road, Suite 240, Richmond, VA 23229. If you have any questions or concerns, please contact the Virginia Pre-Sale Department of counsel for Equities Trustes, LLC at 301-961-6555, website: www.alexdrpide.com.VA-385406-1

Oct 7,14,21, 2026 0012502539

This is a communication from a debt collector and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. The sale is subject to seller confirmation. Substitute Trustee: Equities Trustes, LLC, 8100 Three Chopt Road, Suite 240, Richmond, VA 23229. If you have any questions or concerns, please contact the Virginia Pre-Sale Department of counsel for Equities Trustes, LLC at 301-961-6555, website: www.alexdrpide.com.VA-385406-1

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Bethesda, MD 20814

(301) 907-8000

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4340 East West Highway, Suite 600

Bethesda, MD 20814

(301) 907-8000

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

8207 W B AND A ROAD
SEVERN, MD 21144

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Rodney E. Ruark dated March 11, 2005 and recorded in Liber 16156, folio 377 among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County, at the Court House Door, 8 Church Circle, Annapolis, MD 21401, on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 at 9:17 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with the buildings and improvements thereon situated in Anne Arundel County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. Tax ID #04-155-04888854.

The property, which is improved by a dwelling, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$10,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received in the office of the Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. There will be no reduction of interest due to overpayment of deposit. Adjustment of all real property taxes (excluding recapture of previously reduced or exempt taxes) and any other public charges or assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, and ground rent to be adjusted to date of sale and paid at execution of the deed, except where the secured party is the purchaser, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All due and/or unpaid private utility, water and sewer facilities charges, condo/HOA assessments and Columbia Assoc. assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, are payable by the purchaser without adjustment. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes, recaptured taxes (including but not limited to agricultural taxes), and settlement expenses shall be borne by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. Additional terms to be announced at the time of sale. THIS TRANSACTION MAY BE SUBJECT TO THE FIDEN RESIDENTIAL REAL ESTATE REPORTING RULE ("RRE Rule"). INFORMATION NECESSARY TO COMPLY WITH THE RRE RULE MUST BE PROVIDED TO THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES PRIOR TO CLOSING. FAILURE TO PROVIDE REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION FOR FIDEN REPORTING WILL BE CONSIDERED A DEFAULT. ADDITIONALLY, FAILURE TO PROVIDE THE REQUIRED INFORMATION UNDER SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES COULD RESULT IN THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE NOT EXECUTING THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES DEED. INTEREST WILL CONTINUE TO ACCRUE AND REMAIN THE SUCCESSFUL BIDDER'S RESPONSIBILITY UNTIL THE INFORMATION IS PROVIDED.

If the Trustees are unable to convey good and marketable title, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, subject to order of the court, the entire deposit (including any amount received over the advertised deposit amount) shall be forfeited to the Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulting purchaser and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorney's fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the resale. Defaulting purchaser waives personal service of any document filed in connection with such a motion on him/herself and/or any principal or corporate designee, and expressly agrees to accept service of any such document by regular mail directed to the address provided by said purchaser at the time of the foreclosure auction. Trustees' file number 22-002638-MD-F-1.

Diane S. Rosenberg, Mark D. Meyer, et al., Trustees
LICENSE NOS. A000113, A000176, A000177, A000193, A000424, A000479, A000507, A000508

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Sep 30,Oct 7,14, 2026 0012526917

878

Stafford County

TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
16 CROWN MAJOR DRIVE,
STAFFORD, VA 22554

268

Home & Garden

No cheap cleaning out gutters. Guaranteed! Leaf litter is backed up and clogging your gutters. Transferable warranty. Call today for a free estimate. No-cash guarantee and lifetime inspection and no obligation estimate. Get 15% off your entire order. Plus, Miller & Seniors get an additional 10% off. Limited time only. See us today for more details and price for warranty and other offers.

LOT 14, CROWN MAJOR, SEASIDE 100, THIS SALE OF LAND, BEING DULY DEDICATED, PLATTED AND RECORDED IN PLAT BOOK 24 AT PAGE 114-116, AND CORRECTED IN PLAT BOOK 24 AT PAGE 231-233, OF THE LAND RECORDS OF STAFFORD COUNTY, VIRGINIA, AND DESIGNATED LOT NUMBER TWENTY ONE (21), ON PLAT OF SURVEY SECTION 6, OF AQUIA HARBOUR SUBDIVISION, RECORDED IN THE CLERK'S OFFICE OF THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR STAFFORD COUNTY, VIRGINIA IN PLAT BOOK 5, AT PAGE 17, TO WHICH REFERENCE IS HEREBY MADE, AND THE PARTICULAR DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY HEREIN REVEALED, THIS CONVEYANCE ALSO INCLUDES THE RIGHT TO USE IN COMMON WITH OTHER EASEMENTS OF ACCESS OVER AND UNDER THE PROPERTY AS SHOWN ON A PLAT RECORDED IN PLAT BOOK 4, PAGES 63 THROUGH 64, BOTH DATED AS WASHINGTON DISTRICT.

TERMS OF SALE: ALL CASH. A bidder's deposit of ten percent (10%) of the sale price or ten percent (10%) of the original principal balance of the subject deed of trust, whichever is lower, in the form of cash or cashier's check, shall be due at the time of sale. The balance of the purchase price will be due within fifteen (15) days of sale, otherwise Purchaser's deposit may be forfeited to Trustee. Time is of the essence. If the sale is set aside for any reason, the Purchaser at the sale shall be entitled to a return of the deposit. The Purchaser may, if provided by the terms of the Deed of Trust, be entitled to a \$50 cancellation fee from the Substitute Trustee, but shall have no further recourse against the Mortgagee, the Mortgagee or the Mortgagee's attorney. A form copy of the Deed of Trust and contract to purchase real property is available for viewing at www.alexdrpide.com. Additional terms, if any, to be announced at the sale and the Purchaser may be given the option to execute the contract of sale electronically.

This is a communication from a debt collector and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. The sale is subject to seller confirmation. Substitute Trustee: Equities Trustes, LLC, 8100 Three Chopt Road, Suite 240, Richmond, VA 23229. If you have any questions or concerns, please contact the Virginia Pre-Sale Department of counsel for Equities Trustes, LLC at 301-961-6555, website: www.alexdrpide.com.VA-385406-1

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

722 UNIVERSITY DRIVE

WALDORF, MD 20602

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated September 5, 2023, recorded in Liber 13046, Folio 418 among the Land Records of Charles County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$374,099.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Charles County, 200 Charles St., La Plata, MD 20646, (Sale will be held in the breezeway between the Circuit Court and the District Court), on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 AT 1:02 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Charles County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$37,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 1012-1295B)

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

11683 CYGNET DRIVE

WALDORF, MD 20601

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated January 5, 2018, recorded in Liber 10158, Folio 257 among the Land Records of Charles County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$50,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Charles County, 200 Charles St., La Plata, MD 20646, (Sale will be held in the breezeway between the Circuit Court and the District Court), on

OCTOBER 27, 2026 AT 1:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Charles County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind. The property will be sold subject to a prior mortgage, the amount to be announced at the time of sale.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$50,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 382014-1)

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Oct 7,14,21, 2026

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

4111 HATLEY PLACE

WHITE PLAINS, MD 20695

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated August 31, 2023, recorded in Liber 13044, Folio 442 among the Land Records of Charles County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$465,159.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Charles County, 200 Charles St., La Plata, MD 20646, (Sale will be held in the breezeway between the Circuit Court and the District Court), on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 AT 12:42 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Charles County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$46,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 380400-1)

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SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE

OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

5102 GARIBALDI PLACE

WALDORF, MD 20603

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated February 21, 2007, recorded in Liber 6249, Folio 457 among the Land Records of Charles County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$248,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Charles County, 200 Charles St., La Plata, MD 20646, (Sale will be held in the breezeway between the Circuit Court and the District Court), on

OCTOBER 20, 2026 AT 12:40 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Charles County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$20,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 378592-1)

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File No. 131638.00054

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE

OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

9300 Parkway Subdivision Road

La Plata, MD 20646

(the "Property")

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Purchase Money Commercial Deed of Trust, Security Agreement and Fixture Filing (the "Deed of Trust") from 9300 Parkway Subdivision, LLC to Mangelli & Blotti PLLC, Trustee, dated September 8, 2023 and recorded in Book 13051, at Page 454, among the Land Records of Charles County, Maryland, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Substitute Trustees ("Trustees") will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Charles County, located at 200 Charles Street (in the breezeway between Circuit and District Courts), La Plata, MD 20646, on

October 16, 2026 at 11:00 AM

All that Fee-Simple lot of ground and the improvements thereon, if any, identified as Tax ID No. 06-052606 and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The Property and improvements, if any, thereupon will be sold in "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions, and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$24,000.00 by cashier's or certified check, or in such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine, at their sole discretion at the time of sale. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for Charles County. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate of 11.25% from the date of sale to the date funds are received in the office of the Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, including water/sewer charges and ground rent, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale forward. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer, and recordation taxes and settlement expenses shall be borne by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the Property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the Property from the date of sale forward. Additional terms may be announced at the time of the sale.

If the Trustees are unable to convey good and marketable title, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees for application against all expenses, attorneys' fees and the full commission of the sale price of the above-scheduled foreclosure sale. In the event of default, all expenses of this sale (including attorneys' fees and the full commission of this sale) shall be charged against and paid out of the forfeited deposit. Any remaining deposit shall be applied to the loan secured by the Deed of Trust. The Trustees may then re-advertise and resell the Property at the risk and expense of the defaulting purchaser or may avail themselves of any legal or equitable remedies against the defaulting purchaser without re-selling the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the Property by said defaulting purchaser, and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorneys' fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the resale.

Benjamin P. Smith
Rebekah F. Paradis
Substitute Trustees

HARVEY K. S.

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Sep 30,Oct 7,14, 2026

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The Washington Post

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4 liqueurs
to give your
bar cart
global flair

Spirits
M. CARRIE
ALLAN

As a lover of both Mexican agave spirits and the aperitif tradition, I never anticipated

finding a bottle that could lay claims to both categories. After all, as Hillhamn Salome — who started working to create Xila when she was only 19 — points out, Mexico doesn't really have that evening hour of social drinking and nibbling that serves as a warmup for dinner, in the way that many European countries do.

It's rare for a bottle to capture my affection as much as Xila (pronounced shee-lah) recently has. It's not so much a continuation of the European aperitif tradition as it is an intriguing detour: a rich, complex liqueur with an agave espadín base adorned with a roster of Mexican botanicals — hibiscus and lavender, ancho chile and black pepper, caramelized pineapple. Its stimulation of appetite happens not via the bitterness traditional in European bottles but with a soft, palate-tingling spice (though there is an extra-spicy version available for you hotheads, and it's a banger).

I've long joked that if there were ever a case of contamination at the Chartreuse

SEE **APERITIF** ON **E5**

RECIPE
Solar Flare Cocktail **E5**

At stores,
a blessing
that makes
us curse

BY EMILY HEIL

On a recent visit to the super-market, a trip through the self-checkout left me flustered. I was asked no fewer than five times to use the keypad. Was the total amount correct? Did I want to give to charity? How many bags did I use? Was my card credit or debit? I was asked to enter my PIN.

One of my items, a bottle of water I was already consuming, did not have a scannable code, necessitating a visit from the employee monitoring the area. I set off another alarm by not positioning my items properly in the bagging area. The option to tap my card didn't work, so I wound up swiping.

I had arrived already feeling stressed and rushed, and I left filled with annoyance that threatened to boil over into anger.

Many others find themselves similarly seeing red. When I mentioned this story, colleagues shared accounts of their self-checkout nightmares. Some people channel their rage in Reddit threads and on other social media.

SEE **SELF-CHECKOUT** ON **E3**



NOURISH
A savory salmon porridge for any time of day. **E2**

QUIZ
Are you making these food storage mistakes? **E6**

MORE AT WASHINGTONPOST.COM
Pesto Pantesco **Online**
Pear Overnight Oats **Online**
Red Chili Shrimp **Online**
Chat Thursday, 11 a.m.: wapo.st/chats



PHOTOS BY CLAY WILLIAMS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST



TOP: Jakob Dedona, a Rye employee, slices a \$60 loaf at the Lower Manhattan bakery. In Austria, Martin Auer's loaves are sold for 14 euros, or roughly \$16. **ABOVE:** The bread has a signature gingersnap-like crackle and is thinner and wider than what you'll find at most American bakeries. It's made with just water, organic rye flour and salt, and a 24-hour ferment gives the bread its characteristic sour tang.

This bread costs
a lot of dough

Martin Auer sells loaves of rye for \$60 in New York. It's everything that's right and wrong with the city.

BY ELAZAR SONTAG
IN NEW YORK

People are not happy about Rye by Martin Auer, the bakery that opened Sept. 10 on a tourist-mobbed block of SoHo. But as far as I can tell, few of the complaints — the slew of negative comments on Instagram and in TikTok reviews, the dismal 2.2-star Yelp rating — have much to do with quality. Rye sells just one item: a namesake loaf of bread that most who eat it agree is very good. It is also, as the numerous haters and skeptics are quick to point out, very, very expensive. ¶ \$60 per loaf, to be exact. ¶ On a recent trip to New York, I headed to Rye to give Manhattan's spendiest new bread a fair shake. The bakery was opened by Martin Auer, whose name is on the awning and most every other piece of branding in the shop. Auer owns 43 bakeries throughout his native Austria, but Rye is his first foray into the U.S. bread market. You wouldn't know it from the bakery's interior, which seems purpose-built for a certain kind of moneyed New Yorker. The space has the cool, almost stern feel of an Apple store, with tall gray walls and a long wooden counter that could comfortably serve as a display for Birkins or Manolo Blahniks but is used to slice and serve samples of the toasted and untoasted bread.

SEE **RYE** ON **E4**

Trade sugary oatmeal for savory porridge in this filling, protein-rich breakfast



In her cookbook “Scandinavian Everyday,” Nichole Accettola describes herself as a “PPP” — a passionate porridge person. Although she grew up in Ohio eating sugary

Ellie Krieger

NOURISH

instant oatmeal, she writes that she was living in Scandinavia around the time of “a porridge renaissance,” when “new ingredients and fresh ideas were finding their way into bowls across the region.” Over time, she became so much of a PPP she finished second in a porridge championship.

“Scandinavian Everyday” is Accettola’s second cookbook, and she uses it to dive into the healthful principles of New Nordic cuisine, including its focus on seasonal produce, whole ingredients and healthy proteins. She also devotes an entire chapter to porridge. She offers so many creative and enticing combinations — both sweet and savory, using a wide variety of grains, produce and proteins — she completely smashes the notion that hot cereal has to be overly sweet or stodgy.

This recipe, adapted from the book, is a savory porridge made with barley, seasoned with sautéed shallots, fresh herbs and lemon, and laced with ribbons of spinach and flakes of smoked salmon. It makes a deliciously different breakfast but would be appropriate for any time of day. It’s packed with filling fiber from the barley, some of which is ground first, making the texture both creamy and toothsome. And it’s protein-rich, with silky smoked salmon reminding us that eggs aren’t the only protein that works for mornings. The barley base can be made ahead and heated in individual servings as needed for a nutritious dish that can be pulled together quickly. It’s a satisfying meal in a bowl and, if you aren’t already, it will turn you into a PPP, too.

Krieger is a registered dietitian nutritionist, cookbook author, and cooking show and podcast host. Learn more at elliekrieger.com.



PHOTOS BY TOM MCCORKLE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST; FOOD STYLING BY GINA NISTICO



This hearty porridge is laced with ribbons of spinach and seasoned with sautéed shallots, fresh herbs and lemon juice. Some of the barley is ground into a coarse flour before going into the saucepan.

Barley Porridge With Spinach and Smoked Salmon

4 servings (makes about 4½ cups porridge)

This savory, fiber-rich barley porridge, with shallots, herbs and lemon, is hearty and satisfying. Laced with ribbons of spinach and flakes of smoked salmon, it makes for a comforting breakfast, lunch or dinner. The barley can be prepped ahead and reheated as needed for a nutritious meal that can be pulled together quickly.

Make ahead: The cooked barley can be refrigerated for up to 4 days in advance.

Storage: The porridge base, minus the toppings, can be prepared and refrigerated for up to 4 days. Reheat over low heat, stirring occasionally and adding additional water as needed to reach the desired consistency, until heated through.

Active time: 25 mins; **Total time:** 40 mins
Adapted from “Scandinavian Everyday” by Nichole Accettola (Ten Speed Press, 2026).

Ingredients

- 1½ cups (11½ ounces) pearly barley, divided
- 1 tablespoon neutral oil, such as avocado or canola
- 1 tablespoon unsalted butter
- 1 small shallot, thinly sliced into half-moons (about ⅓ cup)
- Pinch fine salt, plus more as needed
- 4 cups water, plus more as needed
- 2 cups (1½ ounces) loosely packed baby spinach
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh chives
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh dill, plus more for serving
- 2 tablespoons plus 1 teaspoon fresh lemon juice (from 1 lemon), divided
- Freshly ground black pepper
- 8 ounces hot smoked salmon, skin removed, flaked into chunks
- 4 teaspoons extra-virgin olive oil

Steps

- In a spice grinder or mini food processor, grind ½ cup (generous 3¾ ounces) of the barley into a very coarse flour.
- In a medium (4-quart) saucepan over medium heat, melt the oil and melt the butter. Add the shallot and cook, stirring, until softened, about 1 minute. Add the remaining 1 cup (about 7⅓ ounces) of barley and a pinch of salt and cook, stirring constantly, until it looks and smells toasted, about 2 minutes.
- Add the ground barley and the water, increase the heat to medium-high and bring to a boil. Decrease the heat to its lowest setting, cover and simmer, until the barley is very tender and creamy, about 20 minutes. If the porridge looks too thick, add a

- splash of water and stir to combine. Remove from the heat, cover and set aside to thicken further, about 10 minutes. (If not planning to serve this right away, transfer to an airtight container and refrigerate until needed.)
- Return the saucepan to low heat and add the spinach, chives, dill and 1 teaspoon of the lemon juice to the porridge. If needed, add another splash of water and cook, stirring, until the spinach wilts, about 30 seconds. (To prepare a single portion, see Notes.) Taste, and season with pepper and, if desired, more salt.
- Divide the porridge among bowls, then top each with 2 ounces of the salmon, 1½ teaspoons of the lemon juice and 1 teaspoon of the olive oil. Garnish with more dill and serve immediately.

Substitutions

- Pearled barley >> semi-pearled or unpearled barley, with an adjustment to the cooking time and water amount.
- Shallot >> red onion.
- Chives and dill >> fresh tender herbs of your choice.
- Vegetarian? >> Add a poached or fried egg in place of salmon.
- Water >> vegetable broth.

Notes

- For a single serving, use a generous 1 cup of the porridge, ½ cup of the spinach, 1½ teaspoons each of the chives and dill, and ¼ teaspoon of the lemon juice.

Nutrition | Per serving (generous 1 cup porridge and 2 ounces salmon): 537 calories, 67g carbohydrates, 33mg cholesterol, 22g fat, 13g fiber, 21g protein, 5g saturated fat, 568mg sodium, 2g sugar

Recipe tested by Olga Massov; email questions to food@washpost.com

Eating vegetables raw, making the most of tomatillos, coring cabbage and more

Q&A

BECKY KRYSTAL

Each Thursday at 11 a.m., Post recipes editor Becky Krystal answers questions and provides practical cooking advice in a chat with readers at washingtonpost.com/community. Here are edited excerpts. Recipes whose names are capitalized can be found at our Recipes landing page at washingtonpost.com/recipes.

Q: Ever since I was a child, I have dislike cooked vegetables. I remember Mom making me sit there till I ate my cooked carrots. I never did and she finally gave them to me raw, which I happily consumed. (She overcooked all veggies, even freshly picked asparagus, which went into the pot 30 minutes before Dad was due home. To make matters worse, Dad preferred veggies covered in white sauce.) I am convinced that whatever taste buds that perceive bitterness in veggies, I got more than my share. To this day I will eat just about any veggie raw. My question is, at this late date, is there any difference in nutrition between raw and cooked? Can I continue to eat them raw without feeling guilty?

A: It does somewhat depend on the vegetable and the cooking method, in my understanding. That being said, if you eat lots of raw vegetables, that doesn’t strike me as problematic — you’re probably way ahead of where many people are. I suspect many nutrition folks will say that whatever gets you to eat more vegetables (assuming it’s a healthy prep! i.e., not fried, drowning in cheese, cream, etc.) is what you should do. Still, I’m not the ultimate expert here, so I would encourage you to read around some reliable sources in case there are some things you might be open to trying cooked.

Q: I saw the Gingerbread Crinkle Cookies recipe in the very enjoyable article about fall recipes. I want to try them all!



TOM MCCORKLE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST; FOOD STYLING BY LISA CHERKASKY

Gingerbread Crinkle Cookies remix the traditional ginger cookie in an incredibly soft and chewy form, with a balance of the spices we know and love. Confectioners’ sugar adds a finishing touch.

What would happen if I used a full egg with the white and yolk in that cookie recipe, instead of just the yolk? I hate to waste the egg white and don’t have other uses for it.

A: Especially spread across more than two dozen cookies, it’s probably okay. Maybe the cookies will be a little less dense and chewy, but I don’t anticipate catastrophic issues. Egg whites do freeze well, though, and you can save them up to make a batch of meringues or macarons. They’re also a nice binder for granola or spiced nuts.

Q: Does salting steak, roasts and other cuts overnight resting in the fridge, uncovered, make for a better seasoned and more flavorful meal?

A: Yes! That gives the salt time to diffuse through the meat, which improves flavor, moisture retention and browning.

Q: I have high cholesterol. Could I reliably substitute evaporated milk for heavy cream in recipes? Probably not a good swap for things with a firmer texture (cheesecake or custard-ish). I’m thinking mainly sauces. Creamed spinach? Scalloped potatoes? Creamy soups? What type of

result can I expect? I’m okay with a little bit thinner sauce. I tried using whole milk for a saucy recipe and that came out way too watery, so I started thinking maybe evaporated milk?

A: Yes, for sure. Evaporated milk works as a heavy cream swap in many, but not all, recipes. The examples you give are probably safe bets, though, as you note, sauces or soups might be slightly thinner. You might get a slightly more cooked milk flavor, too. I’d be less inclined to use it in baking and desserts because it won’t whip, set, etc., the same way.

Q: We have harvested a ton of tomatillos. We’re salsa’ed out. Looks like chicken recipes are other options, but the recipes I find are extremely similar (Tex-Mex, Mexican). Maybe I’m asking too much, but what can I do to cook these babies? Getting ready to freeze a lot, too.

A: Wow, I’m jealous! Afraid my suggestions are going to mostly land in that genre, just because it’s the kind of cuisine you use them in, but maybe some of these will strike your fancy: Braised Chicken Thighs With Tomatillos, Roasted Tomatillo Salmon, Chicken With Tomatillos and Cilantro, Mango Tomatillo Salsa,



OLIVER PARINI/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Tomatillos have uses beyond salsa. Possibilities from our archive include Roasted Tomatillo Salmon and Everybody’s Chili Verde.

Cumin Beans With Tomatillo and Chips, Vegan Chili Verde, Cooked Green Salsa, Chile Verde, Everybody’s Chili Verde and Pork Tenderloin in Green Pipián Simmer Sauce.

Q: I have an unopened plastic bottle of honey, best by January of ’29. It is stored in a dark, cool cupboard. The bottom quarter has turned to sugar. I have tried setting it in a bowl of almost boiling water, but that didn’t help. I did this several times, but longer time didn’t remove/ dissolve the sugar. It isn’t a good idea to put a plastic container in the microwave to heat the honey. What else can I do to fix the problem? Assuming I am successful, can I use it safely in baking or cooking?

A: America’s Test Kitchen has a method you could try: “Mix it with light corn syrup (2 teaspoons per cup of honey) in a clean jar, place the jar in a saucepan with about an inch of water, and gently heat it until smooth.” If you are scraping it out of the original container anyway, you could transfer it to something that is microwave-safe to try that method. If all fails, combine it with boiling water to make a honey syrup to store in the fridge

that you can use in tea, cocktails or to brush over cakes. If you do succeed in getting the honey back to its proper state, it’s fine to use it however you like.

Q: What’s the easiest way to core a head of cabbage? I have a recipe for stuffed cabbages and it says to core a cabbage. I’m curious to know if there’s an easier way than what I’m doing.

A: I usually cut it into quarters and cut the core out of each big wedge.

Q: I have three grated zucchini (packaged separately) in my freezer. Besides chicken-zucchini meatballs and chocolate zucchini loaves, seeking easy suggestions.

A: Some recipes to consider are: Whole-Wheat Zucchini Bread, Zucchini-Potato Latkes, Zucchini Oat Muffins, Persian Zucchini Frittata, Zucchini Fritters (Frittelle di Zucca) and Zucchini Fritters.

Q: I have a question about your butter-measuring suggestion. Because most recipes ask for measurement by volume, what would be the advantage in converting volume to weight? Maybe it’s just a convenience factor with cold or hard butter?

Or, maybe butter volume varies by fat content? Or, is weight somehow more accurate because of some other factor in how butter is made? Would you suggest that, whenever one sees a volume measure, to first convert that to weight, basically at the rate of two tablespoons being equal to the weight of one ounce? Finally, my question at hand: In something like cookie recipes — say, chocolate chip cookies — I have heard that it is a plus to whip the butter more. What difference might it make to the end result?

A: I believe I made that suggestion because the person was working off a large portion of butter that was not in sticks that are easily cut off into tablespoons per the packaging. Otherwise, if a recipe lists volume (cups, tablespoons), fine to measure that way. It’s much more straightforward to do that and get a consistent result than, say, measuring flour by volume, which varies based on how much the flour is packed, the size of the measuring cup, etc. Properly creamed butter is important for getting the best rise and texture in many baked goods. Tall cakes, cookies that don’t spread, etc. Always follow the cues in the recipe, though — it will tell you what the mixture should look like after beating. Generally, I think people on the whole tend to underdo it.

Q: I received a big piece of fresh turmeric root in my CSA box. How should I store it? Another CSA recipient said he was juicing his. I don’t know what to do with this! Thoughts or ideas?

A: You should be able to refrigerate it for a few weeks in an airtight bag or container. I’d let it shine in raw, fresh applications, such as a smoothie or a warm drink (tea, golden milk, etc.). But you can incorporate it into curries, soups and stews by grating it as you would ginger. According to “The Food Substitutions Bible,” 2 tablespoons of grated fresh turmeric is equal to ¼ to ½ teaspoon ground.

Self-checkouts promised ease and speed. Why do so many of us hate them?

SELF-CHECKOUT FROM E1

“The people who don’t like self-checkout *really* don’t like it, and they’re very vocal about it,” said Jeff Wells, the lead editor of industry publication Grocery Dive. Some shoppers, though, far prefer them, even if they are less likely to take to social media to share their fondness. Experts say self-checkout is popular with younger shoppers — who are more accustomed to virtual interactions and, in many cases, prefer not dealing with humans.

And some consumer advocates note that it is far easier for shoppers to keep an eye on the register to ensure they are being charged the correct prices. Coupon collectors, too, like being able to closely monitor their transactions.

“I think consumers like the idea they can control the checkout process,” said Edgar Dworsky, the founder of consumer resource guide Consumer World. “They can see what they’re being charged and where they charge the right price when they scan a coupon.”

Retailers are just as divided as their customers. Some chains, such as Trader Joe’s, have made in-person checkouts a staple of their in-store experience. Others are doubling down on new technology. But after two decades of treating self-checkout as the inevitable future of shopping, many are experimenting with how much automation customers and stores actually want.

“We’re seeing some retailers that are pulling back from self-checkout, and then we have other retailers that are recommitting,” said Gary Hawkins, the CEO of Retail Mindsteps, a firm that advises retailers on technology. “So, you know, I don’t think there’s one overarching trend there.”

Self-checkout is widely used but may be dipping slightly: According to a 2026 survey by FMI, an association that represents large grocery chains, 33 percent of supermarket transactions last year took place at self-checkout, down from 35 percent the previous year. (The survey took data from 70 retail companies that include more than 42,000 stores.) And a September Toast survey of 340 convenience, grocery and bot-

tle shop retailers found that 36 percent of stores surveyed used self-checkouts, down seven points from the prior year.

Some chains that are dialing back or shifting their self-checkout strategies cite consumer ease and theft prevention. Limiting self-checkout to smaller purchases is a move several major retail chains have taken: Dollar General now limits self-checkout to shoppers with five items or fewer and is completely removing self-checkout in many stores. In 2024, Target limited service to people with 10 items or fewer.

At stores that embrace self-checkout, technology is evolving. AI tools are increasingly being used to identify items, so customers don’t have to look them up manually or enter codes. Tech vendor Diebold Nixdorf offers a service that uses computer vision to tell what kind of produce and how many units a customer is buying. And some retailers are



ILLUSTRATION BY CHLOE MEISTER/THE WASHINGTON POST; ISTOCK



BEBETO MATTHEWS/AP

Some shoppers see red over the frequent malfunctions of self-checkout kiosks, while others prefer not dealing with humans.

experimenting with cameras that can estimate buyers’ ages to reduce the “friction” that comes from needing to card customers who are buying beer or wine.

Many advancements, though, are not about improving the customer experience but about reducing theft. Cameras are common: Kroger uses technology from AI company Everseen, which uses video images to detect if shoppers don’t scan an item.

Despite broad concerns about AI’s impact on the workforce, more automation has not resulted in grocers employing fewer staff. The Bureau of Labor Statistics says grocery store employment reached approximately 2.66 million workers in 2025, a record high.

That doesn’t mean that the number of employees working at checkouts has increased, though. Many jobs have shifted as grocery stores have evolved: The rise in curbside pickup, for example,

means more staff is needed to fill carts. Understaffing, unsurprisingly, can make self-checkouts less pleasant for customers and staff.

In a 2024 paper titled “Please Wait, Help Is on the Way,” Harvard researchers found that self-checkouts, particularly when there aren’t enough workers to monitor them, can lead to greater “incivility,” including bullying and disrespect.

“Workplaces with self-checkout tend to understaff because they have these expectations of technology,” said Nayun Eom, a sociology graduate student who worked on the paper. “So then the workers who are there have to deal with customers often in moments when they’re frustrated or angry, so the default interaction is adversarial.”

And self-checkouts might not be offering the convenience shoppers think they are.

Christopher Andrews, a sociologist at Drew University who has studied the experience, notes that customers might not be as adept at scanning as a cashier who knows where the UPC codes are located, meaning DIY checkout isn’t necessarily faster — even if shoppers assume it is. “It’s a sort of funhouse effect,” Andrews said. “It feels faster because of the social psychology — because of the way we perceive time — and when we’re busy doing something, time seems to go by more quickly than when we’re standing there.”

Andrews sees self-checkouts as part of a broader phenomenon where consumers are taking on more of the labor associated with all kinds of tasks, from punching in the order for our fast-food meals to printing out our own airplane tickets. All these interactions, he says, have contributed to the feeling many of us have of being overworked, even though research shows working hours haven’t actually increased.

“When we survey people and ask them about their perceptions, people feel like they’re working more, and they feel more exhausted,” he said. “It’s because, in part, we’re doing more of these quasi work-like tasks during our time, but we’re not officially working.”



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PHOTOS BY CLAY WILLIAMS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Rye employee Christen Smallwood helps customers choose a loaf. With tall gray walls and a dramatically lit arrangement of loaves, the bakery looks more like a designer boutique than a place that sells bread.

At New York’s Rye, where loaves go for \$60, bread rises to status symbol

RYE FROM E1

At this counter, an employee will first begin to pitch you on your very own \$60 loaf, explaining as they hand over samples that each *miche* is made with just four ingredients: water, organic rye flour and salt ... and, oh, yeah, time. A 24-hour ferment is the fourth “ingredient,” giving the bread its characteristic sour tang. The person telling you all of this is dressed in a chic, cultish uniform that looks like what Issey Miyake might do to a flour sack. Behind the counter, a wall of loaves is arranged and dramatically backlit so as to resemble a bread-based piece of modern art.

In an emailed statement, a spokesperson for the bakery said that Auer’s New York pricing reflects costs “including rent, wages, transportation, regulations, development, packaging, design and the significant handwork involved” in making the bakery viable in New York. In Austria, his loaves are sold for 14 euros, or roughly \$16.

Though the bakery prides itself on selling only this one loaf (plus an array of tartines to be eaten at high-top tables), it turns out that nearly everything in the store is for sale — a \$290 toaster to refresh your bread, a \$480 storage container to preserve your bread, a \$230 serrated knife to cut your bread, a \$160 pair of loafers modeled by the person who sold you your bread, an \$80 cap printed with the word “RYE” so everyone knows what flour is in your bread. This is bread as status symbol. All the pomp and cynical cash grabs do a great disservice to the bread itself.

While too many elements of the bakery are designed for mindless spending, the bread is a genuine work of craftsmanship. The loaf is flatter and wider than what you’d find at a typical American bakery (hence the special storage container ...), with a surface that writer Charlotte Druckman astutely described as resembling “a giant gingersnap.” The ready-to-eat tartines, topped with a hazelnut spread, brie or any number of other salty-sweet elements, are good enough but no better than the toast you’ll find at a dozen other downtown cafes. The plain bread, however, is utterly delicious.

Its crust is stubbornly chewy, with a slight snap when you break through. The dense, dark interior is tangy and earthy. You can purchase it presliced, but I found primal pleasure in ripping off big chunks with my hands and tearing apart more manageable pieces with my teeth. Another bakery’s bread would make for



a nicer sandwich — this one is both too flavorful and too dense — but for savoring on its own, you won’t find tastier. There is an elemental joy to the rye at Rye, if you can look past all the window dressing and stomach the cost. (Half- and quarter-loaves also are available, at proportionally lower prices, \$30 and \$15, respectively.)

Anxiety over the price of boutique restaurant food has become a lightning rod in New York, serving as an uncomfortable repre-

sentation of gentrification and a changing city awash in transplants. This year alone has brought culture wars over the price of a Brooklyn half-chicken (\$40) and a plate of barbecue (\$90, albeit including a very substantial beef rib). And now, as if the city hasn’t endured enough indignity, a \$60 loaf of bread is here to remind us all that New York isn’t what it used to be.

But isn’t it? The tension between high and low, affordable and outrageously out of reach is

a defining quality of New York and its restaurants. It’s here where chef Masayoshi Takayama serves a sushi dinner that will set you back \$1,000. And also here where you can find good, affordable sushi in nearly every neighborhood — not to mention in the cold case at your local grocery store. Here where a pizzeria on the outskirts of historic Little Italy serves a \$68 pie and, just a few blocks away, a cheese slice still goes for \$1.50. New York is as ridiculous and practical as ever.



CLOCKWISE FROM LEFT: In addition to full loaves, Rye sells an array of sweet and savory tartines. Baker Riley Williams prepares an oven full of loaves at the bakery, which opened last month on a tourist-mobbed block of SoHo. Food influencer Victor Pham, left, films a taste test of the much-discussed rye bread.



In a city that has always contained so many possibilities and contradictions, every attainable pleasure has an outrageous counterpart. Case in point: Across the street from Rye is Carhartt Work in Progress, an upscale European offshoot of the affordable American workwear brand, where a flannel shirt costs \$168, and you’ll want to avoid getting paint on the \$308 painter’s jacket.

Rye by Martin Auer is not a neighborhood bakery but some-

thing closer to a designer boutique, eliciting in me the same mix of yearning and disgust that I feel upon spotting an immaculately constructed pair of shoes and then seeing the price tag. I drove home with a loaf of rye bread, and for a week, I’ve sliced off pieces to dip in olive oil, toast under the broiler and enjoy cold for breakfast. I savor it knowing I won’t be back. One \$60 loaf is enough. In a city of endless choice, there’s a lot more good bread to eat.

Popeyes finally gives the people what they want: A chicken biscuit sandwich

BY TIM CARMAN

One of my favorite things about fast-food restaurants is their willingness to let customers innovate for them, a reminder that some of the best ideas don't come from test kitchens or corporate boardrooms but from the people who know how to hack an existing menu.

The latest example arrived last week at Popeyes, the Louisiana kitchen that made us lose our collective minds seven years ago over a chicken sandwich. The Miami-based chain just introduced the honey chicken biscuit, a sandwich that customers have apparently been engineering tableside for years. I stand in awe of the moxie of the American diner who reviews a fast-food menu and says, "I can do better."

For better or worse, I think

most Popeyes stans will want to compare the latest offering to the chicken sandwich that launched a thousand imitators. I think that's a mistake. The two sandwiches feel like two sides of the same coin, connected but distinct.

The original sandwich is the pinnacle of the corporate-kitchen craft, a succulent chicken breast fried and entombed in a sweet brioche bun, offset with briny pickles to provide just enough pucker. While it has Southern touches, the sandwich still feels very much like a fast-food creation, its bun a dead giveaway that it doesn't want to wander too far from the competition.

The honey chicken biscuit, by contrast, feels *Southern* Southern. Like sweet tea on a South Carolina veranda in mid-July. Popeyes designed a slighter larger version of its beloved biscuit to

accommodate the thick, crackly breast meat, a protein so tender you'd swear it's 50 percent buttermilk. The biscuit and chicken come unadorned, the former doing its best to contain the gnarly length of fried bird. The combo includes two packets of "honey sauce," whose corn-syrup sweetness completes the picture.

I pounded this sandwich like I had not eaten in a week. Its components just locked into place: chicken, salt, butter, honey, crunch, flakiness, simplicity, elegance. This is a dish that somehow takes you outside the sterile walls of a chain and provides the kind of comfort we long for in our food.

The chain owes its customers a huge thanks for pointing it in the direction of this winning combo.



TIM CARMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Chiles, spices, matcha and more add international interest to cocktail traditions

APERITIF FROM E1

or Campari production facilities, I'd be the first to drop — the boozy canary in the coal mine. Rare is the week when I don't use some of the green stuff or the red stuff — it's Christmas year-round in my cocktails. I mention these two iconic brands to explain my surprise earlier this year when I realized that, over the past several months, the levels of those bottles on my shelf had dropped only by a few ounces. Meanwhile, since discovering Xila last winter when the adorable bottle caught my eye — I initially wondered why the liquor store was stocking shampoo — I had plowed through two bottles and was trying to figure out where I could pick up a third.

I'd been pouring it straight over ice. I'd been mixing it into cocktails, including a spice-driven Negroni variation. I'd made several punches for parties and happy hours, and doctored up some spicy margaritas. I'd also blathered about it to enough people that I started seeing a little fear in their eyes, the kind that shows up when someone stands up on a plane and starts talking to other passengers about Jesus. (Apparently that's a thing that's happening now? What a time to be alive.)

But I digress.

Salome grew up in and worked as a bartender in Mexico City and fell in love with cocktails, and she noticed that Mexico, while having produced a long and wonderful spirits tradition in tequila and mezcal, did not make many liqueurs. She wanted to step into that space with something new, so she started taking classes and reading and experimenting with flavors. There were already so many bittersweet liqueurs available, and it didn't seem authentic to Mexico to go in that direction. She says she thought, "I can either go after Aperol and Campari and never beat them ... or I can create something completely new."

Thus the flavor notes in Xila are a deliberate departure, but "very common in Mexican culture and cuisine," Salome says. Lavender is everywhere in Mexican green spaces, she says, and agua de Jamaica (hibiscus water) is a frequent offering for refreshment. "Then the three spices — cloves, cinnamon and pepper, which you can also find in our salsas, mole, cafe de olla. And the caramelized pineapple, we use it in our tacos and other things as well. And then the ancho chile, I chose that because in the variety of chiles, it's spicy, but it's not too spicy."

Salome estimates they went through something like 150 different test batches before settling on the final version. It took about a year and a half to develop and launch; the brand won its first gold medal in a blind tasting in 2016; this year it won double gold at the San Francisco World Spirits Competition.

Salome likes using Xila as a vermouth substitute in a Negroni (I concur) but says her favorite uses are in low-ABV drinks, pairing it with soda or tonic water. It works well in coffee cocktails, too.

The drink I've been making most with it is the Solar Flare, which I came up with on the fly, inspired by cocktails like the Jungle Bird and the Naked and Famous, where a bitter red Italian liqueur comes in to play with brighter, richer ingredients, keeping them from veering too far into treacle territory. The



PHOTOS BY DEB LINDSEY/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

ABOVE: From left, Kota Pandan Liqueur, Chambéryzette, Xila and Yoshi Matcha Liqueur. BELOW: The spicy Solar Flare Cocktail features Xila, a Mexican aperitif.

Solar Flare's deep orange color — like a cantaloupe with a sunburn — derives from the combination of Xila, Aperol, passion fruit syrup and a hit of Angostura bitters, and it works with a good blanco tequila or a roastier mezcal. In either form, it's approachable but complex, so it'll meet the needs of your normie friends who just want to party and your weirdo friends who want to lurk in the corner, talk to the dog and geek out about cocktails.

Xila's been the runaway bottle hit of my year, and I'm even more of a fan after learning about how Salome has been using the bottle to empower women in the spirits world in Mexico — the production is women-led, the brand is represented by women, and she works with a U.S. importer led by women. But to keep from descending too far into blathering fan-girl territory, I'll mention a few other newish liqueurs worth your attention. Representing a range of global flavors, one of them may be your next obsession, helping your cocktails travel far and wide.

Chambéryzette

This strawberry vermouth made by Dolin since the early 1900s finally became available in the United States last year. You can argue that the berries aren't inherently French, but if you've had a strawberry at a market in the South of France and felt a sudden rush of indignation realizing what you'd been missing with the version we get in American grocery stores, you'll get it. It has a soft bitterness, and the aromatics of vermouth harmonize with the berries. Put it in your Negroni or muddle it with basil into a spritz.



Kota Pandan Liqueur

It's difficult to describe the flavor and fragrance of pandan, a Southeast Asian plant that stars in Kota and has long flavored Asian desserts. (If you're a fan of sticky rice, throw some pandan leaf into your steamer before cooking and enjoy the results.) I first encountered the liqueur in a Painkiller variation and was wowed by it. It's a little grassy, a little vanilla-y, subtle but influential in a drink. Its applications in the tiki space are extensive, it makes a lovely sweetener in a classic daiquiri, and it adds a new layer of aromatic complexity to an espresso martini.

Yoshi Matcha Liqueur

Matcha purists, those who have delved for years into the many grades and nuances of the green tea used in Buddhist ceremonies in Japan, may pooh-pooh this matcha liqueur, and that's fair: Traditional matcha is a very different thing. But for those who love a matcha latte and want to take that coffeehouse treat into cocktail territory without having to whip up your own matcha syrups, this bottle can help. A rich, smooth green, made with ceremonial-grade matcha and oat milk (so it's vegan-friendly), it retains the grassy note of the tea but leans sweet. If you like the flavor but want to cut the sweetness, look for acidic and drier ingredients to balance it out.

Search “Flannel Shirt Cocktail” or “Pear of Queens Cocktail” in our recipe archives

Find these dishes and discover more dinner inspiration in our archive of more than 10,000 Post-tested recipes.

Recipe questions? Email food@washpost.com.

Solar Flare Cocktail

1 serving (makes 1 drink)

A great drink for parties, this spicy agave and passion fruit cocktail gets a boost of complexity from Xila, a Mexican liqueur flavored with hibiscus, chile, pineapple and spices. Use your preferred blanco tequila or opt for a smoky mezcal — either works well.

Where to buy: Xila can be found at well-stocked liquor stores or online. (If you're a heat-lover, look for the extra-spicy version.) Passion fruit syrup, from brands such as Real or Liber, can be found at well-stocked liquor stores, specialty markets and online.

Active time: 5 mins;
From Spirits columnist M. Carrie Allan.

Ingredients

- 1 large ice cube, plus smaller ice cubes for shaking
- 1½ ounces blanco tequila or mezcal
- 1 ounce fresh lime juice (from 1 lime)
- ¾ ounce passion fruit syrup (see Where to buy)
- ½ ounce Aperol
- ½ ounce Xila (see Where to buy)
- 2 dashes Angostura bitters
- Pinch fine salt (optional)
- 1 to 2 thin slices Fresno or habanero chile, for garnish (optional)

Steps

- Add the large ice cube to a rocks glass and set aside.
- Fill a cocktail shaker with ice, then add the tequila or mezcal, lime juice, passion fruit syrup, Aperol, Xila, bitters and salt, if using. Shake briefly to chill and dilute, about 10 seconds, then

double-strain into the glass. Rest the chile slice, if using, on the ice cube, and serve.

Variations

- Try other red Italian-style aperitivi in place of the Aperol, or swap in pineapple syrup instead of the passion fruit.

Notes

- This drink can be easily scaled up to make a batch for a group. To serve 8, in a punch bowl, combine 1½ cups tequila or mezcal, 1 cup fresh lime juice, ¾ cup passion fruit syrup, and ½ cup each Xila and Aperol. Add bitters to taste, followed by ¾ cup water. Stir well to combine, add a punch ice block and serve.

Nutrition | Per drink: 249 calories, 26g carbohydrates, 0mg cholesterol, 0g fat, 0g fiber, 0g protein, 0g saturated fat, 5mg sodium, 24g sugar

Recipe tested by M. Carrie Allan; email questions to food@washpost.com



Scan the QR code with your phone's camera or visit wapo.st/findrecipes.

Are you storing these foods wrong? Test your knowledge.

1. Your avocado isn’t ripe yet, and you want to make guacamole. What’s the best way to help it ripen more quickly?

- A. Wrap it in foil and bake in a 200-degree oven for 10 to 30 minutes
- B. Place it in a paper bag next to an apple or a banana at room temperature
- C. Put it in the freezer and thaw it in warm water
- D. Leave it on a sunny windowsill for 12 hours

2. You bring home fresh berries. Should you wash them before storing them in the refrigerator?

- A. Yes, wash them immediately
- B. No, keep them dry and wash them just before eating
- C. Only if you store them in an airtight container
- D. It doesn’t make a difference

3. You’ve opened a bottle of ketchup. Where should you store it to maintain the best quality?

- A. On the counter
- B. In the pantry
- C. In the refrigerator
- D. Either the counter or the refrigerator; it makes no difference

6. You bring home fresh carrots. What’s the best way to help them last longer?

- A. Store them in jars of water in the fridge
- B. Peel them before putting them away
- C. Freeze them before putting them in the refrigerator
- D. Cut their greens off and store them in the fridge

9. Your tomatoes are ripe, but you aren’t ready to eat them. What should you do with them?

- A. Store them in a shaded place, like a cupboard or drawer
- B. Wrap them in a wet paper towel and store them in the fridge
- C. Keep them on the counter at room temperature
- D. Store them upside down on a plate in the fridge

10. You bring home a carton of eggs. Where should you store them?

- A. In the original carton on a refrigerator shelf
- B. Loose, in the refrigerator door
- C. On the counter
- D. In an open container in the refrigerator*

BY ALEXANDRA TIRADO OROPEZA

So you come home with groceries, and now it's time to put them away. After meal-prepping, making grocery lists and actually buying the food, this is supposed to be the easy part. And yet, berries grow fuzz, carrots go

limp, and avocados seem to leap from rock-hard to mush when you aren't looking. With grocery prices going up, every extra day of freshness counts. Take our quiz to find out whether your storage habits are helping your food last or hurrying it toward the trash.



ILLUSTRATION BY LAUREN MARTIN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

4. You bought a large package of yeast but don’t bake often. What’s the best way to store it?

- A. In the pantry
- B. In the freezer
- C. In the fridge
- D. In a dark cupboard

5. You’re putting away potatoes. You should avoid storing them next to:

- A. Onions
- B. Vinegar
- C. Yogurt
- D. Garlic

7. You bought a large bag of nuts that will take several months to finish. Where should you keep it to extend the shelf life?

- A. In the original bag in a cool pantry
- B. In an airtight container in the refrigerator
- C. In an airtight container in the freezer
- D. In a glass jar on the counter

8. You bring home raw meat from the grocery store. How soon should you cook or freeze it?

- A. Within two days
- B. Within three to five days
- C. By the “use by” date
- D. Within a week

0-3: We’re scared of going through your fridge ... We’ve all made a few food storage mistakes! Put what you’ve learned into practice after your next grocery run.

4-7: Not bad! You know a thing or two about keeping food fresh. Put what you’ve learned into practice after your next grocery run to make your groceries last even longer.

7-10: You are a food organization master May your avocados always be perfectly ripe, your bananas stay golden and your berries never go fuzzy.

8. **A.** The Agriculture Department recommends cooking or freezing fresh poultry, fish and ground meats within two days. Other fresh meats, such as beef, veal, lamb and pork can generally stay refrigerated for three to five days. Bonus tip: If you're freezing it in its original packaging, wrap the unopened package with freezer-safe foil or plastic wrap to help maintain quality.

9. **D.** Technically, if you really want to slow ripening, experts recommend storing them at 50 degrees, which is what you'd typically get in a cellar. But for those of us without cellars, storing them in the fridge after they are ripe is just fine and a good way to preserve them longer. For the best flavor, be sure to bring them back to room temperature before serving. Bonus tip: Storing tomatoes stem side down might help them last longer.

10. **A.** The official recommendation is for eggs to be stored in the fridge — at least in the United States. The Food and Drug Administration recommends storing eggs promptly in a refrigerator at 40 degrees or below, ideally on a refrigerator shelf rather than in the door, where temperatures fluctuate more. For best quality, the FDA recommends using refrigerated eggs within about three weeks.

5. **A.** Don't store onions and potatoes together. Onions can cause the spuds to sprout faster because of the ethylene they release, much like bananas and apples. (If you see sprouts, don't panic. Rub off the small ones and cut out the big ones.) Another tip: Don't store your potatoes in the fridge. The cold can cause their starches to turn into sugars, which can affect their taste and texture.

6. **D.** Refrigerating carrot sticks in jars of water can help keep them crunchy for a few days, but their total shelf life will probably not be meaningfully extended by this, and it's important to change the water often. Bonus tip: Before you store whole carrots (preferably in plastic bags in the high-humidity crisper drawer, or in a Veggie bag or similar product), trim off any green tops, as they draw out moisture and can cause carrots to go limp.

7. **If you picked either B or C, you are correct.** Nuts contain oils that can turn rancid when exposed to heat, light and air. Refrigeration can keep nuts fresh for up to a year, while freezing can extend their shelf life to about two years. An airtight container also prevents them from absorbing moisture and odors from other foods.

2. **B.** It may be tempting to wash all of your produce as soon as you get home so it's ready for grab-and-go snacking. But berries, especially delicate varieties such as raspberries and blueberries, last longer when kept dry to preserve their freshness and flavor. Wait to wash them until just before eating.

3. **C.** Ketchup's acidity makes it shelf-stable, so it can safely sit at room temperature, but Heinz recommends refrigerating it after opening to maintain the best quality. The Agriculture Department recommends using opened ketchup within six months, even if its expiration date extends longer.

4. **B.** Freezing helps yeast stay fresh for at least a year, making it the best option if you bake infrequently. You can use it straight from the freezer — there's no need to thaw it.